Zackary Mark

Volume 1: SPASD Student Voice

Student voice in the Sun Prairie Area School District: the District-Wide Student Council, weighted grades and Act 95, the district budget, surveys, and the letters, meetings and emails behind them.

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Executive Summary

Zackary Mark is a student advocate at Sun Prairie West High School. He runs two independent projects: **SPASD Student Voice** (since January 2026), which brings student input to Sun Prairie Area School District leaders, and **Sun Prairie ALPR** (since July 2026), a plain-language community report on the police department's license plate reader cameras.

What changed because students spoke up

- District newsletters will go to every student, confirmed in writing on October 21.
- Students sat on principal interviews and met the superintendent finalists, and a Student Senate restarted at Sun Prairie West.
- Students helped write the weighted grades plan; it went to the Board on November 9, with a final vote expected late November.
- Superintendent Dr. Reed backed a District-Wide Student Council ("I love this idea"); Patrick Marsh signed on and other schools are responding.
- The police chief put plate reader commitments in writing: a 14-day retention trial, no livestreaming, monthly audits and a public data-sharing agreement after signing.

Also answered in writing: the district confirmed on October 1 that LGBTQIA+ protections are unchanged.

What's still open: a formal path and sponsor for the student council, the final weighted grades vote, the city's Nov 17 budget vote on the Axon cameras, a public records request, and questions to the Board about the superintendent's license.

How this record works: every email appears as a numbered card (E-001 onward) with sender, recipients and date. Officials' statements are quoted, not paraphrased, and labeled as statements rather than policy. Student names other than Zackary's are removed. Sources and an index are at the back.

What Happened, Why I Started & Why It Matters

How this started, where things stand, and the words you need to read the rest.

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What happened

Two cases involving former Sun Prairie West High School staff shaped how a lot of students feel about safety and trust in our district. These are the facts as reported in public court records and the news:

- Robert Gilkey-Meisegeier, a former coach and dean of students, pleaded guilty in federal court to producing child sexual abuse material. On April 28, 2026, he was sentenced to 18 years in federal prison. A related state case was dismissed after the federal conviction.
- Jennifer Ploeger, a former principal, was charged with three misdemeanor counts of failing to report suspected child abuse. On June 25, 2026, she pleaded no contest to one count, the other two were dismissed, and she was placed in a deferred prosecution program. A no contest plea is not an admission of guilt, and she has not been convicted.

Students mostly learned about both cases through rumors and the news, not from the district. That gap is a big reason this work exists.

Sources: WKOW, Apr 28, 2026 · WTMJ, Jun 1, 2026 · WMTV15, Jun 25, 2026 · Spectrum News, Jun 25, 2026. Status as of October 20, 2026.

Why I started

In January 2026, I wrote to the Sun Prairie School Board after a hard stretch in our district left a lot of students unsure what happened and

who to trust. I proposed a six-part Student Safety & Trust Framework: clearer communication after serious incidents, a plain explanation of how reporting works, the same rules in every building, a real student voice, better mental health support, and regular check-ins on how it's going.

That letter turned into meetings with district leaders, a new Student Senate at a district high school, students helping choose a principal and a superintendent, a seat on the weighted grades work group, and a proposal for a district-wide Student Advisory Council. Along the way, the same questions about transparency led to meetings with the Sun Prairie Police Department about its license plate reader cameras.

The goal hasn't changed. Student voice should be a regular, documented part of how SPASD makes decisions, not something that depends on one student or one principal.

Why it's important

Students are the people most affected by what happens in our schools, but we're usually the last to hear about it and the least likely to be asked. When something serious happens and nobody tells us anything, rumors fill the gap. That makes it harder to trust the adults who are supposed to keep us safe, and harder to speak up when something is wrong.

In outreach this year, most students said they feel physically safe at school. The problem is follow-through. As one student put it: "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen."

Decisions about grades, safety, communication, and leadership shape the next four years of our lives. Weighted grades and Act 95 decide who gets guaranteed admission to UW schools. How incidents are communicated decides whether we hear the truth or a rumor. Who leads our schools decides how all of that gets handled. Students should have a say before those decisions are final, not find out after.

It also works when it's done right. Students served on principal and superintendent interview panels, helped restart a Student Senate, shaped the weighted grades plan, and got the district to start sending its newsletters to every student. Those changes happened because students asked, followed up, and kept a record.

The same goes beyond school. The license plate reader cameras affect everyone who drives in Sun Prairie, including students and their families. People deserve to know what's being collected, who can see it, and how long it's kept, in plain language.

Why this record exists

I keep every email, invite, and set of notes so the conversations, answers, and commitments don't get lost, and so anyone can check what was said and when. Student names have been removed, except mine. This is an independent, student-led record, not an official Sun Prairie Area School District document, and it is shared in good faith, not to accuse any person.

At a Glance: Where Things Stand

Where things stand (November 10, 2026)

- **WON** **newsletters to every student.** Asked for at the Oct 20 meeting; the district confirmed in writing on Oct 21 that newsletters will go to students starting in November.
- **ANSWERED IN WRITING** **LGBTQIA+ protections unchanged** (Oct 1).
- **WON** **students in the room for leadership hiring.** Students sat on the SPWHS principal interviews and met the superintendent finalists (April).
- **WON** **a Student Senate restart** at Sun Prairie West, with students elected in April.
- **MOVING** **weighted grades.** Students helped write the plan and four of them previewed it with Board members on Nov 2. Next: student rehearsal and Board meeting Nov 9, a follow-up with district and school leaders Nov 17, final vote expected late November.
- **BUILDING** **a District-Wide Student Council.** Proposed to Superintendent Dr. Reed on Oct 29 ("I love this idea"), discussed with him in person Nov 4, then opened to every middle and high school, grades 6–12. Patrick Marsh signed on Nov 5 with 3–5 Peer Ambassadors, Prairie Phoenix's principal wrote that he is supportive, and Sun Prairie East offered its weekly newsletter and SP30, then said on Nov 10 it can't share the invitation until the council is school-sponsored. Still open: how a district-level group registers and who sponsors it.
- **ANSWERED** **how Board student reps are chosen.** Two-year terms; recruiting starts in December, applications open mid-January for sophomores.
- **ANSWERED IN WRITING** **license plate readers.** SPPD's written FAQ (Oct 16) and the Chief's Oct 27 answers: a 14-day Axon retention trial, no livestreaming, monthly audits, and a public data-sharing MOU after signing. These are department statements,

not contract terms yet.

- **ASKED IN WRITING** **plate reader records.** Public records request for the Axon estimate, Policy F-18, data-sharing agreements and audit records, filed Nov 9. The Chief also said he's open to a quarterly transparency report once Axon is approved.
- **WAITING** **the Mayor.** Meeting requested Oct 2.

How to use this record

Part 1 has every contact and every meeting in order. Parts 2–4 cover school district work, Part 5 the license plate reader project, Part 6 emails with the city, police, state and district, and Parts 7–8 the surveys and the public Student Voice pages. Emails appear as cards with the subject, sender, recipients and date. Anything marked as a department or district statement is what officials said, not a signed policy or contract.

Glossary

- **Act 95** — Wisconsin law that guarantees UW admission to top-ranked students, which is why class rank and how GPA is calculated matter.
- **ALPR** — Automated license plate reader: a camera that photographs passing cars and reads the plate.
- **Axon** — The company Sun Prairie plans to switch to for plate readers, starting May 2027.
- **Capstone** — An advanced, project-based course; part of the weighted grades plan.
- **F-18** — SPPD's written policy on license plate readers.
- **Flock** — Flock Safety, the company behind Sun Prairie's current plate reader cameras.
- **Fusus** — Software that can pull camera feeds into a live view. The Chief said there will be no livestreaming.
- **Hotlist** — A list of plates police are looking for, such as stolen cars. A match is an alert, not proof of a crime.
- **MOU** — Memorandum of understanding: a written agreement between agencies, here about sharing plate data.
- **PSC** — The City of Sun Prairie's Public Safety Committee.
- **SP-ALPR** — Sun Prairie ALPR, Zackary's independent project on the city's plate readers (sunprairiealpr.netlify.app).
- **SPASD** — Sun Prairie Area School District.
- **SPPD** — Sun Prairie Police Department.
- **SPWHS / SPW** — Sun Prairie West High School. **SPE** is Sun Prairie East.
- **T&L Committee** — The Board of Education's Teaching & Learning Committee.
- **Weighted grades** — A GPA scale where harder classes (AP, capstones, some dual credit) can count up to 5.0 instead of 4.0.
- **287(g)** — A federal program that lets local agencies help with immigration enforcement. SPPD says plate data won't be shared

with agencies in it.

- **Committee of the Whole** — A Board of Education meeting where all members discuss an item in depth before a formal vote.
- **MTSS** — Multi-tiered system of support: a school's layered approach to academic and emotional help, from all students to those needing the most.
- **Outpost** — Axon's solar-powered plate reader camera, the model in the draft Sun Prairie estimate.
- **Peer Ambassadors** — A Patrick Marsh student group whose members may join the student council pilot.
- **PLC** — Professional Learning Center, 220 Kroncke Dr., where the Board of Education meets.
- **SP30** — Sun Prairie East's daily advisory period, where announcements and slides are shared.
- **Public records request** — A request under Wisconsin law for copies of government records.

1. Contacts & Meetings

Who Zackary has worked with and every meeting, first as one table and then in detail.

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Contacts

City of Sun Prairie & Public Safety

- Kevin Warych — Chief of Police, Sun Prairie Police Department — Office (608) 825-1153 — kwarych@cityofsunprairie.com — 2598 W. Main St., Sun Prairie, WI 53590
- Michelle Garrison — PD Business Manager, SPPD — Office (608) 825-1149 — mgarrison@cityofsunprairie.com
- Mayor Stocker — mayor@cityofsunprairie.com (also sstocker@cityofsunprairie.com)
- Rex Owens — Alder, District 1 — (608) 896-4260 — rowens@cityofsunprairie.com
- Other council/committee addresses on the June 2026 Flock email: sschmidt@, tveith@, rsilva@cityofsunprairie.com
- Joshua Clements, AICP — Planning Director — Office (608) 825-0854 — jclements@cityofsunprairie.com — 300 E. Main St.
- John Brimmer — jrbrimmer@cityofsunprairie.com (solar/facilities); backups Scott Hallebach (608) 825-0710, Richard Gobeli
- City IT help — help@cityofsunprairie.com, (608) 825-0808
- Office of the City Clerk — (608) 837-2511, Mon–Fri 8:00 a.m.–4:30 p.m. — FAX (608) 825-6879 — 300 E. Main St., Sun Prairie, WI 53590 — www.cityofsunprairie.com
- Public Safety Committee written comments — sschmidt@cityofsunprairie.com — online comments:

cityofsunprairie.com/Comments/publicsafetycommittee

- Chris Garrison — Fire/EMS Chief
- Ryan Cox — Assistant Chief, SPPD
- Lt. Ray Thomson — SPPD
- Det. Jeremy Rademacher — SPPD (Toy Drive Fundraiser)
- Sun Prairie Media Center — sunprairiemediacenter.com; Charter channel 983; TDS channels 983/1983
- Sun Prairie Public Library — 1350 Linnerud Drive

State Officials & Candidates

- Representative Francesca Hong — info@francescahong.com
- David Crowley (Milwaukee County Executive) campaign — info@crowleyforwi.com

ALPR Vendors

- Axon Enterprise, Inc. — 17800 N 85th St, Scottsdale, AZ 85255 — (800) 978-2737 — ALPR@axon.com — trust.axon.com
- Brandon Jones — Axon sales representative — brjones@axon.com
- Neera Islam — Axon Marketing Project Manager — nislam@axon.com
- Flock Safety — Sun Prairie transparency portal: transparency.flocksafety.com/sun-prairie-wi-pd

SPASD District Leadership & Staff

- Dr. Antoine Reed — Superintendent (since July 1, 2026)
- Bradford (Brad) Saron — former Superintendent — bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org
- Dr. Taren Turner — Assistant Superintendent of Teaching, Learning & Equity (TLE) — trturne@sunprairieschools.org
- Sarah PrankeKlang — Director of Secondary TLE (listed earlier as CHMS Principal) — saprank@sunprairieschools.org
- Dr. Sarah Chaja-Clardy — Director of Secondary Teaching, Learning & Equity — srchaja@sunprairieschools.org

- Dr. Curtis (Curt) Mould — Director of Digital Media, Innovation and Strategy; Robotics Advisor; organizer, Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group — cdmould@sunprairieschools.org — 608-834-6531
- Matt Clark — Director of Business & Finance — (608) 834-6510 — mpclark@sunprairieschools.org
- Jewel Mucklin — Assistant Superintendent of Operations
- Karen Richmond — Executive Assistant to Superintendent and Board Leadership — (608) 834-6502 — krrichm@sunprairieschools.org
- Janet Thomas — Director of Student Services — (608) 834-6638 — jathoma@sunprairieschools.org
- Jennifer Apodaca — Director of Student Services — jjapoda@sunprairieschools.org
- Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr. — Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion — mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org
- Marlita A. Bevenue — Director, Strategic Communications — mabeven@sunprairieschools.org — 501 S. Bird Street
- Vientiane Yang — Multimedia & Website Specialist, SPASD — (608) 834-6568 — 501 S. Bird Street (district story interview and headshot, Oct. 22, 2026)
- Carolyn Pao — Administrative Associate, Systemic Equity & Inclusion — cmpao@sunprairieschools.org — (608) 834-6592
- Dr. Tricia Rodey, Ph.D. — answered Title IX / LGBTQIA+ protections questions
- Dr. Christopher Sadler — Human Resources Director — cjsadle@sunprairieschools.org
- Nicholas (Nick) Reichhoff — district administrator — nfreich@sunprairieschools.org
- Stephanie Leonard-Witte — smleona@sunprairieschools.org
- Katelyn Janssen — AVID District Coordinator — kmjanss@sunprairieschools.org
- Kristine Wendorf — Infinite Campus questions — kkwendo@sunprairieschools.org

- Jordain Blank — SPWHS office (meeting scheduling, Act 95 superintendent session) — jnblank@sunprairieschools.org
- District Service Center — 501 S. Bird St., Sun Prairie (Student Voices meetings, Room 100)
- SPASD Title IX Coordinator — contacted Sept. 29, 2026

SPASD Board of Education

- Diana McFarland — Board President — dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org
- Bryn Horton — bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org
- Colleen Uhlenkamp — cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org
- Amanda Davis — andavis@sunprairieschools.org
- Melissa Grayson — mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org
- Isaac Sung — cisung@sunprairieschools.org
- Danny Miller — dmille@sunprairieschools.org

Sun Prairie West High School (SPWHS)

- Peggy Shoemaker — Principal — pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org
- Eric Nee — Athletics/Activities (student group registration) — eanee@sunprairieschools.org
- Gavin Christianson — Student Council adviser — glchris@sunprairieschools.org
- John Barth — Associate/Assistant Principal — jebarth@sunprairieschools.org
- Edward Ford — Assistant Principal — ebford@sunprairieschools.org
- Natalie Fowler — Dean of Students — nefowle@sunprairieschools.org
- Jamie Diaz — Dean of Students — jadiaz@sunprairieschools.org
- Keith Medema — Counselor — kamedem@sunprairieschools.org
- Chelsea Saldana — Counselor — cmalda@sunprairieschools.org
- Monica Wagner — Counselor — mmwagne@sunprairieschools.org
- Phau Thao — Counselor — pthao@sunprairieschools.org

- Vivi Velasquez — Restorative Practices Coach — vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org
- Lisa Mezei — AVID Site Coordinator — lamezei@sunprairieschools.org
- Laura Korppel — AVID — lskoepp@sunprairieschools.org
- Heidi O'Toole — AVID — haotool@sunprairieschools.org
- Jennifer Dorner — teacher — jmdorne@sunprairieschools.org
- Caryn Peters — teacher — capeter@sunprairieschools.org
- Former principal: Jen Ploeger

Sun Prairie East High School (SPEHS)

- Jim (James) Ertel — Principal — jaertel@sunprairieschools.org
- Sarah Dianich — skdiani@sunprairieschools.org (contacted Nov 3 about including East students)
- Allison Fuelling — Associate Principal (recommended May 2026; previously interim)
- Pang Khang — Assistant Principal — pkhang@sunprairieschools.org
- Rachel Looper — former Associate Principal (resigned April 2026) — ryloope@sunprairieschools.org
- Erin Goelden — AVID — (listed as eagood)
- Jennifer Josheff — AVID — jajoshe@sunprairieschools.org
- Scott Kloehn — AVID — srkloeh@sunprairieschools.org
- Kristin Trettin — AVID — kmtrett@sunprairieschools.org
- Sarah Albright — Counselor — (listed as sdalrbi)
- Steven Jordan — Counselor — sljorda@sunprairieschools.org
- Amy Rath Karsten — Counselor — amrathk@sunprairieschools.org
- Phau Thao — Counselor — pthao@sunprairieschools.org
- Dionte Prewitt — Dean of Students — ddprewi@sunprairieschools.org
- Jannyce Rodriguez-Duverge — Dean of Students — jirodri@sunprairieschools.org

Prairie Phoenix Academy (PPA)

- Nehemirah Barrett — Principal of Alternative Education Programs — ntbarre@sunprairieschools.org — Office (608) 834-6901
- Lisa Yang — Counselor — liyang@sunprairieschools.org
- Still needed: assistant principal, AVID, dean of students

Middle Schools

Prairie View Middle School (PVMS):

- Michelle Jensen — Principal — mmjense@sunprairieschools.org — Office (608) 834-7801
- Kolleen Gibbons — Assistant Principal — kmgibbo@sunprairieschools.org
- Craig Brandl — AVID Coordinator — cvbrand@sunprairieschools.org

Patrick Marsh Middle School (PMMS):

- Shawn Bartelt — Principal — sbbarte@sunprairieschools.org — Office (608) 834-7601
- Tiffany Kvalheim — School counselor, Peer Ambassadors — tekvalh@sunprairieschools.org
- Rebecca Zahn — Principal — rjzahn@sunprairieschools.org
- Kirsten Adneoni — Assistant Principal — ktandre@sunprairieschools.org
- Joanne Sather — AVID Coordinator — jksathe@sunprairieschools.org

Central Heights Middle School (CHMS):

- Sarah PrankeKlang — Principal (per the notes) — saprank@sunprairieschools.org
- Mark Roth — Assistant Principal — maroth@sunprairieschools.org
- Emeline Good — AVID Coordinator — eagood@sunprairieschools.org

Still needed for all three: counselors and deans of students.

Superintendent Finalists (April 2026)

- Dr. Antoine Reed (selected), Jeff Fleig, Michael Harris

Meeting Log

All 33 meetings in one table. Full details for each are in the cards that follow.

Date (2026)	Meeting	Where
January 26	SPASD Board of Education — Act 95 public hearing	SPASD Board meeting
February 26	Introductory Meeting — Weighted Grades	Google Meet
March 2	Student Advocacy Meeting (Student Support Check In)	Room 1418, Sun Prairie West High School
March 10	Student Voices (Board of Education)	Room 100, District Service Center, 501 S. Bird St.
March 12	ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Meeting	Google Meet
March 18	ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg	Google Meet
April 3 and April 7	SPWHS principal interviews	Sun Prairie West High School
April 13	ACT 95 Group – Superintendent Session (Day in the District)	Small Theater (organized by Jordain Blank)
April 27	Student Senate election	SPWHS (during SP30)
July 10	Chief Kevin Warych — Flock ALPR cameras	West Side Community Building, 2598 W Main Street (Sun Prairi
August 17	Chief Kevin Warych — public safety, staffing, accountability	Sun Prairie Police Department, 2598 W Main Street
August 18	Budget Conversation	In person
August 21	City Planning Discussion	Liv's Drink Emporium, 3140 Edmonton Dr #100
August 27	Student voice and district engagement	Dr. Turner's office, District Support Center, 501 S. Bird St

Date (2026)	Meeting	Where
September 23	Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #1	Google Meet
September 25	Conversation with Chief Warych about ALPR	Sun Prairie Police Department
October 1	Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2	Google Meet
Requested October 2	Mayor Stocker	City Hall or another location
October 7	Public Safety Committee	Council Chambers, City Hall, 300 E. Main Street (and Zoom)
October 15	Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #3	Google Meet
October 20	Weighted Grade – 26/27 meeting (invite titled "Meeting #2")	Google Meet
October 20	Student Voice & District Engagement	Conference Room 1202, Sun Prairie West High School, 2850 Iro
October 22	District "Student Voice Story" interview and headshot	Room 1007, front office, Sun Prairie West High School
October 27	Weighted grades work group	Google Meet
October 28	SPW Student Senate — weighted grades feedback	Sun Prairie West High School
November 2	Teaching & Learning Committee — weighted grades preview	District office, 501 S. Bird St.
November 4	Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed — District Student Advisory Council	Main office, Sun Prairie West High School
November 4	Student Q&A with Superintendent Dr. Reed	Sun Prairie West
November 9	Board Committee of the Whole — weighted grades (students present)	PLC, 220 Kroncke Drive (rehearsal in Room 200)

Date (2026)	Meeting	Where
November 10	Sun Prairie city budget work session (ALPR/Axon funding)	City of Sun Prairie
November 12	Patrick Marsh — District-Wide Student Council planning	Patrick Marsh Middle School front office (in person)
November 17	Weighted Grade Convo	Google Meet (West students join from Conference Room 1006)
November 17	City Council — final budget approval	City of Sun Prairie

Meeting details

SPASD Board of Education — Act 95 public hearing

Date Monday, January 26, 2026, 6:00 PM

Where SPASD Board meeting

With Board of Education; the student-led Act 95 group

Topic Students presented survey findings and a recommendation on Act 95 class ranking. The Board also heard from four superintendent search firms.

Introductory Meeting — Weighted Grades

Date Thursday, February 26, 2026, 10:08–10:40 AM

Where Google Meet

With Curtis Mould (organizer), the student work group, district and building staff

Topic Who should be at the table, how to collect feedback from students, staff and caregivers, and forming sub-teams. Goal: a policy to the Board by the end of May.

Student Advocacy Meeting (Student Support Check In)

Date	Monday, March 2, 2026, 1:00–1:30 PM (moved from Feb. 25)
Where	Room 1418, Sun Prairie West High School
With	Dr. Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Principal Peggy Shoemaker, Associate Principal John Barth, Vivi Velasquez, and one other student
Topic	Safety communication, accountability and consistency across schools, student voice in the principal and superintendent searches.
Outcome	Zackary added to the SPWHS principal interview list (April 3 or 7); Mr. Barth to follow up on Student Senate and including the Act 95 / weighted grading groups; Mr. Barth to gather mandated-reporting information for students.

Student Voices (Board of Education)

Date	Tuesday, March 10, 2026, 4:30 PM
Where	Room 100, District Service Center, 501 S. Bird St.
With	Board of Education members
Topic	Open invitation from Board President Diana McFarland.

ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Meeting

Date	Thursday, March 12, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM
Where	Google Meet
With	Curtis Mould and the work group
Topic	GPA calculation. Consensus to use a 5.0 scale instead of bonus points. Caregiver and staff survey drafts.

ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg

Date	Wednesday, March 18, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM
Where	Google Meet
With	Curtis Mould and the work group
Topic	Survey Team work (meeting called the same morning). The staff survey link went out March 20.

SPWHS principal interviews

Date	April 3 and April 7, 2026
Where	Sun Prairie West High School
With	Student interview team
Topic	Students interviewed principal candidates on safety, communication and student voice.

ACT 95 Group – Superintendent Session (Day in the District)

Date	Monday, April 13, 2026, 1:00–3:10 PM
Where	Small Theater (organized by Jordain Blank)
With	Finalists Jeff Fleig, Dr. Antoine Reed, Michael Harris
Topic	Zackary's ratings: Reed "pretty strong," Harris "unsure/mixed," Fleig "not a good fit." Dr. Reed was selected in May.

Student Senate election

Date	Monday, April 27, 2026
Where	SPWHS (during SP30)
Topic	Grade-level ballots; a second ballot was sent after four students were left off the first one. Results announced April 29.

Chief Kevin Warych — Flock ALPR cameras

Date	Friday, July 10, 2026, 12:00 PM
Where	West Side Community Building, 2598 W Main Street (Sun Prairie Police Department)
With	Chief Kevin Warych
Topic	How the 9 Flock cameras are used, access, audits, data sharing, retention, federal access, cost. Prep: the July 10 briefing memo, question sheet and Transparency Portal printout.
Outcome	About 40 minutes. Zackary posted a public recap the same day; handwritten notes are in Part 5.

Chief Kevin Warych — public safety, staffing, accountability

Date	Monday, August 17, 2026, 11:00 AM – 12:00 PM
Where	Sun Prairie Police Department, 2598 W Main Street
With	Chief Kevin Warych (booked by Michelle Garrison)
Topic	Staffing (61 of 63 sworn filled), call volume, accountability, community trust, mental health calls, the failed 2026 referendum, technology. Full notes in the Chief Warych Meeting Brief.

Budget Conversation

Date	Tuesday, August 18, 2026, 11:30 AM – 12:15 PM
Where	In person
With	Matt Clark, Director of Business & Finance
Topic	How the budget is built, the 5-year forecast, state aid and revenue limits, staffing costs, the 2024 referendum, fund balance (21%). Full notes in Part 4.

City Planning Discussion

Date	Friday, August 21, 2026, 8:30 AM (cancelled)
Where	Liv's Drink Emporium, 3140 Edmonton Dr #100
With	Joshua Clements, Planning Director
Topic	Downtown redevelopment, housing, growth. Zackary cancelled the night before; Josh offered Aug. 26, 27 or 28 instead.

Student voice and district engagement

Date	Thursday, August 27, 2026, 11:30 AM – 12:30 PM
Where	Dr. Turner's office, District Support Center, 501 S. Bird Street
With	Dr. Taren Turner (Assistant Superintendent of TLE) and Janet Thomas (Director of Student Services)
Topic	Student voice in decisions, leadership, communication, Student Senate follow-up, climate and trust. Agenda and discussion guide in Part 2.

Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #1

Date	Wednesday, September 23, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM
Where	Google Meet
With	Curtis Mould and the 2026–27 work group
Topic	Review of past work and timeline, finalizing the caregiver survey, building criteria for which classes get weighted.

Conversation with Chief Warych about ALPR

Date	Thursday, September 25, 2026
Where	Sun Prairie Police Department
With	Chief Kevin Warych
Topic	The switch from Flock to Axon, retention, audits, data sharing. The Chief handed over the Flock Utilization & Hits list (up to 9/21/26), the 13 national ALPR principles, and the 2023 Flock contract. Afterward he emailed Axon's ALPR brief.
Outcome	Handwritten notes are in Part 5.

Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2

Date	Thursday, October 1, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM
Where	Google Meet
With	Curtis Mould and the work group
Topic	Caregiver survey final version and send dates; forming a Criteria Team and a Roll-in Team.
Outcome	Survey finalized (checkbox questions, new question on applying weights to current vs. future students), Spanish translation, students to research weighting criteria in Wauwatosa, Elmbrook, Middleton, Verona and Oregon.

Mayor Stocker

Date	Requested October 2, 2026
Where	City Hall or another location
Topic	Transparency, public participation, public safety, growth, and how young residents interact with city government. Awaiting reply.

Public Safety Committee

Date	Wednesday, October 7, 2026, 7:00 PM
Where	Council Chambers, City Hall, 300 E. Main Street (and Zoom)
With	Committee members; Chief Kevin Warych
Topic	Chief's report on Axon Outpost as the new ALPR system. A report only, no vote. Axon estimate: $235,388.97 over 10 years for 9 cameras.

Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #3

Date	Thursday, October 15, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM
Where	Google Meet
With	Curtis Mould and the work group
Topic	Criteria Team work on which classes get weighted, using the district research.
Outcome	Draft recommendation of a 5.0 scale for capstone classes (including try-out music courses), AP courses, and classes that earn industry certification or college credit, except courses equivalent to high school credit or that don't transfer to UW schools.

Weighted Grade – 26/27 meeting (invite titled "Meeting #2")

Date	Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM
Where	Google Meet
With	Curtis Mould, Kristine Wendorf and the student work group
Topic	How to roll in weighted grades.
Outcome	Students agreed to start with next year's freshmen (Class of 2031) in 2027–28. Dr. Mould to draft a one-page communication package; Student Senate to hear it the following Wednesday. Notes in Part 2.

Student Voice & District Engagement

Date	Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 1:30–2:30 PM
Where	Conference Room 1202, Sun Prairie West High School, 2850 Ironwood Dr.
With	Marlita Bevenue (Strategic Communications Director) and Dr. Michael Morgan (Systemic Equity & Inclusion Director, organizer); scheduled through Carolyn Pao
Topic	Zackary's work and goals, the feedback survey, a district-wide Student Advisory Council, and how student voice can be supported across the district. Invite sent Oct. 15 after first being requested Sept. 8. Prep: pre-read and discussion guide, slides, pamphlet and handout (Part 2).
Outcome	Ms. Bevenue committed to sending district newsletters to all students starting in November. Agreed next step is a wider student survey on what good student voice looks like, then goals with benchmarks. Recap and draft Report #4 emailed the same afternoon; advisory council and equity questions left for a follow-up meeting.

District "Student Voice Story" interview and headshot

Date	Thursday, October 22, 2026, 1:00 PM
Where	Room 1007, front office, Sun Prairie West High School
With	Vientiane Yang, SPASD Multimedia & Website Specialist (introduced by Marlita Bevenue)
Topic	A short interview for the district about Zackary's student voice advocacy, what inspired it, and what he hopes to accomplish.

Weighted grades work group

Date	Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Where	Google Meet
With	Curtis Mould and the work group
Topic	Review the draft communication package; decide how to answer families of current high schoolers, using the caregiver survey findings.
Outcome	Not yet recorded in this archive.

SPW Student Senate — weighted grades feedback

Date	Wednesday, October 28, 2026
Where	Sun Prairie West High School
Topic	Work group students bring the one-page weighted grades summary to the Senate for feedback.
Outcome	Not yet recorded in this archive.

Teaching & Learning Committee — weighted grades preview

Date	Monday, November 2, 2026, 4:45–5:45 PM
Where	District office, 501 S. Bird St.
With	Board members Melissa Grayson and Amanda Davis; Dr. Mould; Dr. Taren Turner and Tara Vandehei (cc'd); the student work group
Topic	Weighted grades is on the posted agenda. Per Dr. Mould's Oct 29 email, an informal, conversational discussion around a table with Board members about the process and decisions, and answering their questions. No presentation needed; Dr. Mould will bring the one-pager. A Committee of the Whole meeting follows. Zackary can't attend because of a work conflict (told Dr. Mould Oct 29); four other students from the work group confirmed. On Oct 30 he sent the attending students a briefing on the caregiver survey and asked them to report back on Board questions and the final vote date.
Outcome	Four students from the work group attended with Dr. Mould; Zackary could not attend because of work. What the committee asked is not yet recorded in this archive.

Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed — District Student Advisory Council

Date	Wednesday, November 4, 2026, 7:50 AM
Where	Main office, Sun Prairie West High School
With	Dr. Antoine Reed; scheduled through Karen Richmond
Topic	The spring 2027 District Student Advisory Council pilot proposed on Oct 29: next steps, a staff liaison, and how it fits with the Student Senate and the Board's student representatives. Dr. Reed replied Oct 30, "I love this idea," and asked Zackary to run it by his principal first; Principal Shoemaker opted out, calling it a district-level group; Dr. Reed then asked to meet "even if it's before school starts." Prep packet in Part 2.
Outcome	Next steps as Zackary summarized them to Dr. Reed on Nov 6: email the administration at every middle and high school, develop a pilot program for a District Student Council, and create a schedule and calendar with talking points. By noon the same day the plan had become a District-Wide Student Council (3–5 students from every middle and high school, grades 6–12), and invitations went to every principal, copied to Dr. Reed. Patrick Marsh (Nov 5) and Prairie Phoenix (Nov 5) replied in support; Zackary then asked Dr. Reed how a district-level group should register and who should sponsor it.

Student Q&A with Superintendent Dr. Reed

Date	Wednesday, November 4, 2026
Where	Sun Prairie West
With	Dr. Antoine Reed, Dr. Taren Turner, and a group of West students
Topic	Recorded with an automatic transcript, which is too garbled to quote. Its summary lists: student mental health and a multi-tiered system of support, student voice in district decisions, phones in school, college applications, and incentives for attendance and achievement (open campus was raised).

Board Committee of the Whole — weighted grades (students present)

Date	Monday, November 9, 2026, 6:00 PM (student rehearsal 5:00–6:00 PM)
Where	PLC, 220 Kroncke Drive (rehearsal in Room 200)
Topic	Weighted grades framework presented to the Board; final approval expected at the end of November.
Outcome	Pending Zackary's notes.

Sun Prairie city budget work session (ALPR/Axon funding)

Date	Tuesday, November 10, 2026 (upcoming)
Where	City of Sun Prairie
Topic	Per Chief Warych (Oct 27), the Axon ALPR proposal is at committee and moving with the city budget. The Oct 27 work session was the first; Nov 3 was corrected to no meeting.

Patrick Marsh — District-Wide Student Council planning

Date	Thursday, November 12, 2026, 3:00 PM (upcoming)
Where	Patrick Marsh Middle School front office (in person)
With	Principal Shawn Bartelt; school counselor Tiffany Kvalheim
Topic	How 3–5 Peer Ambassadors could join the council pilot.

Weighted Grade Convo

Date	Tuesday, November 17, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (upcoming)
Where	Google Meet (West students join from Conference Room 1006)
With	Dr. Curtis Mould (organizer), Sarah PrankeKlang, Principal Peggy Shoemaker, Dr. Taren Turner, Principal Jim Ertel, and the student work group
Topic	Follow-up on weighted grades after the November 9 Board meeting.

City Council — final budget approval

Date	Tuesday, November 17, 2026 (upcoming)
Where	City of Sun Prairie
Topic	Final approval of the city budget, which includes the Axon ALPR proposal, per Chief Warych (Oct 27).

Follow-up: Student Voice & District Engagement

Date	Wednesday, November 18, 2026, 1:50–2:50 PM (upcoming)
Where	Google Meet
With	Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr. (organizer); Marlita Bevenue (optional)
Topic	Items from Oct 20 that ran out of time: the pilot student advisory council and a staff partner for it; sharing the student survey through district channels; a recurring student-district check-in; one "you said, we did" update this semester. Also: input on the survey questions and outreach plan, with a goal of launching in December.

2. Student Voice & District Engagement

Emails, packets, reports and notes from the work with the Board, the superintendent and school leaders, in date order.

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Overview: Student Voice & Safety Initiative

STUDENT VOICE & SAFETY INITIATIVE — Amplifying Student Voice Sun Prairie West High School • Sun Prairie Area School District. A Student Safety & Trust Framework • Student Senate • Act 95 & Weighted GPA • District Leadership Engagement • Civic Advocacy. Compiled by

Zackary Mark • AVID Scholar • 2025–26 School Year – Present.

Meet the Advocate

Zackary Mark — Student Advocate • AVID Scholar • Sun Prairie West High School "Asking 'Why?' can be the beginning of meaningful change."

- Focus: Public policy, education, government, and civic engagement
- On the ground: Active in SPASD Student Voices, Student Senate, and district safety/trust conversations since January 2026
- Beyond the district: Engages city leadership directly — including public-safety technology oversight with the Sun Prairie Police Department
- Looking ahead: Plans to pursue a double major in Social Studies Education and Political Science

The Journey: A Timeline of Student-Led Advocacy

From a January email to the Board to an ongoing seat at the table with district and city leadership.

- Jan 2026 — Framework Proposed: Proposes a Student Safety & Trust Framework directly to the Board of Education.
- Jan 26, 2026 — Act 95 Public Hearing: Student-led Act 95 group presents survey findings and a recommendation to the Board.
- Feb–Mar 2026 — Student Support Check-Ins: Recurring working sessions with SPWHS administration and district staff begin.
- Apr 2026 — Senate & Interviews: Runs for Student Senate; joins the SPWHS principal interview team.
- May 2026 — New Superintendent: Board selects Dr. Antoine Reed to lead SPASD starting July 1.
- Jul 2026 — Civic Engagement: Meets with Sun Prairie Police Chief Kevin Warych on ALPR camera policy and oversight.

Where It Started: The Student Safety & Trust Framework

Proposed to the Board of Education in January 2026, aligned with DPI guidance on safe, supportive learning environments.

1. Acknowledge & Communicate — Clear communication when serious incidents occur, even when details can't be shared.
2. Safety & Reporting Overview — A districtwide, accessible explanation of how concerns are reported, investigated, and resolved.
3. Consistent Protocols — The same conduct and safety standards applied across every SPASD building.
4. Strengthened Student Voice — Formal, ongoing advisory structures with required administrative response.
5. Proactive Wellness Supports — Advisory time, manageable counselor caseloads, and clear pathways to help.
6. Ongoing Review & Reflection — Regular climate surveys and transparent public reporting on progress.

Project Overview: What the Student Voice Project Does

- Represent — Give every student a seat in conversations that shape their education.
- Gather — Collect honest, districtwide feedback through a bilingual student survey.
- Advocate — Turn feedback into concrete asks, like a weighted GPA policy.
- Connect — Build direct lines between students and district and city leadership.

Student Leadership: Student Senate

Launched by SPWHS Principal Peggy Shoemaker for the 2026–27 school year, seeded directly by the Act 95 & Weighted GPA student groups. "I have been deeply impressed with your voice and agency on

Act 95 and weighted grading." — Principal Peggy Shoemaker

1. Two Paths to a Seat — Members join by student-body election (grade-level ballot) or by a fair drawing among Act 95 working-group volunteers.
2. Grade-Level Representation — Nine senators elected in spring 2026, three each from the incoming 10th, 11th, and 12th grade classes.
3. Direct Pipeline — Senate works with administration to set concrete goals and an action plan for 2026–27.
4. Growing the Model — After being passed over for the first Senate cohort, Zackary proposed expanding Student Council's role to include structured feedback — a reminder that advocacy adapts when one door doesn't open.

Data Collection: Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback

A bilingual (English/Español) survey, open to students, families, and staff, built around four focus areas identified in meetings with district leadership. Four focus areas:

- Development of a Student Senate / advisory structure
- Student involvement in leadership decisions (principal & superintendent searches)
- Communication & transparency around safety, policy, and student services
- Trust and consistency across schools

Sample questions:

- "Do you feel students currently have a meaningful voice in district decisions?"
- "How would you rate communication to students about important issues?" (1–5 scale)
- "Should students have a role in leadership decisions, such as principal or superintendent selection?"
- "What specific changes would you like to see moving forward?" (open response)

Policy Context: Why Act 95 Matters to Sun Prairie Students

The law: Wisconsin Act 95 created the Wisconsin Guarantee and Direct Admit Wisconsin, giving guaranteed admission to University of Wisconsin System schools for top-ranked students in every graduating class. "The sole criterion for ranking pupils shall be the pupil's grade point average." — Wisconsin Act 95

- Top 5% — Guaranteed admission to UW–Madison
- Top 10% — Guaranteed admission to all other UW System schools

The problem for Sun Prairie: Class rank runs on GPA alone, and SPASD currently ranks students on an unweighted scale. An unweighted "A" in a study hall counts the same as an "A" in AP Calculus or AP Chemistry. Students who challenge themselves in honors and AP courses can be pushed out of the top 5% and 10% by peers with lighter schedules. 31 SPWHS students, including Zackary, organized as the Act 95 group, gathered student voice, and presented a recommendation at the January 26, 2026 Board hearing.

Our Ask: A Weighted GPA System for SPASD

Give rigor its due weight, so students who take the hardest classes aren't penalized under Act 95 ranking.

- 4.0 — Standard scale today: an A is an A, regardless of course difficulty
- 29 — SPWHS students organized in the Weighted GPA working group, alongside the Act 95 group
- 5%/10% — The Act 95 rank thresholds that decide UW guarantee eligibility

What Student Senate is asking the Board to consider:

1. Add weighted points for Honors, AP, and dual-enrollment coursework on the SPASD transcript scale.
2. Model the change against three graduating classes to confirm it doesn't create new inequities.

3. Use the Student Advocacy survey to bring student and family sentiment directly into the board's discussion.

Building Relationships: Meeting with District & Building Leadership

1. New Superintendent — Dr. Antoine Reed: Building a working relationship with SPASD's incoming superintendent, who took office July 1, 2026.
2. Board Leadership — Diana McFarland, Board President: Ongoing correspondence since January 2026 on the Safety & Trust Framework and student representation.
3. District Administration — Dr. Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Director of Secondary Teaching, Learning & Equity: coordinates staff follow-through on student proposals.
4. Building Leadership — Peggy Shoemaker & John Barth, SPWHS Principal and Associate Principal: partners on Student Senate, the survey, and behavior-matrix feedback.

Civic Engagement: Beyond the District, Public Safety Oversight

On July 10, 2026, Zackary met with Sun Prairie Police Chief Kevin Warych to discuss the city's Flock ALPR camera program, applying the same transparency and accountability lens to city government.

1. Purpose & Use — What goals the cameras serve, and how many cases they've directly helped solve.
2. Data & Privacy — What's captured, how long it's retained, and who can access it.
3. Oversight — Audit practices, misuse safeguards, and accountability if policy is violated.
4. Community Trust — How resident feedback, including immigration-related concerns, shapes policy.

Approach: pro-public-safety, not anti-technology — seeking the same transparency for city surveillance tools as for school safety systems.

Moving Forward: Next Steps

1. Field the Student Advocacy & School Climate survey districtwide and report results to the Board
2. Establish a recurring check-in with Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed
3. Support Student Senate's first 2026–27 action plan, including the weighted GPA proposal
4. Formalize a Student Advisory Representative role bridging students and administration
5. Follow up on ALPR policy questions with the Sun Prairie Police Department

Emails with the Board, District and School (Jan.–May 2026)

This document compiles a series of emails, meeting notes, and advocacy materials from Sun Prairie West High School student Zackary Mark, documenting his ongoing efforts from early 2026 to strengthen student safety, trust, and voice across the Sun Prairie Area School District (SPASD). Through formal correspondence with the Board of Education, district leadership, school administrators, and staff, Zackary raises concerns about consistency, transparency, and accountability in response to serious incidents, while proposing a Student Safety and Trust Framework aligned with Wisconsin Department of Public Instruction (DPI) guidance.

The record traces how student concerns about school climate, communication after critical events, leadership decisions, and districtwide discipline practices led to concrete next steps, including Student Voices meetings, invitations to advisory roles, the development of a Student Senate, and expanded student participation in principal and superintendent hiring processes. The document also includes the agenda for a student advocacy meeting, a bilingual Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback form, and follow-up communication illustrating collaboration between students and district staff. Overall, it serves as both a case study and a working archive of student-led advocacy aimed at improving safety, transparency, and shared decision-making in SPASD.

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E-001 · Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Jan 13, 2026
Topics	Surveys · Board of Education · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-002, E-003, E-004, E-005, E-006, E-007, E-008, E-009

Dear Members of the Sun Prairie Area School District Board of Education,

I am writing as a follow-up to prior student concerns regarding school climate, safety, and transparency across the Sun Prairie Area School District. I appreciate the time and attention the Board has given to student and family feedback, and I am writing to further clarify the depth of concern being felt by students and to propose a constructive framework for moving forward.

As students, we recognize that schools operate within complex legal, personnel, and privacy constraints. At the same time, it is important to communicate that the cumulative effect of multiple incidents across the district—at the elementary, middle, and high school levels—has contributed to an atmosphere of uncertainty and concern among students. These concerns are shaped not only by specific publicly reported cases, but also by the perception that some issues are addressed quietly or without clear communication to the broader school community.

Many students have shared that when serious situations arise and little is acknowledged publicly beyond limited statements, it becomes difficult to understand how safety systems are functioning or how future harm is being prevented. This uncertainty affects students' sense of security and their ability to fully engage in learning.

The Wisconsin Department of Public Instruction emphasizes safe, supportive, and inclusive learning environments, as well as continuous

improvement through reflection, transparency, and stakeholder engagement. From a student perspective, safety includes not only physical protection, but also trust in reporting systems, confidence in adult accountability, and clarity about how concerns are handled across the district.

In the spirit of constructive problem-solving, I respectfully offer the following Student Safety and Trust Framework for the Board's consideration. This framework is intended to align with DPI guidance while responding to student experiences.

First, clear acknowledgment and communication when serious incidents occur. Even when details cannot be shared, district communication that acknowledges impact, explains general processes, and reaffirms safeguards would help reduce speculation and anxiety among students and families.

Second, a districtwide safety and reporting overview. Students and families would benefit from a clear, accessible explanation of how concerns are reported, investigated, and resolved, including the roles of school administration, district leadership, and external authorities, when applicable. Transparency about process builds trust without violating privacy.

Third, consistent implementation of safety and conduct protocols across all schools. Students notice differences in how similar situations are handled between buildings. A clearly defined, districtwide framework aligned with restorative practices and DPI expectations would promote fairness and accountability.

Fourth, strengthened student voice related to school climate and safety. Establishing formal, ongoing student advisory structures at the middle and high school levels, with required administrative responses, would ensure that student concerns are heard and addressed in a meaningful way.

Fifth, proactive mental health and wellness supports. DPI's whole-child approach emphasizes prevention and early intervention. Regular advisory time, manageable counselor caseloads, and clear pathways for accessing support would help students feel supported before concerns escalate.

Finally, ongoing review and reflection. Regular climate surveys, transparent summary reporting, and public discussion of improvement efforts would demonstrate a commitment to continuous improvement and

responsiveness to student and family feedback.

I share these thoughts not to assign blame, but to advocate for systems that help students feel safe, supported, and confident in the adults and structures meant to protect them. SPASD has the opportunity to strengthen trust by addressing not only individual incidents, but also the broader systems that shape student experiences across the district.

Thank you for your continued service and for your willingness to consider student perspectives as part of SPASD’s ongoing improvement efforts.

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-002 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Date	Jan 13, 2026
Topics	Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-001, E-003, E-004, E-005, E-006, E-007, E-008, E-009

Zackary,

Thank you for such a thoughtful email. Diana will respond on behalf of the board, but as a community member I want to sincerely thank you for sharing your perspectives, concerns and such great ideas for a framework. I admire how you offered solutions while advocating for yourself and other students. Keep up the great work!

Melissa

E-003 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Jan 15, 2026

Topics Board of Education · Safety & mental health

Thread Same conversation: E-001, E-002, E-004, E-005, E-006, E-007, E-008, E-009

01/15/2026

Dear Zackary,

Thank you for reaching out to the board and being engaged. I appreciate your efforts to improve our school district by communicating with me and other board members about school safety and transparency. Your continued advocacy is exactly what our community needs!

According to school board policy, the board president will provide you with an official response soon if she hasn't already. But I wanted to respond to let you know that I had received and read your email.

Thank you for your understanding. Isaac Sung

E-004 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account), Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Jan 20, 2026

Topics Board of Education · Safety & mental health

Thread Same conversation: E-001, E-002, E-003, E-005, E-006, E-007, E-008, E-009

Dear Zachary, Thank you for taking the time to write such a careful and respectful message. First, I want to apologize for the delay in this response. I personally am responsible for speaking on behalf of all seven Board members, and I usually try to do so as quickly as possible. In this case, I did not want to reply until the full Board could come together to discuss a response to your email, and it took longer than I had initially hoped. I also want to acknowledge the thoughtfulness, maturity, and care for your fellow students that are evident throughout your email. It is clear that your intent is not to assign blame, but to contribute constructively to our collaborative efforts to improve our school community for all our students. The concerns you describe are ones the Board hears and takes seriously. You are absolutely right that schools operate within legal, personnel, and privacy constraints, and you are equally right that those constraints can unintentionally contribute to uncertainty when communication feels limited. When the Board crafts a public statement, it must keep in mind the wide breadth of potential readers, and that can make it feel a bit impersonal to the students and educators most closely impacted by the topic at hand. This is part of why we also assign a Board member as a liaison to each school, so we can ensure the Board does not feel too removed from the schools we serve. I am the Board's elected liaison to PPA, and we are also actively recruiting to fill our open Student Board Representative seat for PPA. I visited PPA twice last week, and I plan to visit regularly throughout the rest of the school year as well. I promise

you, the Board is paying close attention to the experiences of students and educators in your school community.

There will always be room for us to improve, and in that light I want to directly address some of the issues you are raising:

- This Board agrees with the importance of transparency, and that is why we opted to publicly share the recent report we received from the Board's selected independent investigator with our community. We also established a website (https://www.sunprairieschools.org/district/news/arrest-of-former-spwhs-employee) to provide additional information, and we will continue to update the FAQ portion of that website as needed to address additional questions we receive.
- The Board has recently updated our Concert & Complaint (https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/DFRMCQ5A9EB0/$file/Board%20Procedure%2013%2C%20Formal%20Appeal%20Process.pdf) process, and with the help of our Community Voices we are continuing to work on improvements to that process. This is just one example of many plans we have for continuous improvement based on community feedback. This year was also our first year holding Student Voices meetings for an hour prior to the full Community Voices meetings, and we hope to see more students participate in these meetings in the future as we are able to spread the word about that opportunity to interact with the Board.
- Student safety is incredibly important to us all, and you did a great job acknowledging that this goes far beyond physical safety. You deserve to have teachers and school systems you can trust, understand, and have confidence in over time. The Secondary Behavior Response matrix is in all of our high school handbooks (https://www.sunprairieschools.org/east-high/sun-prairie-high-school-academics/student-handbook) under Appendix A. You can view it directly HERE (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1iEbCDY6BcJn6Hlp5a0Rz62xh8OJCBFdy/view). A group is working to create an elementary behavior matrix as well. We very much appreciate hearing the perspective of students regarding the effectiveness of implementation moving forward.
- Student-Centered Decision Making and Respect are two of our Core Values (https://www.sunprairieschools.org/district/mission-values), and those values inform the Board's policies such as OE10 - Learning Environment (https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/CQSRU

M6C41A4/$file/OE-10%20
Learning%20Environment%20(Revised%204-10-23).pdf). This is where the Board names the expectations we have for the District and monitors the District's adherence to those expectations annually in our public Board meetings. Students are welcome to attend and speak at those meetings, as well as email Board members with their concerns at any time.

Thank you again for engaging respectfully and courageously in this work. Student voices like yours are essential to continuous improvement, and your willingness to speak thoughtfully on behalf of your peers does not go unnoticed. I encourage you to continue sharing your perspective and to remain engaged in the conversations ahead. This spring we will be hiring a new Superintendent to lead our District moving forward, and the person we choose to hire will have a deep impact on many of the policy and process issues you indicated interest in. We hope you will engage in our transparent community engagement opportunities as we work to select the best candidate on behalf of our community. On behalf of the Board, thank you for your advocacy and for your commitment to helping make SPASD a place where all students feel safe, supported, and heard.
Sincerely,

Diana

E-005 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Jan 22, 2026
Topics	Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-001, E-002, E-003, E-004, E-006, E-007, E-008, E-009

Dear President McFarland and Members of the Board,

Thank you for your thoughtful response and for sharing my email with the full Board. I appreciate your attention to student concerns and your explanation of steps being taken to improve transparency, safety, and student voice.

I am encouraged by the following updates:

- The decision to publicly sharI am glad to hear about these updates:’s report and maintain an updated FAQ for the comYou have updated the Concern & Complaint process and are continuing to work with Community Voices. Voices.
- The addition of Student Voices meetings and your hope to increase student participation.
- The focus on student safety is more than just physical security, including trust in systems and accountability.
- The Secondary Behavior Response Matrix and the work underway to create an elementary version.

I would like to stay actively involved as a student partner in this work. In particular, I am interested in:

- Student Voice Structures – Learning more about how students can participate in the Student Voices meetings and how feedback from those meetings will be communicated back to students.

- Implementation of the Behavior Matrix – Providing student feedback on how consistently the Secondary Behavior Response Matrix is being applied in classrooms and across buildings, and how that impacts our sense of fairness and safety.
- Climate and Communication – Exploring ways to ensure that when serious incidents occur, students receive timely, age-appropriate information that both respects privacy and helps us understand how systems are responding.

As you move forward with the superintendent search, I would also welcome any opportunities for students to give input on the qualities and priorities we would like to see in the district's next leader—especially around safety, transparency, and trust.

If it would be helpful, I would be glad to:

- Attend a Student Voices or Community Voices meeting to share student perspectives in person.
- Participate in a small student advisory conversation about school climate and safety.
- Help share information with other students about how to engage with the Board and district processes.

I offer this draft and my ongoing engagement in the spirit of partnership and with deep respect for the Board's role and constraints. I also recognize that any future policy or resolution language may need to be refined by the Board or administration to align with existing policy and legal guidance.

If the Board or administration determines that additional student input or assistance would be helpful during the implementation of safety, transparency, or governance initiatives, I am more than willing to support this work in an appropriate capacity.

Additionally, for the upcoming school year, should there be a vote or selection process for student representatives to the Board or related advisory roles, I would respectfully express my interest in serving and contributing a student perspective to district governance.

Thank you again for your responsiveness, your time, your service to our community, and your openness to student voice. I remain committed to working together so that all students in SPASD feel safe, supported, and heard.

Sincerely,

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-006 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account), Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Jan 24, 2026
Topics	Weighted grades · Board of Education · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-001, E-002, E-003, E-004, E-005, E-007, E-008, E-009

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for the thoughtful response. I'm glad you hear you want to be actively involved! Please feel free to come to our next Student Voices meeting at 4:30pm March 10th in room 100 of the District Service Center building at 501 S. Bird St. Spread the word and bring your friends? Would you feel comfortable giving feedback on the implementation of the behavior matrix and climate to one of our district administrators? If so, I'd be happy to make a connection for you. The Board can always listen to that feedback, but day-to-day implementation is really in the hands of our educators and I want your feedback to reach the people who are most closely connected to the work so it can have the most impact possible.

Monday night, January 26, the Board will meet beginning at 6pm. The first item on the agenda is a public hearing on Act 95, primarily led by a group of students who helped gather student voice and opinion before developing a recommendation to the Board. Then we will also view presentations by four Superintendent Search firms. If you would like to attend and provide public feedback in person, or watch the video of the meeting at home and then email us your thoughts here, we would love to

hear more from you! Once the Board selects a search firm we will start to get community feedback on more of the things you named above such as the qualities and priorities we would like to see in our district's next leader. So if you'd like to wait to attend meetings until we get to that point I completely understand. These meetings can often take quite a bit of time, and you do not need to attend them all to have your voice heard.

If you do enjoy the topics of Board meetings and have the time and interest in being a Student Representative to the Board, we currently have an open seat for a PPA Representative. You can read a bit about how that position works here (https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/DBVRP26D6486/$file/Board%20Procedure %203%2C%20Student%20Representatives%20to%20the%20School%20Board%20(12-9-24).p df). I have been working with Principal Barrett and a couple other teachers to try to recruit an interested student, so if that is something you would like to learn more about why don't we set up a time to chat in person and I can answer any questions you might have? I know they have been asking around to see who might be interested, so I would need to check back in with them to see if any other students also want to be considered for that role before making any commitments.

I hope you have a wonderful weekend,

Diana

E-007 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Jan 30, 2026

Topics Student council · Board of Education · Safety & mental health

Thread Same conversation: E-001, E-002, E-003, E-004, E-005, E-006, E-008, E-009

Dear Members of the Sun Prairie Area School District Board of Education,

Thank you again for your responses and for the chances you've given students to share our perspectives, including through Student Voices and feedback on the behavior matrix and school climate. I appreciate that my previous emails have been taken seriously and shared with the full Board.

I'm writing to follow up with more specific and district-wide concerns in light of:

The firing and criminal charges involving former Sun Prairie West High School Principal, Ms. Jen Ploeger; The decision to keep Mr. Barrett in his leadership role at Prairie Phoenix Academy (PPA); and Ongoing incidents and patterns affecting students at Sun Prairie East High School, Sun Prairie West High School, Prairie Phoenix Academy, and at the middle and elementary school levels.

Together, these situations raise important questions about consistency, safety, transparency, and accountability across the entire district.

1\. Firing and Criminal Charges Involving Former SPWHS Principal, Ms. Ploeger

From a student point of view, learning that Ms. Ploeger was fired and is now facing criminal charges has been shocking and confusing. Students at West, East, and PPA have mostly heard about this through rumors and media, not through clear, student-focused communication.

I want to be clear that I personally understand how and why she was criminally charged in connection with child neglect. I recognize the seriousness of those allegations and why they rise to the level of a criminal case.

However, many students do not understand this. They have not been given any kind of accessible explanation (within legal limits) about what “child neglect” means in this context, what kinds of failures or actions can lead to that charge, and how the district responds when there are serious concerns about student safety.

There is also a broader concern: students are aware of other situations where staff or teachers have allegedly failed to act to protect students or have been involved in what feels like serious neglect of student needs or safety. In those cases:

We have not seen the same level of public acknowledgement; There has often been very little communication with students or families; and There have not been visible consequences or criminal charges.

This creates a perception that some incidents of child neglect or serious harm are treated as criminal and fully addressed, while others seem to be minimized, kept quiet, or handled privately without clear accountability. Even if there are legal reasons for different outcomes, the lack of communication makes it hard for students to understand the difference or trust that all cases are being taken seriously.

I understand that you cannot share every detail of a legal case or a personnel matter. But right now, most students don’t understand what happened, what “child neglect” really means in this situation, or how the district is making sure that similar failures do not happen again in any building.

2\. Retention of Mr. Barrett at Prairie Phoenix Academy

At the same time, students have raised multiple concerns about the leadership and climate at Prairie Phoenix Academy under Mr. Barrett. These concerns include:

Students feeling dismissed or not believed when they report safety issues, bullying, or staff behavior; A sense that staff and administrators are not always held to the same standards and consequences as students; and A feeling that some of the same patterns of ignoring or minimizing student

concerns that show up at West and East are also happening at

PPA.

While serious action has been taken in response to issues involving Ms. Ploeger, Mr. Barrett remains in his leadership role and is involved in recruiting a Student Representative to the Board. To many students, this feels inconsistent and confusing:

Why is one principal removed and facing criminal charges, while another administrator with ongoing student complaints remains in place without visible accountability or change? What clear process or criteria does the district use to decide when an administrator is removed, reassigned, or kept in their position?

Again, my goal is not to attack any individual personally. I am questioning the systems, standards, and decision-making processes that apply to people in powerful positions in our schools.

3\. Issues at East, West, PPA, Middle Schools, and Elementary Schools

These concerns are not limited to one school. Across the district, students, families, and staff have reported:

At East, West, and PPA: inconsistent discipline, rules being enforced differently depending on the student, and students feeling unsafe or ignored when they report bullying, harassment, or staff behavior. At middle schools: bullying, discriminatory language, and safety issues where students feel that consequences are inconsistent or that follow-up doesn’t always happen, especially for repeated behavior. At elementary schools: worries from younger students and families about behavior and safety, and about how early harmful patterns are addressed—or not addressed—which shapes whether kids feel safe speaking up as they get older.

This is also personal to me. I have a sibling currently in middle school who has experienced some of these same problems: feeling like concerns aren’t always taken seriously, that bullying or harmful behavior is handled unevenly, and that it’s not always clear which adults they can trust to act. I also know students in other middle and elementary schools who have had similar experiences.

I don’t want my sibling and their classmates to come into high school already feeling like the system won’t protect them or listen to them. My hope is that these issues will be addressed before they get to high

school—and ideally much sooner—so that:

Students entering high school next year, and Current high school students at East, West, and PPA

can have more trust that the district will act fairly and protect their safety.

4\. How This Affects Trust and Willingness to Speak Up

When students across the district see:

A principal fired and charged with child neglect, but with almost no student-facing explanation; Other situations that feel like neglect or serious failures to protect students that are not talked about or addressed publicly; and Another administrator kept in place despite ongoing concerns;

it sends some harmful messages:

That only some serious problems get fully addressed and others may be handled quietly or not at all; That adults in similar positions may not be held to the same standards; and That student concerns may not actually lead to investigation or change.

This makes it harder for students to trust the system or to feel safe coming forward. Students—especially younger students, marginalized students, and those in alternative settings like PPA—need to see that:

Their experiences matter and will be taken seriously; There are clear, consistent processes for handling concerns about staff and administrators; and The district will communicate openly, within legal limits, about how these issues are being addressed.

5\. What I’m Asking the Board and District to Do

Because of all of this, I’m respectfully asking the Board and district leadership to consider these specific steps:

Clear, Student-Focused Communication Share written communication with students and families at East, West, PPA, and at middle and elementary schools that:

Explains, in clear and simple language, as much as can be legally and ethically shared about the situation involving Ms. Ploeger and the

meaning of the child neglect charge; Clarifies what the district can and cannot say about personnel and legal matters, so people understand the limits; and Describes what has been learned and what changes are being

made across the district as a result.

Transparent Standards for Administrators and Staff At a policy level (without naming individuals), explain how the district:

Receives and investigates complaints about principals, administrators, and other staff when student safety or possible neglect is involved; Decides when an administrator or staff member is removed, reassigned, disciplined, or reported to outside authorities; and Makes sure those standards are applied consistently at East, West, PPA, and at middle and elementary schools.

Review of Leadership and Climate at PPA and Other Sites Conduct a real, focused review of climate, leadership, and safety at PPA and other schools where concerns have been raised, that:

Actively and confidentially collects feedback from students about their experiences with administration and staff; Looks specifically at whether student safety concerns and possible neglect are being handled consistently and taken seriously; and Includes a clear timeline and next steps, with a general summary back to students and families about what will change.

More and Better Spaces for Student Voice In addition to Student Voices, create or expand:

School-based forums at East, West, and PPA where students can talk directly about safety, discipline, leadership, and trust; Age-appropriate ways for middle and elementary students and families to share concerns and get responses; and Clear, well-communicated options (including anonymous ones when needed) to report concerns about staff or administrators.

Include Students With Direct Experience In any committees, working groups, or feedback processes on leadership, climate, safety, or the behavior matrix, make sure to include:

Students from East, West, and PPA; and Student perspectives that reflect middle school experiences and from

students who have gone through alternative schooling, discipline processes, or safety-related incidents.

I am very willing to be involved in this work and to collaborate with students from East, West, PPA, and other schools. I would also be willing to

meet directly with the Board—either in person or virtually—if that would help move these conversations and solutions forward.

6\. My Commitment to Ongoing Follow-Up and Board Participation

I want to be clear that I will keep following up on these issues and on your responses until I see real, concrete steps being taken and clearly communicated across the district. This is not a one-time email for me—it’s something I plan to stay engaged in.

I will be attending Board meetings, both virtually and in person when I can, to stay informed and to make sure that action is being taken on all of these concerns, not just the ones that have already been publicly addressed. I plan to keep asking questions and raising student experiences from East, West, PPA, and from the middle and elementary levels until students can clearly see that their safety, voices, and rights are being prioritized.

I know these are difficult and sensitive issues, and I appreciate that you are willing to hear from students even when what we say is uncomfortable. My goal is not to undermine the district, but to help it live up to its values and become a model for real student-centered transparency and accountability.

Thank you for your time, for your service to our community, and for your attention to these concerns. I look forward to your response and to any chances to work together on these issues.

E-008 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account), Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>, Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Feb 3, 2026

Topics Safety & mental health

Thread Same conversation: E-001, E-002, E-003, E-004, E-005, E-006, E-007, E-009

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for your continued advocacy and for taking the time to share such a comprehensive and thoughtful set of concerns with the Board. Your willingness to engage deeply with these issues reflects a strong commitment to your peers and to the district as a whole.

I want to acknowledge the role the Board plays in this work, and also connect you with additional staff within our system that are best positioned to help with the concerns you have raised. As a Board, we care deeply about trust, consistency, safety, and communication. We are actively working to improve Board level communication in ways that build trust with students, families, and the broader community.

The Board's primary responsibilities are governance, policy, and oversight. You have outlined several specific concerns and action steps related to school climate, leadership practices, follow-up on reports, and student-facing processes. District administration and school-based leadership are best positioned to engage in the kind of detailed, action-oriented conversations you are seeking. I have shared your message with our Superintendent and Director of Student Services. I also want to introduce you to Dr. Sarah Chaja-Clardy, our Director of Secondary Teaching, Learning, and Equity. She has offered to help connect you with other leaders within our system to ensure your ideas and concerns are

heard by those who can take next steps at the school and district level.

Please know that the Board values hearing directly from students, and your feedback helps inform our ongoing oversight and discussions with district leadership. I appreciate your engagement and your desire to work collaboratively to improve the experience and safety of students across the district.

Thank you again for reaching out and for your continued involvement.

Sincerely,

Diana

E-009 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Zackary Mark (school account), Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>, Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 4, 2026
Topics	Weighted grades · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-001, E-002, E-003, E-004, E-005, E-006, E-007, E-008

Hi Zackary, (and thanks for making this connection, Diana :)),

Thank you again for your thoughtful message and for the leadership you continue to show in speaking up about issues that matter to students. Your ongoing involvement, such as your recent engagement in Act 95 efforts, demonstrates a strong commitment to improving school climate and student experience for you and your peers. That kind of advocacy makes a real difference.

As a next step, I will be sending a separate email that includes you and several key school staff members who are best positioned to dig into the specific concerns and ideas you raised. My goal is to create a direct space

for dialogue, collaboration, and clarity around possible next steps. We can also explore setting up a meeting if that would be helpful, so everyone can talk together and ensure your voice is fully heard.

Thank you for the care, courage, and persistence you bring to this work. I look forward to continuing the conversation and supporting meaningful follow-through.

Warmly, Dr. Chaja-Clardy

E-010 · Next Steps and Support

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>, Keith Medema <kamedem@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 4, 2026
Topics	Board of Education

Hi Zackary,

As promised, I am including members of the SPWHS team who are best able to support you and to talk through the ideas and concerns you shared in your recent email to the Board of Education.

Joining this conversation are your principal, Ms. Shoemaker; Mr. Barth, your Associate Principal; Mr. Medema, your School Counselor; Ms. Vivi, our school's Restorative Practices Coach; and Ms. Mezei, our school's AVID Site Coordinator. Mr. Barth and Mr. Medema both support students whose last names begin with "M." Ms. Vivi supports student leadership and helps create a positive school community through restorative practices. Ms. Mezei leads our AVID program and works closely with students to support their voice, leadership skills, and sense of belonging. Each of them brings experience and care that can help turn your advocacy into meaningful action.

My hope is that this group can be a space for open conversation, shared understanding, and next steps. I would be happy to help organize a meeting so we can all connect, hear your perspective more clearly, and talk together about possible next steps. If the team prefers to organize the

meeting and keep me looped in with updates/next steps, that works as well. Ms. Shoemaker, please just let me know.

Thank you again, Zackary, for the leadership and determination you continue to show in working to improve school climate. I appreciate everyone's willingness to take part in this important conversation, and I look forward to working together.

Warmly,

Dr. Chaja-Clardy

E-011 · Student Support Check In @ Wed Fed 25, 2026 1pm-1:30pm (CST)

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org> Reply-To: Jordain Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>

To Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>. Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Feb 5, 2026

Student Support Check In When: Wed Feb 25, 2026 1pm - 1:30pm (CST) Where: Room 1418 Who: Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Vivi Velasquez, John Barth, Peggy Shoemaker

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E-012 · Updated invitation: Student Support Check In @ Mon Mar 2, 2026 1pm - 1:30pm (CST)

From Jordain Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org> Reply-To: Jordain Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>

To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>. Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Feb 19, 2026

Student Support Check In When: Monday Mar 2, 2026 · 1pm – 1:30pm (CST) Where: Room 1418 Who: Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Vivi Velasquez, John Barth, Peggy Shoemaker

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E-013 · Re: Student Support Check In (March 2 meeting)

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Jordan Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>, another student
Cc	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>, Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>, John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 23, 2026
Thread	Same conversation: E-014, E-015

Hi all,

I would also like to invite another student to this event, as he will be working alongside me on this project. He will help address student concerns and will contribute his own perspective to the issues we will be discussing.

Thank you all once again for your ongoing support and partnership as we continue working to make the Sun Prairie Area School District a better place.

Best, Zackary Mark

E-014 · Re: Student Support Check In (March 2 meeting)

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Jordan Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>, another student Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>, John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 23, 2026
Thread	Same conversation: E-013, E-015

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for your continued leadership and for thinking thoughtfully about your advocacy and engagement.

At this stage, we want to be mindful not to get ahead of ourselves. Our first step is to meet with you to fully understand your concerns and goals, and then determine together what next steps, and who else, might be helpful

to include.

I appreciate your partnership and look forward to our conversation.

Best, Sarah

E-015 · Re: Student Support Check In (March 2 meeting)

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
Cc	Jordan Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>, another student Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>, John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 23, 2026
Topics	Weighted grades · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-013, E-014

Thank you for your note and for clarifying logistics. I wanted to confirm that I will only be inviting another student to the March 2 Student Support Check-In. My reasoning is that he has demonstrated prior follow-through, particularly with the Act 95 waiver process, and I trust him to engage responsibly and constructively in this project.

The goal of having him join is to ensure a broader range of student perspectives while keeping the conversation focused and productive. I appreciate your support and guidance as we work to strengthen student safety, communication, and voice across the district.

Thank you, Zackary Mark

E-016 · Background for Meeting on 02/25/2026

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>. John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 8, 2026
Topics	Safety & mental health

Hi Team,

I’m sending along some background info ahead of our meeting on Wednesday, February 25th, from 1:00–1:30 PM in Room 1418, so everyone has a clear understanding of what we’ll be discussing.

The packet includes:

Pages 1–25: Emails and context from previous discussions, giving background on student concerns, district processes, and prior conversations with the Board and administrators.

Pages 26–28: The questions and goals I’d like us to work through together during the meeting. These focus on student safety, districtwide consistency, leadership transitions, communication, and ways to strengthen student voice.

I’m hoping this gives everyone a clear picture before we meet so we can have a focused, student-led discussion and leave with actionable next steps.

I’m looking forward to hearing your thoughts and collaborating on solutions that make a real difference for students across the district.

(Attachment: background packet — link removed)

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

E-017 · Email with Board of Education

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Feb 5, 2026
Topics Board of Education
Thread Same conversation: E-018, E-019, E-020, E-021

Hi Ms. Vivi,

I wanted to follow up on our recent conversation and share the email chain below in case you would like more context or additional information about the concerns and ideas I raised.

If you have any questions or would like me to clarify anything further, I would be happy to do so. Thank you again.

(Attachment: background packet — link removed)

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-018 · Re: Email with Board of Education

From Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Feb 9, 2026
Topics Board of Education
Thread Same conversation: E-017, E-019, E-020, E-021

Thank you Zack!!! For the Feb 25th meeting, do you want me to be there? Do you feel the appropriate people are there?

I appreciate you reaching out and sending me the email chain, and for meeting with me to discuss your concerns. -- Vivi Velasquez

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E-019 · Email with Board of Education

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Feb 9, 2026
Topics Student council · Board of Education
Thread Same conversation: E-017, E-018, E-020, E-021

Hi Ms. Vivi,

Yes, I would really appreciate it if you could be at the Feb 25th meeting. I feel better having you there and think your perspective would be really helpful.

I'm glad SPWHS admin and a district-level person are involved, but since my concerns are district-wide, I think it would also be helpful to include additional district administration and administration from SP East, so the conversation reflects more than just one school.

Thank you again for your support.

E-020 · Email with Board of Education

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Feb 9, 2026
Topics Board of Education
Thread Same conversation: E-017, E-018, E-019, E-021

Hi Ms. Vivi,

I went ahead and shared a Google Doc with you that includes the email chain, my notes, and some additional context that might be helpful for the February 25th meeting. There's no need to respond to the document. I just wanted you to have everything in one place.

Thank you again for all your support.

SPASD Engagement Notes (https://docs.google.com/document/d/1UEgGUYcWyuxK8kuvOsrlG-2Vyy1abP3JOgLdbDYMGp U/edit?usp=sharing)

SPASD Engagement Emails & Meeting Notes (https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tYbQZwF46d7Dkd8DfiIYwIWMrpUPAynvJlEsvl3j1BQ/edi

t?usp=sharing)

E-021 · Re: Email with Board of Education

From Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Feb 9, 2026
Topics Board of Education
Thread Same conversation: E-017, E-018, E-019, E-020

Got it! Received :)

E-022 · Follow up from today's meeting

From Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Mar 2, 2026
Topics Weighted grades
Thread Same conversation: E-023, E-024

Hi Zack,

Thank you for a productive meeting today. It was a pleasure to meet you. As discussed, here are the next steps we'll be moving forward with:

1\. You expressed interest in serving on the SPWHS principal interview team. The

interview date options are April 3 and April 7, and I've added your name to the list of interested students for either date. 2. Mr. Barth will follow up with Ms. Shoemaker regarding Student Senate and the

possibility of including Act 59/Weighted Grading groups as potential representatives. 3. Mr. Barth will connect with the student services team to gather and share information

for students related to mandated reporting, including when state agencies are involved and when parents are notified in certain situations.

I've set a reminder for myself to follow up on these items in two weeks. I know you'll be out of the country at that time, but I'll circle back to keep

you in the loop.

Thanks again for your leadership and engagement!

Best, Sarah

E-023 · Re: Follow up from today’s meeting

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Mar 16, 2026
Thread	Same conversation: E-022, E-024

Hi everyone,

I hope you’re all doing well. I wanted to check in to see if there have been any updates on the items we discussed at our last meeting.

In particular, I’m wondering if there has been any follow-up regarding the Student Senate development, as well as the information being gathered for students related to mandated reporting.

No rush if things are still in progress; I just wanted to touch base and keep the communication moving.

Thanks again for the time and thought everyone has been putting into this work.

Kind regards, and happy snow day, Sarah

E-024 · Re: Follow up from today’s meeting

From	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
Cc	Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Mar 16, 2026
Thread	Same conversation: E-022, E-023

Hello, I am working out the details for the Student Senate. Thanks!

Peg

E-025 · Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	District administration
Cc	Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>, Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Apr 15, 2026
Topics	Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-026, E-027, E-028, E-029

Dear district administration,

I am writing to request clarification regarding concerns that arose in 2024 involving former Cardinal Heights and Sun Prairie West High School staff member, Jill Hansen.

In reviewing publicly available information, I was unable to find clear documentation regarding whether an investigation took place or the circumstances surrounding Ms. Hansen’s departure. Based on available information, she continues to hold a valid teaching license and is currently employed in another school district.

I am not making accusations, but I am seeking clarity. Specifically, I would like to better understand:

- What processes the district follows when allegations of this nature arise
- Whether those processes were followed in this situation in 2024 (to the extent that can be shared)
- How the district ensures continuity and accountability in handling serious concerns, particularly during leadership transitions

I appreciate that there may be limitations on what can be shared regarding personnel matters. However, transparency around process and student safety is important for maintaining trust.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

E-026 · Re: Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Christopher Sadler <cjsadle@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Apr 15, 2026
Topics	Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-025, E-027, E-028, E-029

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for reaching out and for sharing your questions. I appreciate your continued interest in understanding our district's processes and commitment to student safety.

Because your inquiry relates to personnel matters and occurred before Mrs. Shoemaker was with us, I am including our Human Resources Director, Dr. Sadler, in this message so he can respond and address your

questions to the extent possible.

Kind regards,

Sarah

E-027 · Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>, Christopher Sadler <cjsadle@sunprairieschools.org>
Cc	Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Apr 27, 2026
Thread	Same conversation: E-025, E-026, E-028, E-029

Dear Dr. Sadler,

I hope you are doing well. I wanted to follow up on my previous email regarding my inquiry into the district’s processes for handling allegations of this nature. I understand these matters can take time, but I wanted to check in to see if there are any updates or if additional time is needed.

I appreciate your attention to this and look forward to your response.

E-028 · Re: Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 28, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-025, E-026, E-027, E-029

Hi Zackary,

I just wanted to reach out once again to thank you for your engagement and to apologize for the delay in receiving a response. Unfortunately, I do not personally have any additional information to offer you, as that will need to come from the administration. However, I want to let you know that I am also keeping an eye on this thread and will be interested to learn more with you when the reply from administration comes through.

All the best, Diana

E-029 · Re: Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From Nicholas Reichhoff <nfreich@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>, Stephanie Leonard-Witte <smleona@sunprairieschools.org>, Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>, Christopher Sadler <cjsadle@sunprairieschools.org>
Date May 5, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-025, E-026, E-027, E-028

Hello Zachary -

Thank you for your patience about your inquiry. It took a bit to get this routed to me, and then it took a bit more time to be able to compose a response. I believe I am best positioned to answer your questions.

As you may have seen from media coverage of this incident, the allegations you referenced arose in 2024 and triggered an investigation that included a Title IX review. Without discussing specific situations about other students with you, I can assure you that a significant number of

student interviews were completed, and the families of any students who were identified as potential victims were involved. In addition, school administrators contacted the Sun Prairie Police Department. Based on that information, it was determined that district policies were violated, which resulted in disciplinary action of the staff member. The PD, the Department of Public Instruction, and the school districts involved are all aware of the incident. Decisions related to an individual's teaching license or employment in another district are out of our hands.

Moving forward, the district is committed to following our established protocols to investigate allegations in partnership with the Sun Prairie Police Department. We continue to engage in regular training of leaders so they understand their responsibilities to look into concerns and follow the established procedures to do so thoroughly.

I hope you have a great end to the school year!

Sincerely, Nick

E-030 · Associate Principal Update

From Sun Prairie East High School <DoNotReply@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Apr 28, 2026

Dear Sun Prairie East Cardinals,

I wanted to take a moment to update everyone on our associate principal staffing. As of Monday, Ms. Looper has resigned her position with the Sun Prairie Area School District for personal reasons. I would like to thank Ms. Looper for her leadership these past two years, and I wish her the best in her future endeavors.

For the remainder of the school year, Allison Fuelling will continue to serve as interim associate principal and cover Ms. Looper's former duties and responsibilities. I plan to post the AP position as soon as possible and aim to fill it this spring. I will be working with school district leadership as well as our in-building leadership teams to organize and plan interviews.

Please reach out to me directly if you have any questions.

Thank you.

Jim Ertel

Principal, Sun Prairie East High School

E-031 · Associate Principal Recommendation

From Sun Prairie East High School <DoNotReply@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date May 21, 2026

Dear Sun Prairie East High School Students, Parents, Caregivers, and Staff,

We are writing to share some exciting news regarding our school's leadership. We are pleased to announce that Allison Fuelling has been recommended as the next associate principal of Sun Prairie East High School! This recommendation will be forwarded to the School Board for consideration on May 26, 2026.

Most recently, Allison has been serving as the Interim Associate Principal at Sun Prairie East. She holds a Bachelor’s degree in Biology and Psychology from Cornell College, Secondary Science Teaching Certification from UW-Madison, and two Master’s degrees: one in Molecular and Cellular Pharmacology from UW-Madison and one in Educational Leadership from Viterbo University. You can view her resume here (https://drive.google.com/file/d/11C8r8o5bZaCcUbmrbTEUkUBZOOA2HS6a/view?usp=sharing) for more information on her professional background.

Allison comes to us with experience in education as an Instructional Coach at Sun Prairie East High School and a Middle School Summer School Principal. Before her service to Sun Prairie, she was a Science Teacher, K-12 Science Specialist, and 7-12 Instructional Coach at Marshall School District. In 2017, she was named Wisconsin Outstanding Biology Teacher of the Year by the National Association of Biology Teachers. Allison also currently serves on the Marshall School Board.

Outside of school, Allison enjoys spending time with her family, gardening, and spending time with friends. Thank you to the students, parents, caregivers, and staff members who participated so thoughtfully in this interview process. Please join us in welcoming Associate Principal Allison Fuelling to our school community! Allison will continue in her current role as interim Associate Principal and will officially begin full-time when her contract takes effect on July 1, 2026.

Sincerely,

Jim Ertel, Principal

E-032 · Request to Continue Student Leadership Work

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Apr 29, 2026

Thread Same conversation: E-033, E-034

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

I hope you're doing well.

I wanted to thank you for the opportunity to be part of the Student Senate process. I appreciate the time and effort that went into organizing it, and I'm glad to see strong student interest in leadership at SPWHS.

While I was not selected, I remain committed to strengthening student voice and continuing the work I've already been involved in with both school and district leadership. Over the past several months, I've focused on improving communication, building trust between students and staff, and helping elevate student perspectives.

I would like to formally request a defined role working alongside administration, such as a Student Advisory Representative or student liaison position. My goal is to continue contributing in a structured and consistent way, particularly in areas related to student voice, communication systems, and school climate.

I believe creating or expanding a role like this would not only allow me to stay actively involved, but also help strengthen the connection between students and administration moving forward.

I would appreciate the opportunity to discuss how I can continue contributing in this capacity.

Thank you again for your time and leadership.

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

E-033 · Re: Request to Continue Student Leadership Work

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 29, 2026
Topics Student council
Thread Same conversation: E-032, E-034

Hello Zach, I will have to think about this. To be honest, what you are asking for is unrealistic. Student Senate will provide me with the student lens to issues we have in our school addressing student voice, communication systems and school climate. Perhaps you may have more voice in another committee in the school or Student Council? I would also encourage you to run again next year.

Warm regards,

Ms. Shoemaker

E-034 · Re: Request to Continue Student Leadership Work

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Apr 29, 2026
Topics Student council
Thread Same conversation: E-032, E-033

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for your response — I appreciate your perspective.

I understand the role Student Senate plays in representing student voice, and I am open to getting involved in Student Council or another committee as you suggested. While I know Student Council often focuses on school events, I would be interested in helping expand its impact by incorporating more structured student feedback and communication with administration.

My goal is to contribute in a way that supports both student engagement and meaningful input on school climate, communication, and student experience.

I would appreciate the opportunity to be involved and continue supporting this work in whatever way is most helpful.

Thank you again for your time.

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-035 · Student Senate

From Sun Prairie West High School <DoNotReply@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Apr 13, 2026

Thread Same conversation: E-036, E-037, E-038

Dear Students!

Here is more information about Student Senate!!

- Be a Voice for Your Peers: Actively listen to the ideas, concerns, and needs of the student body and represent those perspectives during Senate meetings.
- Identify Areas of Concern: Openly and constructively discuss challenges facing our school environment, academics, or student life.
- Build Community: Collaborate on new ideas, events, and initiatives that promote inclusivity, school spirit, and a positive campus culture.
- Develop an Action Plan: Work alongside Ms. Shoemaker to establish concrete goals and a strategic action plan for the upcoming 2026-2027 school year.

Student Senate will be made up of three 9th, 10th and 11th graders as well as members of some of our clubs. We will meet weekly next year to discuss problems in our school and how to solve them. If you are interested in being part of this team, please fill out this form

Forms are due Wednesday, April 22. Elections will be held Monday, April 27, 2026. Sign up here: Student Senate Interest Form (https://docs.google.com/forms/d/10GjHclvvHKhtrAI9jvS6DkP9d0jaRp_IzdMhqOvKm00/edit).

Ms. Shoemaker

Principal

Student Senate Interest Form Please fill out the form below by Wednesday, April 22. Elections are Monday, April 27

Name (Short Response)

What is your grade level next year

- I will be in 10th Grade
- I will be in 11th Graade
- I will be in 12th Grade

Why are you interested in representing your grade level as a Student Senator? (Short Response)

Your name will be on the voting ballot. Is there anything else you want students to know about you? (Short Response)

E-036 · STUDENT SENATE

From	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Date	Apr 18, 2026
Topics	Weighted grades
Thread	Same conversation: E-035, E-037, E-038

Hi Zach,

Thank you for your interest. There are two ways for your to apply to Senate:

1\. I will draw a name from those interested and who are a part of the ACT 95 student group.

2\. You may choose to be included on the grade level ballot for the student body voting at the end of April - first week of May.

Zach, you can certainly choose one or both options. If you are wanting to be a part of the student body voting process, please fill out the interest form asap!

Thanks. Ms. Shoemaker

E-037 · Re: STUDENT SENATE

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Apr 18, 2026
Topics Weighted grades
Thread Same conversation: E-035, E-036, E-038

Hi Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for the clarification.

I've already submitted the interest form to be included on the student body ballot, and I would also like to be considered through the ACT 95 group selection.

I appreciate the opportunity and look forward to being involved in either process.

Thank you, Zackary

E-038 · Re: STUDENT SENATE

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 18, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-035, E-036, E-037

Sounds good. Thanks.

E-039 · Student Senate Invite

From Jordan Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account) and other students from the Act 95 / weighted grading groups
Date Apr 16, 2026
Topics Weighted grades

Dear students,

I have been deeply impressed with your voice and agency leveraged on the ACT 95 and

weighted grading potential policies. I am inviting one of your members to be a part of the

Student Senate. Please reach out to me at pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org if you are

interested. In order to be fair, I will draw a name from those interested in serving next year.

With appreciation,

Ms Shoemaker

E-040 · Student Senate Application

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>

To (undisclosed recipients)

Bcc Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Apr 20, 2026

Hello, Your application has been received! Thank you so much for your interest in Student Senate and in making our school a better place. I want to inform you of next steps:

1\. The vote will be next Monday, April 27 during SP30. 2. On the ballot, your name and why you want to be a part of the Senate will be included. 3. Some of you have asked about posters. You may hang posters anywhere in the Commons with blue tape. The school will not be able to provide you with copies. 4. If for some reason you have decided to not be a part of the election, please let me know soon so I can take your name off of the ballot.

Thank you so much! Have a great day! Ms. Shoemaker

E-041 · Student Senate 1 ([grade level] Ballot)

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 27, 2026

Dear [grade level] students!

Please find the candidates for the [grade level] Student Senate. I urge you to read through the candidates first before casting your vote. YOU MAY ONLY VOTE FOR ONE and ONLY ONE TIME. I am collecting email addresses so I will know if you voted more than one time. The polls will close at 4:00 pm today.

Who best represents your goals for our school? Vote here: [grade level] (https://forms.gle/hWVyCKshvHfg8Noq8)

Thank you!

Ms. Shoemaker

E-042 · Student Senate - New Ballot

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 27, 2026

Dear [grade level] students,

Here is the new NEW Student Senate Ballot - [grade level] (https://forms.gle/4w2uHKYF7uZwGtbs8) containing all of the students who wish to be on the ballot and were left off the first time. There was a technical error on my end and it is remedied now.

Reminder: Vote 1 time

Polls close at 4:00 pm on Tuesday

Thank you.

Ms. Shoemaker

E-043 · New Student Senate Ballot

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To (undisclosed recipients)
Bcc Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 27, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-044, E-045

Hello, I wanted to let you know that 4 current students in that grade were left off the ballot due to technical difficulties. I have now included them in the new ballot which will be sent to students today. I wanted to let you know in advance.

Thank you! Ms. Shoemaker

E-044 · Re: New Student Senate Ballot

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Apr 27, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-043, E-045

Hi Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for the update and for sending out the new ballot.

Do you know when the results of the election will be available, or when they'll be shared with students?

Thank you,

Zackary Mark

E-045 · Re: New Student Senate Ballot

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 27, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-043, E-044

Hi Zackary, Thanks for reaching out. I extended the deadline for [grade level] students we I can announce on Wednesday morning. Thank you!

E-046 · Student Senate Update

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Grade-level student mailing list
Date Apr 29, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-047, E-048

Dear [grade level] students,

Three students were elected to Student Senate, serving next year as Seniors.

-
-
-

All students who were running received votes from classmates. Thank you to everyone who was interested in serving. I was very much impressed with your passion for leadership and serving Sun Prairie West.

Ms. Shoemaker

E-047 · Student Senate Update

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Grade-level student mailing list
Date Apr 29, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-046, E-048

Dear Tenth Graders,

Three students were elected to Student Senate, serving next year as 11th graders.

-
-
-

All students who were running received votes from classmates. Thank you to everyone who was interested in serving. I was very much impressed with your passion for leadership and serving Sun Prairie West. Each spring we will conduct another election!

Ms. Shoemaker

E-048 · Student Senate Update

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Grade-level student mailing list
Date Apr 29, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-046, E-047

Dear Ninth Graders,

Three students were elected to Student Senate, serving next year as 10th graders.

-
-
-

All students who were running received votes from classmates. Thank you to everyone who was interested in serving. I was very much impressed with your passion for leadership and serving Sun Prairie West. Each spring we will conduct another election!

Ms. Shoemaker

March 2, 2026 Student Advocacy Meeting — Agenda, Notes & Next Steps

Sun Prairie Area School District Student Advocacy Meeting – Agenda & Questions

Date: March 2, 2026 Time: 1:00–1:30 PM Location: Room 1418

Purpose: To discuss districtwide student safety, trust, and school climate, and explore actionable next steps with administration. This conversation will include perspectives from students across all SPASD schools and connect to ongoing leadership searches (Superintendent and SPWHS Principal) and community engagement efforts.

Agenda & Key Questions

1\. Safety Communication (0–8 min)

- How is student communication decided after serious incidents?
- Is there a consistent district process or timeline for communicating with students?

2\. Accountability & Consistency (8–15 min)

- How are complaints about staff or administrators reviewed?
- How does the district ensure consistent follow-through across schools?

3\. Leadership Transitions & Community Engagement (15–20 min)

- With the superintendent and SPWHS principal searches underway, how are student perspectives being incorporated?
- How can community engagement strengthen trust during these leadership transitions?

4\. Student Voice & Feedback (20–25 min)

- How will feedback from this conversation lead to concrete action?
- What ongoing structure ensures continued collaboration with students across all schools?

5\. Concrete Next Steps & Follow-Up (25–28 min)

- Which of the proposed initiatives feels most realistic to begin, and what would the timeline look like?
  - (Examples: districtwide student climate listening sessions, student-facing safety communication protocols, ongoing student advisory group, input opportunities for students in leadership searches)

6\. Closing & Confirm Follow-Up (28–30 min)

- Confirm agreed-upon next steps
- Identify responsible parties and timelines
- Confirm how students will be updated on progress

Notes:

This meeting is intended to be solution-focused and collaborative. The goal is to leave with one or two clear action items and a plan for follow-up

Look at the Student Code of Conduct Board of Education - Coach Rob Incident Students are emailed, as well as parents K-8 is not emailed District leadership goes through with complaints What actually happens then to laws/policies Training after incidents Consequences vary with incidents An attorney is always hired Surveys sent out Interview questions were taken with them Student voice with direct spw principal Superintendent firm HYA 3/9 Board of Education meeting Trust? Student services clarity Newsletter issues SP100 - June/November/March - Key district personnel - used to be student senate involved Goals every 100 days Spw principal - Search end April - Start date July 1st Superintendent - Search end April - Start date July 1st Interim principal/superintendent next year?

Next Steps:

You expressed interest in serving on the SPWHS principal interview team. Sarah Chaja-Clardy The interview date options are April 3 and April 7, and I've added your name to the list of interested students for either date.

will follow up with regarding Student Senate and the possibility John Barth Peggy Shoemaker of including Act 95/Weighted Grading groups as potential representatives.

will connect with the student services team to gather and share information for John Barth students related to mandated reporting, including when state agencies are involved and when parents are notified in certain situations.

March 2 Meeting Script — Student Partnership & Engagement (word-for-word)

Student Partnership & Engagement Meeting Script – Word-for-Word Purpose: Shift from concern-sharing to system-building. Goal: define scope + secure one structural next step.

0:00–2:00 — Opening & Scope Clarification

“Thank you for meeting today. I appreciate the time and willingness to sit down with students directly.

I want to clarify the purpose of this conversation from the beginning. While student concerns are part of this discussion, my broader goal is long-term structure.

I’m hoping we can focus not only on what students are experiencing, but on how student voice is built into systems moving forward.

This is about sustainability, not a one-time conversation. ”

2:00–7:00 — Framing the Core Themes

“I’ve organized what students are experiencing into three structural categories.

First: Communication Infrastructure.

- Students often receive limited clarity after major events.
- The issue isn’t just information — it’s predictability and process.

Second: Consistency Across Schools.

- Students notice differences in enforcement, follow-up, and tone depending on the building.
- That creates perception gaps in fairness and trust.

Third: Ongoing Student Integration.

- There are opportunities for input, but they aren’t always structured or visible.
- Students want clarity on how feedback moves from conversation to action.

These themes are less about isolated complaints and more about how systems are designed. ”

7:00–17:00 — Strategic Questions (Slow Pace, Take Notes)

A. On Scope

- “How does the district currently define ‘student voice’ in decision-making?”
- “Is there a written or consistent structure that ensures student perspectives influence outcomes?”

B. On Communication Systems

- “What determines the timing and depth of student-facing communication after serious incidents?”
- “Is there an opportunity to create a predictable communication framework students can rely on?”

C. On Leadership & Trust

- “In leadership transitions, what formal role do students play beyond feedback surveys?”
- “What would it take to institutionalize student partnership during these processes?”

Maintain steady posture. No rapid-fire questions. Let silence work for you.

17:00–25:00 — Propose Structural Direction

“I’d like to move toward one concrete structural next step.

Rather than a one-time listening session, I’m proposing one of the following:

- A formal districtwide student advisory framework with a defined meeting cadence.
- A transparent student-facing communication protocol draft.
- A clear integration plan for student input during leadership transitions.

Which of these is most realistic to pilot in the near term?

And what would the timeline look like?”

Let them talk. Write everything down.

25:00–29:00 — Lock Structure

“To ensure this conversation translates into action, I’d like to clarify four things before we close.

- What is the agreed next step?
- Who is responsible for moving it forward?
- What is the timeline?
- How will students receive updates?

Could we summarize those together?”

29:00–30:00 — Close with Stability

“Thank you for engaging in this conversation. Students are committed to partnership and long-term trust-building. We look forward to continuing this work in a structured and collaborative way.”

More Emails: Superintendent Session & Student Update (March–April 2026)

E-049 · Invitation: ACT 95 Group – Superintendent Session @ Mon Apr 13, 2026 13:00–15:10 (CDT)

From Jordain Blank (organizer), Sun Prairie Area School District

To Zackary Mark (school account) and the high school students in the Act 95 group

Date Mar 30, 2026

Topics Weighted grades

This is for high school students to participate in the Day in the District on Monday, April 13. This will be your opportunity to meet the superintendent finalists, learn more about each of them, ask questions and offer feedback. The sessions start at 1 p.m. and end around 3:10 p.m.

When: Monday, April 13, 2026, 1:00–3:10 PM (Central) Location: Small Theater

E-050 · Student Advocacy Update

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To another SPWHS student

Date Apr 3, 2026

Topics Weighted grades · Surveys · Board of Education

Thread Same conversation: E-051

Hey [name withheld],

Thanks again for being willing to help out. I really appreciate it.

I wanted to follow up and provide you with a brief update on our current progress. I'll keep it brief here, but I'm happy to share more details if you'd like.

Here are a few key things that are happening right now:

Student Senate: Ms. Peggy Shoemaker and Mr. John Barth are working on establishing the Student Senate so we can have a more consistent space for student voice and feedback.

Community survey: I'm putting together a survey to share with the public. The goal is both to help people better understand what I'm working toward and to give me a clearer picture of what students, families, and community members are most concerned about.

Public report: I recently shared a public report-out, and I'm planning to keep doing that every month. That way, people can see what's been worked on, what's changed, and how my goals are evolving based on what we're hearing.

Leadership and principal support: With Ms. Peggy Shoemaker staying on as Interim SPWHS Principal next year, we'll have more consistent principal support behind this work going into next school year.

District and board leadership: With the upcoming SPWHS ACT 95 Group Superintendent Session to meet candidates for SPASD Superintendent, and the upcoming SPASD Board of Education elections, I'll also be paying close attention to which candidates in both races seem most focused on supporting and positively impacting students.

Staying updated: For anyone who wants to follow this work more closely, updates and public reports will also be shared on social media, through the various Sun Prairie community groups on Facebook and on Instagram at @spasdstudentvoice.

If you have any thoughts, questions, or ideas about any of this, especially around how to make Student Senate or the survey more meaningful for students, I'd really like to hear them.

Thanks again for all your support. I'll keep you updated as things move forward.

Zackary Mark AVID Scholar, Sun Prairie West High School +1 (608) 940-7356 | school account

E-051 · Re: Student Advocacy Update

From another SPWHS student
To Zackary Mark
Date Apr 4, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-050

Lemme know if you need any help with any of this, or just someone to plug for support. Appreciate all the work you're doing my man!

E-052 · Re: Student Senate Timeline and Next Steps

From Associate Principal John Barth
To Zackary Mark
Date Mar 17, 2026, 8:26 AM

Hey, Zackary,

Thank you for your patience. It's been a crazy couple of weeks with ACT testing and scheduling for next year. I know Ms. Schoemaker is working on the details of the Student Senate. I would look for more details after Spring Break. Thanks!

-Mr. Barth

> Zackary's question (Mar 4): "I wanted to check in about the timeline for when Student Senate can be expected to be up and running. Do you have a rough idea of when things might get started? I'm also wondering if there is anything I can help with or work on now to make sure it can get started as soon as possible."

March 2 Meeting Handout

Meeting 1 Print Out — STUDENT SAFETY & TRUST | MARCH 2 MEETING
Prepared by: Zackary Mark, Sun Prairie West HS

Purpose

- Share student concerns and themes
- Guide a solution-focused, collaborative discussion
- Outline next steps and follow-up plan

Meeting Flow

1. Opening (0–2 min) — Appreciation, collaborative framing, focus areas: safety, communication, accountability, student voice
2. Student Concern Themes (2–8 min) — Safety gaps, inconsistent accountability, limited student voice
3. Clarifying Dialogue (8–18 min) — Questions on communication, accountability, leadership engagement, student input
4. Next Step Decision (18–26 min) — Options: student listening session, climate survey, advisory structure, leadership input; define responsible lead & timeline
5. Confirm Follow-Through (26–29 min) — Confirm action, lead, timeline, communication method
6. Closing (29–30 min) — Appreciation, reaffirm goal of safe, student-centered schools

Student Feedback Highlights

- Mixed feelings of safety vs. trust
- Desire for clearer communication
- Concern about fairness/consistency

Example quote: "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen… people be pulling up with knives."

Work Done

Outreach & feedback; draft survey & reports; communication with leadership & Board; teacher/admin engagement.

Current Focus

Consolidate feedback; clarify themes; collaborate on one concrete next step.

Request

Agree on one actionable step; assign lead; set timeline; communicate with students.

Goal: Move from concern → collaboration → action → ongoing partnership. Principle: Students are seeking safety, clarity, fairness, voice, trust — not blame.

Meeting 2 Print Out: (page left blank in the original)

Superintendent Candidates (April 13)

4/13 Superintendent Candidate Meeting — Zack's evaluation notes and question list.

Candidate: Jeff Fleig

1. Learning & Academics — Key ideas: asking students first; staff first; communication on curriculum; academic gaps; shifts every couple of years; 4-year planning as a freshman; changes in administration; temporary staff. Good for student learning? Strong.
2. Student Voice & Involvement — Would they actually listen? Probably.
3. Safety, Mental Health, and Culture — Support for students is mandatory; professionals; keeping kids safe mentally/psychologically in previous city.
4. Opportunities & Fairness — Fair to students across schools? Somewhat.

5. Additional — "Turn around leader." 5 of 14 schools exceeded expectations at the start; ended with 13 of 14 schools exceeding. 31 years in education. Safety; great education; trust and relationships; elementary school expectations.
6. First-year promise heard: Build systems that are going to outlast them.

Overall rating: Not a good fit — too numbers focused; didn't answer questions directly; less informed about the district; team administration; left on bad terms.

Candidate: Antoine Reed

1. Learning & Academics — Good for student learning? Strong.
2. Student Voice & Involvement — No specific groups came to events, losing trust; representation; going to where people are; open hours; student leadership/influencers; communication through a multitude of channels. Would they actually listen? Probably.
3. Safety, Mental Health, and Culture — Teacher help.
4. Opportunities & Fairness — Fair to students across schools? Yes.
5. Additional — Staff support: time, tools, training; keeping key staff.

Overall rating: Pretty strong — energetic; excited to be here; actually wants it; eager to help staff and students mentally.

Candidate: Michael Harris

1. Learning & Academics — Agendas; resources needed; priorities key; community holding administration accountable; same types of education to thrive. Good for student learning? Okay.
2. Student Voice & Involvement — Key on student voices; Student Council of the Superintendent (Milwaukee); visiting schools is key. Would they actually listen? Probably.
3. Safety, Mental Health, and Culture — Student voice for improvement.
4. Opportunities & Fairness — Communication; audit of schools for gaps. Fair across schools? Somewhat.

5. Additional — Listen, learn, improvement. Described as fair, resourceful, and straightforward.
6. First-year promise heard: Quick wins; momentum; no long-term goal.

Overall rating: Unsure/mixed — looking at data most of all; superintendent license in May.

Student Questions for Candidates

A. Students & Learning

1. Improving day-to-day learning: "What are the most important changes you think our schools need to make to improve students' day-to-day learning?"
2. Support for different learners: "How will you support students with different needs and strengths — like advanced learners, students who need extra help, English learners, and students with IEPs?"
3. Preparing us for the future: "How will you make sure students are ready for life after graduation, college, trades, careers, or whatever path we choose?"

B. Student Voice & Involvement

4. Listening to students: "How will you regularly listen to students and make sure our ideas and concerns are part of important decisions?"
5. Hearing from many types of students: "How will you make sure you're hearing from students at different schools, grade levels, and backgrounds, not just the same small group?"

C. Safety, Well-Being, and School Culture

6. Mental health and well-being: "What will you do to improve student mental health support and reduce stress, anxiety, and burnout?"
7. Belonging and respect: "How will you help create school environments where students of all backgrounds feel safe, respected, and like they belong?"
8. Handling problems and discipline: "How do you think schools should handle behavior problems or conflicts so that students are held

accountable but also able to learn and grow from mistakes?"

D. Activities, Opportunities, and Equity

9. Clubs, activities, and opportunities: "How will you support more opportunities for students, like clubs, arts, sports, and career/tech programs, especially for students who can't always participate now?"
10. Fairness between schools: "If some schools in the district have more opportunities or better resources than others, how will you address that?"

E. Leadership Style & First-Year Actions

11. How you lead: "How would you describe your leadership style when working with students, staff, and families?"
12. First-year promise: "What is one specific thing you promise to do in your first year that students will actually notice and feel?"

Notes, Outreach & Meeting Scripts

Teacher Responses

On 02/10/2026 Zackary sent the same outreach email to Lisa Mezei, Jennifer Dorner, Natalie Fowler, and Caryn Peters:

> Dear [teacher], I hope you are doing well. I am currently working on a student-led project in collaboration with district and school leadership focused on strengthening student safety, improving communication, and ensuring that student voice is meaningfully included in school decision-making.
>
> As part of this effort, I am gathering brief perspectives from both students and staff to better understand what is working well and where improvements may be needed. Your insight would be greatly appreciated. If you are willing, I would value your thoughts on a few short questions:
>
> - From your perspective, do most students feel safe at school?
>
> - If a serious concern occurred, do students generally feel comfortable reporting it to an adult?
>
> - Do you feel that student concerns are consistently heard and followed up on?
>
> - What is one change that could most improve student safety, trust, or communication in our schools?
>
> Responses can be as brief as you prefer, and participation is completely optional. My goal is simply to ensure this work reflects a range of real experiences and perspectives across our school community. Thank you for your time, your leadership, and your continued support of students.
>
> — Zackary Mark, AVID Scholar, Sun Prairie West High School, (608) 940 7356, school account

Responses recorded: Mezei — none recorded. Dorner — none recorded. Fowler — none recorded.

Response from Ms. Peters

Do most students feel safe at school? In my opinion as a teacher, I feel about 60-70% of students feel safe. Safety to me could mean a few different things to different students. 1. Do they feel they are in a safe space overall to learn? Are they protected from the outside world? Active threats like people coming into the school to hurt them or others? 2. Do they feel they are in a safe space to learn within their classes? Are they comfortable with their peers enough to be vulnerable to learn? Are there people either harassing them or bullying them? Or are people just being jerks and unkind (which is still not ok, but not the level of bullying)? 3. Do students feel they have adults they can connect with if they feel threatened for either reason 1 or 2? 4. Are the adults in the building able to actually help the student? How do we make sure we don't have adults in the building who have questionable boundaries, or worse, manipulate students for their own gain? Or, even passively just ignore students' concerns?

If a serious concern occurred, do students generally feel comfortable reporting it to an adult? I think some students do. Usually, those students have been raised in safe spaces with adults who protect them and care for their needs, which makes them feel safe. However, we have students who are going to question everything a person does, even an adult, because of their past experiences. We can't change that, so how do we make students know that we aren't going to be a threat to them like perhaps adults in their past have been? Additionally, with everything that has happened in our school over the last few years, I feel students have every right to be wary of trusting adults, especially the adults who allow students to cross unhealthy boundaries (for instance, teachers that give students their personal cell number).

Are student concerns consistently heard and followed up on? No. I think some students' concerns are heard, but that typically comes from certain groups of students that administration pays more attention to for one reason or another. One example would be students whose caregivers are VERY VOCAL when something doesn't

go their way and they threaten to make something public in the media because of it.

One change that could most improve student safety, trust, or communication: New superintendent; new district leadership; new principal. More training for staff on how to help students address their problems. More accountability on staff to have healthy boundaries with students, while still maintaining healthy working relationships with them. More accountability on students for their behavior so that all students feel safe and can learn their best while in school.

Student Responses (word for word)

Question sent: "Hey! Quick question for a student project I'm working on with the district about safety and student voice. Do you mind answering a few super short questions? Do you feel safe at school most of the time? If something serious happened, would you feel comfortable telling an adult? Do you feel like adults actually listen when students report problems? What's one thing you would change to make school feel safer or better? Totally optional, just trying to make sure real voices are heard. Thanks :)"

Response 1: "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen. Something I would do is make them get cops to pat people down before they enter cuz people be pulling up with knives."

Response 2: "Yes I do feel safe at school most of the time. I would not feel uncomfortable telling an adult. Yes I do like it when adults actually listen to the problems students report. I would add reminders for students that this is a safe space just so they do not forget and always know where to look for if they need a safe space."

Outreach to a fellow student (02/11/2026)

Zackary asked a fellow student from the Act 95 group to answer the same questions, share them with other students, and possibly attend a few meetings.

That student's reply (02/16/2026): "Most of the time yeah [I feel safe]. Depends on the adult and what happened... Yes [adults listen], because they are legally obligated to. Might not be because they think it is right or they care." His one change: actually monitor the bathrooms, where students gather to vape.

Meeting 1 Script — Student Advocacy Meeting (30 minutes, word-for-word with pauses)

Purpose: Student safety, trust, communication, and influence in district leadership decisions (superintendent & SPWHS principal searches). Goal: one concrete next step + follow-up plan.

0:00–2:00 — Opening & Purpose. "Thank you all for taking the time to meet today. [pause] I really appreciate your willingness to engage with students directly about districtwide concerns. [pause] The goal of this conversation is partnership and improvement in student safety, communication, and leadership processes. [pause] This isn't about pointing fingers at anyone — it's about understanding the system and making it better for everyone. [pause] Specifically, I want to talk about: how students experience safety and trust in schools; how student voice is heard and followed up on; and how leadership transitions, like the superintendent and SPWHS principal searches, can strengthen student trust and community engagement."

2:00–8:00 — Student Concerns Overview. "I've organized districtwide student concerns into three main themes:

1. Safety & Communication — Students often rely on rumors or social media after incidents. Limited student-facing explanation after serious events. Students aren't always sure how safety systems prevent future harm.
2. Consistency & Accountability Across Schools — Discipline and follow-up can feel inconsistent. Reports of bullying or harassment are not always clearly addressed. Students notice adults aren't always held to the same standards.

3. Student Voice & Follow-Through — Some positive steps exist, like feedback opportunities, but many students aren't aware. Limited structured voice for younger students. Students sometimes feel heard symbolically rather than systemically.

These themes are being experienced across multiple schools, not just SPWHS."

8:00–18:00 — Clarifying Questions & Dialogue.

- A. Safety Communication: "How is student communication decided after serious incidents?" "Is there a consistent district process or timeline?"
- B. Accountability & Consistency: "How are complaints about staff or administrators reviewed?" "How does the district ensure consistent follow-through across schools?"
- C. Leadership Transitions: "With the superintendent search and SPWHS principal search underway, how are student perspectives being incorporated into these decisions?" "How can community engagement strengthen trust during these transitions?"
- D. Student Voice Moving Forward: "How will feedback from this conversation lead to concrete action?" "What ongoing structure ensures continued collaboration with students across all schools?"

18:00–26:00 — Propose Concrete Next Steps. "I'd like to focus on one primary next step and a backup. Options could include: districtwide student climate listening sessions; a clear student-facing safety communication protocol; an ongoing student advisory group with admin involvement; input opportunities for students in leadership searches. Which of these feels most realistic to begin with, and what would the timeline look like?"

26:00–29:00 — Lock in Follow-Up. Confirm the agreed next step, who is responsible, the timeline/date for follow-up, and how students will be updated on progress.

29:00–30:00 — Closing. "Thank you again for collaborating with students today. We're committed to strengthening student safety, trust, and engagement districtwide, and we look forward to continued

partnership and follow-through."

Meeting 2 — Follow-Up Meeting Script (30 minutes)

Opening (0:00–2:00): Thank you again for meeting previously and for the time and care you've given to these concerns. My hope for today is to briefly review what progress has been made since February 25, look at any early outcomes for students, and then identify the next clear step and timeline moving forward.

Progress Since Last Meeting (2:00–10:00): What specific actions have taken place since our last meeting related to student safety communication, consistency in follow-up to concerns, and opportunities for student voice or feedback? Who has been involved, what timelines are in progress, and what might students or families begin to notice changing?

Evidence of Impact for Students (10:00–18:00): Are there any early signs of impact, even small ones — clearer communication, planned listening opportunities, steps toward surveys or feedback systems, clarified processes for handling concerns? If larger changes are still developing, what is the most realistic first visible step within the next 30 days?

Identifying the Next Concrete Step (18:00–26:00): One clear next action, for example scheduling a student listening session, developing a draft student communication framework, piloting a student climate or trust survey, or creating an ongoing student advisory structure. What feels most achievable, and what timeline makes sense?

Confirming Follow-Through (26:00–29:00): Confirm the agreed-upon next step, who is responsible, the expected timeline, and how students will be updated.

Closing (29:00–30:00): Thank you again for your time, your openness to this conversation, and your continued support of students.

Questions to Ask — Measuring Impact

1. Whether students pay attention: surveys or polls ("Did you hear about this?" "Do you know how to report concerns?"); participation tracking (Student Voices, town halls, board meetings); informal feedback from friends and student groups.
2. Whether students speak up: track Student Voices attendance and who speaks; keep a record of questions, comments, or emails sent to the board/district; check anonymous reporting tools; ask clubs, AVID classes, or advisory groups if students feel comfortable sharing concerns.
3. Whether the district follows through: updates from the board/district (newsletters, emails, websites); meeting minutes mentioning changes to policies, the behavior matrix, or safety plans; visible changes in classrooms, hallways, or offices; follow-up telling students how their feedback led to action.

Tracking sheet:

- Students paying attention — Survey, meeting attendance — Track % who respond
- Students speaking up — Number of comments/questions/emails — Track trends over time
- District follow-through — Emails, website updates, classroom observations — Look for concrete actions

Student Senate Restart Framework

STUDENT SENATE RESTART FRAMEWORK (PHASE I) — Sun Prairie West High School

This document outlines a phased relaunch of the Student Senate at Sun Prairie West High School, utilizing a gradual and sustainable model that will begin in April. Phase I focuses on rebuilding systems, establishing credibility, and strengthening student–administration collaboration before expanding to a full representative body.

The restart model prioritizes sustainability, consistency, achievable goals, and administrative partnership over immediate scale.

I. Purpose

The Student Senate exists to provide structured student input on school improvement, policy feedback, and campus climate.

During Phase I, the Senate will operate as a small pilot advisory team rather than a full legislative body.

II. Core Objectives (Phase I)

1. Re-establish consistent student–administration dialogue.
2. Create repeatable and documented meeting systems.
3. Complete one measurable improvement initiative.
4. Build student awareness and trust in the Senate process.
5. Develop a foundation for gradual expansion in Phase II.
6. Represent diverse student perspectives across grade levels and involvement areas.
7. Provide structured input on school policies, academic systems, and improvement initiatives.
8. Review and respond to student concerns in a systematic and documented manner.
9. Partner with administration in school improvement planning.
10. Promote transparency between students and school leadership.

Definition of a Measurable Initiative: A measurable initiative must include:

- A clearly defined problem
- Documented student input
- A written recommendation
- A tracked outcome or administrative response

III. Authority & Scope

The Student Senate holds formal advisory authority in the following areas:

- Academic policies (grading feedback, weighted GPA structures, scheduling feedback)
- Student climate and equity initiatives
- School improvement planning
- Student discipline framework feedback
- Resource allocation input affecting students
- Facilities and campus improvement suggestions

The Senate does not override administrative decisions. However, the Senate should be consulted on major student-impacting changes when feasible prior to final implementation.

IV. Structure (Phase I Model)

A. Membership

Phase I will consist of a small founding team of 4–6 students selected through a brief application and interview process.

Selection Criteria:

- Demonstrated leadership, initiative, or engagement
- Representation across at least two grade levels
- Commitment to structured work sessions
- Willingness to collaborate respectfully with staff

The goal is diversity of perspective, not size.

B. Terms

- One semester pilot term (April–June)
- End-of-semester evaluation
- Decision on Phase II expansion based on performance and feasibility

C. Expansion Plan (Phase II Consideration)

If Phase I meets its objectives, Phase II may introduce:

- Additional grade-level seats
- A small committee system
- Increased membership to 8–12 students

V. Leadership Roles

- President – Facilitates meetings; sets agendas with advisor and administration; serves as primary liaison.
- Vice President – Assists President; supports coordination and internal operations.
- Secretary – Records and publishes meeting minutes; maintains documentation archive.
- Communications Lead – Provides public updates to the student body.
- Committee Chairs – Established in Phase II if needed.

VI. Meetings & Decision Rules

Meeting Schedule (Phase I):

- Full Senate meets bi-weekly (short, focused sessions).
- One formal SP100 preparatory meeting before the staff review period.

Agendas must be published 24–48 hours before meetings. Minutes must be published within 72 hours after meetings.

Decision Rules:

- Quorum: A majority of members must be present.
- Recommendations: Adopted by simple majority vote.
- Framework Amendments: Require a two-thirds vote and administrative approval.

- The President votes only in the event of a tie.

Attendance Policy:

- Attendance is recorded internally.
- After two unexcused absences, membership status will be reviewed.

VII. Proposal Process

1. An issue is submitted by a student or senator.
2. The issue is reviewed during a scheduled meeting.
3. A draft recommendation is prepared.
4. The recommendation is reviewed by the President and Advisor.
5. A final written brief is submitted to administration for review and discussion.

All proposals must be documented and archived.

VIII. Transparency & Accountability

- Meeting notes are accessible to members and the advisor.
- A brief public summary is shared after any formal administrative review.
- Documentation is maintained in a shared digital archive.

At the conclusion of Phase I, all meeting minutes, reports, and recommendations will be archived in a shared digital folder maintained by the advisor to ensure continuity.

IX. Code of Conduct

Senators must:

- Represent peers respectfully
- Maintain confidentiality when required
- Avoid conflicts of interest
- Engage in civil, solution-focused dialogue
- Prioritize school-wide impact over personal agenda

X. Advisor Role

The Faculty Advisor:

- Ensures continuity and structural stability
- Supports logistics and communication
- Coordinates staff interactions
- Maintains documentation archives
- Does not control votes or recommendations

XI. Staff Partnership Structure

A. Core Staff Advisory Group

May include:

- Principal
- Assistant Principal(s)
- Dean of Students (if applicable)
- School Improvement Lead
- One rotating teacher representative

B. SP100 Participation Protocol (Phase I)

- The Senate will submit a written briefing aligned with the SP100 meeting cycle (June, November, March).
- The President may attend as an observer if invited.
- A written summary of feedback or next steps will be shared within five school days when appropriate.

Phase I prioritizes written briefing participation over full meeting integration.

XII. Evaluation & Transition

At the end of Phase I:

- Review accomplishments and measurable outcomes
- Identify unresolved initiatives
- Document lessons learned
- Assess readiness for Phase II expansion

- Archive all materials for continuity

XIII. Amendment Process

- Two-thirds vote of active Senate members
- Administrative approval required
- Public posting of approved amendments

Adopted: _____ Phase I Review Date: _____ Quarterly Review: _____

Meeting log template

Student Senate meeting log template.

Agendas

Date: _____

Minutes

Date: _____

SP100

Date: _____

Public Reports (April 2026)

Report A — Student Advocacy and Progress Report (April 2026)

Sun Prairie Area School District (SPASD). Prepared by: Zackary Mark. Date: April 2026.

Executive Summary

Since January 2026, student-led advocacy has driven measurable progress toward stronger student safety, trust, transparency, communication consistency, and authentic student voice within the Sun Prairie Area School District. Beginning with a formal proposal to the Board of Education and advancing through collaborative meetings and structured initiatives, these efforts have resulted in the launch of the Student Senate at Sun Prairie West High School, expanded student participation in leadership selection, and ongoing work to improve district systems.

While foundational steps have been achieved, several areas remain in development. Sustained implementation, clear accountability measures, and districtwide scaling will be critical to embedding student perspectives into SPASD's operations and creating long-term improvements in school climate.

Purpose of This Report

The purpose of this report is to document the journey of student-led advocacy, highlight concrete progress made to date, provide transparency on current initiatives, and outline clear recommendations for sustained improvement. It serves as both a record of achievements and a roadmap to ensure student voice translates into meaningful, long-term systems that enhance school climate, safety, and shared decision-making across SPASD.

Key Definitions

- Student Voice: The structured and meaningful inclusion of student perspectives in school climate, safety, communication, and decision-making processes.
- Student Safety and Trust Framework: The January 2026 proposal submitted to the Board of Education that outlines actionable steps for improved incident communication, consistent safety protocols, transparent reporting, formal student advisory structures, and proactive mental health supports.
- Student Senate: A formal, elected representative body designed to provide ongoing student input on school-related issues, collaborate with administration, and contribute to problem-solving and goal-setting.
- Shared Decision-Making: The practice of including students, alongside administrators and the Board, in leadership selection, policy development, and continuous improvement efforts.

1. Background and Timeline of Student Advocacy

Student concerns regarding school climate, safety, communication after serious incidents, and consistency in district practices prompted structured advocacy efforts.

- January 13, 2026: Submission of the "Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework" to the SPASD Board of Education. The proposal addressed gaps in incident communication, reporting transparency, cross-building consistency, student advisory structures, mental health supports, and continuous improvement processes.
- January–February 2026: Individual responses received from Board members affirm the importance of transparency and student voice.
- March 2, 2026: Student Advocacy Meeting with district leadership. The agenda focused on safety and communication systems, consistency and accountability across schools, and the role of student voice in leadership decisions.

- March–April 2026: Follow-up communications on Student Senate development, mandated reporting clarity, and student involvement in the Sun Prairie West High School principal search.
- April 2026: Rollout of the Student Senate interest form, application period, elections, and coordination of student participation in principal interviews.

2. Student Safety, Trust, and Proposed Framework

The January 2026 framework proposed a comprehensive, DPI-aligned approach to rebuilding trust. Core components:

- Clear acknowledgment and communication when serious incidents occur, even when full details cannot be shared.
- Districtwide overview of safety and reporting processes, including roles of administration, district leadership, and external authorities.
- Consistent implementation of safety and conduct protocols across all schools to address observed variations in handling similar situations.
- Strengthened student voice through formal advisory structures at middle and high school levels with required administrative responses.
- Proactive mental health and wellness supports, including regular advisory time and accessible counseling pathways.
- Ongoing review and reflection via regular climate surveys, transparent reporting, and public discussion of improvement efforts.

Board Response (January 20, 2026): The Board acknowledged the concerns, emphasized legal/privacy constraints, highlighted actions already taken (such as releasing independent investigator reports and maintaining a dedicated FAQ website), and committed to continued attention through school liaisons and student representative recruitment.

Current Status: Transparency initiatives are advancing, with district leadership focusing on clearer student-facing communication regarding reporting escalation, parent notifications, and post-incident messaging.

3. Student Advocacy Meeting Outcomes (March 2, 2026)

The meeting established a foundation for collaborative, solution-oriented engagement. Primary discussion areas included student safety and communication systems; consistency and accountability in districtwide practices; and integration of student perspectives into leadership decisions and formal processes. The meeting shifted focus from identifying concerns to developing structured next steps with measurable outcomes.

4. Establishment of the Student Senate

District leadership initiated planning for a representative Student Senate to institutionalize student input beyond one-time feedback opportunities.

- Introduced in April 2026 for full implementation in the 2026–2027 school year.
- Composition: Three students per grade level (9th, 10th, and 11th graders serving in the following year) plus additional members from student clubs and organizations.
- Selection Process: Student-wide elections following an interest/application period (deadline April 22, 2026). Elections held April 27, 2026, with a revised ballot issued to correct initial technical errors.
- Purpose and Goals: Serve as a formal voice for peers; identify school climate concerns; collaborate with administration on communication systems and problem-solving; develop concrete goals and strategic action plans.

Elected representatives were announced April 29, 2026: three incoming seniors, three incoming juniors, and three incoming sophomores.

Observations: High student interest was evident. However, initial ballot errors temporarily affected trust in the process. Discussions also explored incorporating students from Act 95 and the Weighted GPA

initiative groups.

5. Student Involvement in Leadership Selection

A significant milestone was the invitation for students to participate in the Sun Prairie West High School principal interview process. Interview dates (April 3 and April 7, 2026) were coordinated, providing students a direct opportunity to evaluate leadership candidates on priorities including safety, communication, and student voice.

6. Communication and Transparency Initiatives

District leadership is actively addressing inconsistencies in how information reaches students following incidents and clarifying student services processes. Focus areas:

- Evaluation of existing communication protocols and identification of gaps in student-facing messaging.
- Increased clarity on mandated reporting: when and how reports escalate to external agencies, parent/guardian notification procedures, and accessible information for students.
- Development of more timely, consistent, and transparent communication systems.

Current Status: These improvements remain in progress and constitute a critical area for building long-term trust.

7. Challenges and Observations

- Transition from informal feedback to structured involvement is underway, but success depends on administrative timelines and system capacity.
- Technical issues during Student Senate elections highlighted the need for robust process review.
- Popular election promotes broad participation but may benefit from hybrid selection methods to better include highly engaged students.
- Student Senate provides an important avenue for voice, yet complementary structures are needed to fully utilize experienced advocates and prevent over-reliance on a single body.

8. Recommendations

- Institutionalize the Student Senate with clear governance, meeting schedules, defined influence on school decisions, and mechanisms for administrative accountability.
- Expand Student Voice Pathways by creating additional advisory, liaison, and committee roles to complement the Senate.
- Enhance Election and Selection Processes through rigorous pre-launch review and consideration of hybrid models (application + election).
- Advance Communication Systems by finalizing standardized protocols for incident response and student services transparency, with regular updates to the community.
- Strengthen Accountability via regular progress reporting, climate surveys, 100-day goal check-ins, and measurable indicators.
- Scale Districtwide by extending successful practices, such as student participation in principal and superintendent searches, to other schools and levels.

9. Survey

The bilingual "Student Advocacy Feedback / Comentarios sobre la defensa de los estudiantes" form is reproduced in full in the Surveys & Feedback part of this document. Respondent link: https://forms.gle/pQsxiPcCcrp9tB1j6

Conclusion

The advocacy efforts of recent months illustrate the power of persistent, constructive student engagement when met with responsive district leadership. The proposed Safety and Trust Framework, Student Advocacy Meeting, launch of the Student Senate, and student involvement in principal selection mark important progress toward a more transparent, consistent, and student-centered school district.

Long-term success will depend on converting these early initiatives into embedded systems. By maintaining collaboration, ensuring

accountability, and prioritizing student voice in decision-making processes, SPASD can establish a model of shared responsibility that enhances safety, trust, and educational excellence for all students.

Report B — Student Advocacy Report #2: Progress Update on Student Voice, Communication, and Leadership Engagement

Executive Summary

Following the initial Student Advocacy Meeting, continued efforts have been made to advance districtwide priorities related to student voice, communication transparency, and system-level consistency. While several initiatives remain in development, meaningful steps have been taken to integrate student perspectives into both ongoing discussions and formal leadership processes.

Background

The March 2, 2026 Student Advocacy Meeting established a foundation for collaborative engagement between students and district leadership, focused on student safety and communication systems; consistency and accountability across schools; and the role of student voice in leadership decisions and district processes. The goal was not only to identify concerns, but to transition toward structured, solution-oriented next steps with measurable outcomes.

Progress & Developments

1. Exploration of a Districtwide Student Senate — District leadership has initiated discussions regarding the reestablishment of a Student Senate framework. Current considerations include incorporating students involved in recent district initiatives, including Act 95 and Weighted GPA discussions. Emphasis is on a more consistent, representative, and sustainable structure, moving beyond one-time feedback toward an ongoing, system-level student advisory model.

2. Student Involvement in Leadership Selection — Students have been invited to participate in the Sun Prairie West High School principal interview process. This creates a direct opportunity to influence leadership priorities, values, and communication approaches.
3. Student Services & Communication Transparency (In Progress) — District leadership is working to provide increased clarity regarding student services processes, particularly mandated reporting: when and how reports are escalated to external/state agencies; when and how parents/guardians are notified; and how information is communicated to students clearly.
4. Continued Focus on Communication Systems — Initial discussions highlighted inconsistencies in how information is communicated to students following incidents. Priorities: evaluating existing protocols, identifying gaps in student-facing communication, and exploring more consistent, timely, and transparent messaging.

Current Status Overview

- Student Senate development → In progress (early-stage planning)
- Student involvement in leadership processes → Active and ongoing
- Communication and transparency improvements → In development
- System-level implementation → Pending further structure and follow-up

Key Observations

- There is a clear shift from informal student feedback toward structured student involvement.
- Progress is present, though dependent on administrative timelines and system capacity.
- Early-stage efforts will require sustained attention to ensure they translate into long-term systems rather than temporary initiatives.

Priority Areas Moving Forward

- Establishing a clear structure and timeline for Student Senate implementation

- Ensuring transparency and accessibility in student-facing communication systems
- Expanding and sustaining student involvement in leadership and decision-making processes
- Maintaining accountability through defined follow-ups and measurable progress indicators

Conclusion

Student voice is most effective when it is not only heard, but embedded into the processes that shape the district. Continued collaboration between students and district leadership will be essential in ensuring that progress remains steady, measurable, and aligned with the needs of the broader student community.

Report C — Public Report on Student Safety, Voice, and Communication (February 2026)

Prepared by: Zackary Mark, Student Representative. Status: Public Community Document.

I. Purpose

The purpose of this report is to document student-led efforts to understand and strengthen student safety (physical, emotional, and psychological), student voice in decision-making, and communication transparency between students, staff, families, and district leadership. This report is not an accusation against any individual or institution. Its purpose is constructive transparency and continuous improvement in support of students.

II. Definitions

- Student Safety includes physical protection, emotional wellbeing, and confidence that school systems will respond appropriately to concerns.
- Student Voice refers to structured opportunities for student perspectives to meaningfully influence school or district decisions.

- Transparency is clear, timely, and accessible communication of processes, actions, and outcomes within legal privacy limits.
- Accountability means consistent policy implementation, visible follow-through on concerns, and equitable standards across schools.

III. Background

During the 2025–2026 school year, student discussions within SPASD highlighted recurring themes: questions about how safety concerns are reported and addressed; uncertainty about whether student reports lead to visible action; and desire for stronger student involvement in district decisions. In response, a student-led engagement effort was initiated to gather voluntary perspectives and encourage constructive dialogue with district leadership.

IV. Method of Engagement

Direct outreach to middle and high school students; voluntary written student responses to standardized safety questions; outreach to teachers, staff, and administrators; public community communication via social media; and preparation for collaborative meetings with district leadership. Participation has been voluntary and informal at this stage.

V. Preliminary Observations (Non-Statistical)

Many students report feeling generally safe physically. Some students express uncertainty about adult follow-through. Concerns exist regarding whether reports are consistently heard. Students show interest in clearer procedures and communication.

VI. Risks and Limitations

Small and voluntary response sample; possible participation bias; ongoing data collection; privacy laws restricting the disclosure of incidents; variation in experiences across schools.

VII. Actions Completed to Date

Initiated student-led safety and voice inquiry; developed a standardized student question set; collected initial voluntary student responses; conducted outreach to staff and administrators; began community awareness through social media; prepared documentation for district discussion.

VIII. Actions Currently in Progress

Continued student response collection; expansion of outreach to additional schools and grade levels; preparation for February 25 administrative meeting; organization of documentation and communication materials.

IX. Actions Recommended Next (0–90 Days)

- Immediate (0–30 days): Conduct a district-supported student listening session or distribute a brief student climate and trust survey.
- Short term (30–60 days): Public summary of themes that protects confidentiality; identification of priority safety and communication needs.
- Near term (60–90 days): Establish an ongoing student advisory or feedback structure; define clear communication pathways for student concerns.

X. Social Media and Community Engagement Status

Public informational posts inviting voluntary participation; encouragement of student, family, and staff dialogue; emphasis on constructive collaboration rather than criticism. Engagement remains early-stage but positive.

XI. Relationships and Collaboration

Respectful outreach to students across grade levels, teachers and school staff, school and district administrators, and families and community members, emphasizing voluntary participation, respectful

dialogue, and shared commitment to student wellbeing.

XIII. Good-Faith Statement

All actions described in this report were conducted in good faith with the intent to improve student safety and wellbeing, strengthen trust and communication, and support collaborative solutions within SPASD. No portion of this report is intended to defame, accuse, or target any individual.

XIV. Conclusion

This student-led effort represents an early but meaningful step toward greater transparency, stronger student voice, and improved trust in safety systems. Sustained engagement, structured data collection, and clear communication will be essential to long-term progress.

XV. Public Release Notice

This document is suitable for community awareness, educational discussion, administrative planning, and civic learning and student leadership development. It should be interpreted as a constructive public report, not a legal claim.

Meeting Packet: Dr. Taren Turner (August 27)

STUDENT VOICE • STRONGER TOGETHER — Meeting Brief & Discussion Guide Zackary Mark + Dr. Turner. Thursday, August 27, 2026, 11:30 AM–12:30 PM, District Support Center.

Purpose of the Meeting

Use this hour to discuss how student voice can become a consistent part of district decision-making, student leadership, communication, and school improvement. The goal is not simply to identify concerns, but to identify practical structures, opportunities, and next steps that can create lasting student–district collaboration.

Opening Message

I appreciate the opportunity to meet with district leadership. My goal is to bring a student perspective to conversations about how SPASD can strengthen communication, trust, student leadership, and meaningful involvement. I am especially interested in turning student input into something that is consistently connected to decisions and follow-through.

Proposed Discussion Agenda

- 11:30–11:40 | Welcome, introductions, and purpose — Establish the goal for the conversation and identify the most important priorities.
- 11:40–12:20 | Core discussion — Work through student voice, leadership, engagement, Student Senate follow-up, district initiatives, and school climate.
- 12:20–12:30 | Next steps and closing — Identify concrete action items, responsible people, communication, and a path for continued collaboration.

Priority Discussion Areas

1. Student voice & decision-making — How can student perspectives be heard earlier and reflected more consistently in district decisions?
2. Student leadership & advocacy — What structures, supports, and opportunities can help students lead and advocate effectively across SPASD?
3. Engagement & communication — How can communication between students, administrators, and the Board become more consistent, transparent, and two-way?
4. Student Senate & engagement follow-up — What has happened since the Student Senate/student engagement work, what is in motion, and what needs to happen next?
5. District programs, policies & initiatives — Which areas could benefit most from direct student input before decisions are finalized?
6. Climate, belonging, safety & trust — How can students contribute constructively to conversations about school climate, belonging, safety, and trust?
7. Continued collaboration — What ongoing structure could keep student leaders and district leadership connected after this meeting?

Questions to Drive the Conversation

1. What does meaningful student involvement look like to you at the district level?
2. Where does SPASD currently have the strongest student voice, and where is there the biggest gap?
3. How can students be involved before a decision is made rather than only asked for feedback afterward?
4. What would make student leadership sustainable instead of dependent on individual students or staff members?
5. How should student feedback be communicated back to students so they know what changed, what did not, and why?

6. What should the next phase of Student Senate/student engagement work look like?
7. Are there district policies, programs, or initiatives where student input could be incorporated immediately?
8. What is the best way for students to contribute to conversations about safety, belonging, trust, and school climate?
9. Who should be responsible for maintaining an ongoing student–district feedback loop?
10. What is one concrete action we can take after this meeting that would demonstrate that student voice is being taken seriously?

Desired Outcomes

- A clear priority area for continued student–district collaboration.
- Specific next steps, with responsible people and an expected timeline where possible.
- A practical pathway for students to provide input on district decisions and initiatives.
- A plan for continued communication between student leaders, administrators, and district leadership.
- Clarity on the next phase of Student Senate/student engagement work.

Key Principle

Student voice should move beyond being heard to being meaningfully connected to action.

Notes & Commitments: _____

Meeting Packet: Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed

Student Perspective on District Engagement & Improvement Prepared for: Dr. Antoine Reed, Superintendent. Prepared by: Zackary Mark, Sun Prairie West High School

Executive Summary

The Student Voice Initiative is a student-led effort focused on strengthening communication, transparency, trust, and meaningful student engagement across the Sun Prairie Area School District.

The goal is to ensure student voice is not only heard, but consistently reflected in district conversations and long-term decision-making.

Work Completed

- Developed and launched the SPASD Student Voice initiative.
- Created district-wide social media platforms to share information, encourage discussion, and promote student engagement.
- Designed a bilingual student feedback survey to gather perspectives from students, families, staff, and community members.
- Worked with district leadership on topics including student engagement, communication, transparency, school climate, trust, and leadership collaboration.

Prior Areas of Involvement

- Student leadership discussions
- Communication improvement efforts
- Student engagement frameworks
- School climate conversations
- Student advocacy initiatives
- District leadership collaboration

Current Priorities

- Stronger student voice
- Increased collaboration between students and district leadership
- Greater transparency around district decisions
- Sustainable student engagement systems
- Student feedback that results in visible action

Looking Ahead

Potential next steps include exploring:

- A District Student Advisory Council
- Regular student-district meetings
- Structured opportunities for student input
- Public updates demonstrating how student feedback informs district decisions

Purpose

Student Voice should move beyond occasional feedback and become a consistent, transparent, and meaningful part of how SPASD listens, collaborates, and improves.

Discussion Topics & Questions — Meeting with Dr. Antoine Reed

Student Voice

- What does a meaningful student voice look like under your leadership?
- How do you envision students contributing to district-level decision-making?
- What opportunities do you see for students to regularly collaborate with district leadership?

Communication & Transparency

- What improvements would you most like to make regarding communication with students?

- How can communication become more consistent across all SPASD schools?
- How can students better understand why district decisions are made?

Student Advisory Council

- Would you be open to exploring a district-wide Student Advisory Council?
- What would you want that structure to accomplish?
- How could it remain sustainable through future leadership transitions?

School Climate & Trust

- What do you believe builds trust between students and district leadership?
- Where do you believe SPASD has made progress?
- Where do you see the greatest opportunities for improvement?

Looking Ahead

- What are your priorities during your first year as Superintendent?
- How can students help support those priorities?
- What would successful student engagement look like one year from now?

Student Voice Project

- How could the Student Voice project complement existing district engagement efforts?
- Are there opportunities to share student feedback or ideas with district leadership on a regular basis?
- How can student-led initiatives best support the district while remaining constructive and solution-focused?

Closing Questions

- Is there anything you would like students to better understand about district leadership?

- What advice would you give to students who want to become involved in improving their schools?
- What are the best next steps to continue this conversation and build a long-term partnership?

Contact Information

Zackary Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School

- Facebook: @Zack Mark
- Instagram (SPASD Student Voice): @spasdstudentvoice
- School Email: school account
- Personal Email: zackarymark160@gmail.com
- Phone: +1 (608) 940-7356

Thank you for taking the time to meet and discuss the future of student engagement within SPASD. I appreciate the opportunity to share student perspectives and look forward to continuing to work collaboratively to strengthen communication, trust, and meaningful student voice across the district.

Student Advocacy Report #3: Fall 2026 Update

Published on the SPASD Student Voice website. Covers late April through October 8, 2026.

Summary

The biggest change since spring: SPASD's new superintendent, Dr. Antoine Reed, is open to a district-wide Student Advisory Council. Students also helped interview the superintendent finalists, the weighted grades work restarted this fall, and the Director of School Operations offered to help build a student-rights guide.

One thing is still stuck. Mandated-reporting information promised in March hasn't been shared. On the good side, a meeting with the district's equity and communications leaders is now set for October 20.

Student Advisory Council

On April 13, high school students met the three superintendent finalists and gave feedback. In a meeting this fall, Dr. Reed shared ideas for student voice:

- Two-way conversation and quarterly meetings with students
- Advisory teams of 3–5 students from each middle and high school, plus a parent team at each school
- More communication channels, including the district app and a shared calendar
- Building the council into the culture so it lasts through leadership changes

Next step: a written proposal for how members are chosen, how often they meet, and how the district responds to them.

Weighted grades

A student and staff work group aims to bring a weighted grades framework to the Board by the end of November, in time for the December course guides. The group agreed on a 5.0 scale for weighted courses and is writing criteria rather than picking classes one by one. A caregiver survey, in English and Spanish, goes out in October.

Student rights and Title IX

After the federal Title IX change, the district confirmed that its own nondiscrimination and anti-bullying policies still protect students based on sexual orientation, gender identity, and other protected classes. Students can report concerns through Speak Up Speak Out. The Director of School Operations offered to help create a plain-language student-rights guide.

How the budget works

From an August 18 meeting with the Director of Business & Finance: about 80% of spending is staff, enrollment drives revenue, and state aid per student isn't tied to inflation. A separate one-page explainer is on the site.

Still waiting

- Student-facing information on mandated reporting (asked March 2)

Coming up: a meeting with the district's equity and communications leaders on October 20.

Next 60 days

- Send Dr. Reed a Student Advisory Council proposal
- Start the student-rights guide
- Help finish the weighted grades framework
- Share a summary of survey results

District Emails (Sept.–Nov. 2026)

E-053 · Follow-Up: Student Voice & District Engagement

From	Carolyn Pao <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Marlita Bevenue <mabeven@sunprairieschools.org>, Dr. Michael Morgan <mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Sep 8, 2026, 1:10 PM
Thread	Same conversation: E-054, E-055

Hello Zackary,

Thank you for your patience. I am writing to you on behalf of Strategic Communications Director Marlita Bevenue and Systemic Equity & Inclusion Director Dr. Michael Morgan to help set up a time for the three of you to meet.

They apologize for the delay in following up on your initial email — it has been a very busy start to the school year — but they are very excited to reconnect with you. They want to learn more about the work you have been doing, hear about your goals, and discuss how your vision can support student voice and engagement across the district. Their goal for this meeting is to build a shared understanding before mapping out potential next steps together.

We can schedule this either in person or virtually. To make sure we don't pull you away from your studies, we would like to coordinate a time during lunch or outside from your core academic classes.

Please let me know:

- Format preference: In-person or Virtual
- Your availability: 3 times over the next 2 weeks during non-core class times (i.e. lunch)

Once you let me know what works best for your schedule, I will schedule a meeting based on everyone's availability and send you a calendar confirmation. If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to reach out.

Thank you!

Pao, Administrative Associate, The Department of Systemic Equity & Inclusion (She/Hers)

E-054 · Re: Follow-Up: Student Voice & District Engagement

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Carolyn Pao <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>
Cc	Marlita Bevenue <mabeven@sunprairieschools.org>, Michael Morgan <mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Sep 8, 2026, 1:20 PM
Topics	Student council · Surveys
Thread	Same conversation: E-053, E-055

Hello,

Thank you for reaching out and for coordinating this meeting. I really appreciate the opportunity to reconnect and speak with Dr. Bevenue and Dr. Morgan about the work I have been doing around student voice, communication, and school climate.

I would prefer to meet in person, as I think that would allow for a more productive conversation and give us the opportunity to discuss the ideas and potential next steps in greater depth.

My availability over the next two weeks during non-core class times is:

- A Days: 12:15–3:50 p.m.
- B Days: 12:15–3:50 p.m.

I am flexible within those windows, so any three times that work best for everyone's schedules should work well for me.

I am looking forward to sharing more about the Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback survey, the ideas I have been developing around a district-wide Student Advisory Council, and how I believe student voice can become a sustainable part of SPASD's decision-making and communication processes.

Thank you again for coordinating this. I appreciate the opportunity and look forward to meeting with everyone.

Best, Zackary Mark Student Advocate | Sun Prairie West High School | Instagram: SPASD Student Voice

E-055 · Re: [Student] Re: Follow-Up: Student Voice & District Engagement

From Carolyn Pao <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc Marlita Bevenue, Dr. Michael Morgan
Date Sep 8, 2026, 2:15 PM
Thread Same conversation: E-053, E-054

Thank you Zackary for the quick response and I will coordinate with Marlita and Dr. Morgan on what date and time would best work for them. I will also need some additional time to coordinate with the West High staff to ensure we can reserve one of the conference rooms as well. Please standby and my goal is to update you before the end of the week.

Best, Pao

E-056 · Questions Regarding Recent Title IX Changes and LGBTQIA+ Student Protections

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Title IX Coordinator <titleixcoordinator@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Sep 29, 2026, 8:25 PM

Dear Title IX Coordinator,

I'm reaching out because I have some questions about the recent federal changes to Title IX and what those changes mean for LGBTQIA+ students in the Sun Prairie Area School District.

With the federal government reinstating the 2020 Title IX regulations, I want to better understand how SPASD is interpreting and implementing these changes at the district level. In particular, I'm hoping the district can clarify:

- Whether the recent federal changes affect any protections or policies currently provided to students based on sexual orientation or gender identity.
- Whether SPASD's existing nondiscrimination policies and protections for LGBTQIA+ students remain in effect.

- Whether students, families, and staff should expect any changes to how discrimination, harassment, or other concerns involving LGBTQIA+ students are handled.
- What resources or support will remain available to LGBTQIA+ students if federal Title IX protections change or become more limited.

I'm asking because I think it is important for students to have a clear understanding of their rights, the district's responsibilities, and the support available to them. I also want to make sure that information being shared with students is accurate and reflects both federal requirements and the district's own policies.

If there are any updated policies, guidance, or resources related to these changes, I would appreciate being directed to them.

Thank you for taking the time to clarify this and for continuing to support students across the district.

Sincerely, Zackary Mark Student Advocate | Sun Prairie West High School | Instagram: SPASD Student Voice School Email: school account | Personal Email: zackarymark160@gmail.com | Phone: +1 (608) 940-7356

E-057 · Re: [Title IX Coordinator] [Student] Questions Regarding Recent Title IX Changes and LGBTQIA+ Student Protections

From	Tricia Rodey <tcrodey@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Date	Oct 1, 2026, 9:05 PM
Thread	Same conversation: E-058

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for your email. I appreciate your advocacy on this important issue. Here are my answers to your questions:

- Whether the recent federal changes affect any protections or policies currently provided to students based on sexual orientation or gender identity.

I am answering this assuming you are referring to the Dept of Education decision from 9/28/26 to formally rescind the 2020 Title IX guidance. Please let me know if you are referring to other changes. A judge actually

blocked the 2020 changes a year ago, so we haven't been able to use them during that time. This latest decision officially removes them from the books. However, Sun Prairie Area School District policy still includes protections for all members of protected classes (this includes classifications based on gender, sex, and gender identity). The latest move does not impact any protections or policies provided to students in our district.

- Whether SPASD's existing nondiscrimination policies and protections for LGBTQIA+ students remain in effect.

They do indeed. Title IX was one layer of protection, but our anti-bullying/anti-harassment policies are actually more robust protection and are still alive and well. The criteria for Title IX is actually very narrow and my hope is that we put an end to harassment through the aforementioned policies well before the behavior would meet the threshold for a Title IX complaint.

- Whether students, families, and staff should expect any changes to how discrimination, harassment, or other concerns involving LGBTQIA+ students are handled.

They should not. Title IX was one tool in the toolbox for addressing concerns involving LGBTQIA+ students, but we still have other tools available to us. The fact of the matter is we (administrators in Sun Prairie) are keenly aware of the harm a hostile school environment can have on any students but particularly members of our LGBTQIA+ community. My team and I remain committed to ensuring all of our students have access to a safe and supportive school community. We've actually been working to make reporting concerns easier and more robust through changing how we use Speak Up Speak Out (SUSO) to ensure more eyes are on complaints more quickly.

- What resources or support will remain available to LGBTQIA+ students if federal Title IX protections change or become more limited.

All of the resources we have in the district remain in effect. Administrators and staff remain committed to ensuring students have access to whatever resources they need. These Title IX changes do not limit or change what we are able to offer our students.

I admire and share your goal to ensure that all students know their rights — both within and beyond the school setting. I've been looking for an

in-road in SPASD to provide information to students about the rights and protections. I think Title IX is one example of a confusing legal topic, but the events at East this week also has me thinking it might be useful for students to learn more about their first amendment rights (not because those students did anything wrong, but because I want students to feel confident exercising their voice and know what is and isn't legal). If it ever fits into your schedule, would you be willing to meet with me to brainstorm what this might look like? I see your email signature says "student advocate," I am curious what that role entails and if you have an affiliation with a student activist group. I would more than welcome the opportunity to connect with activist minded students to learn how I might be helpful in supporting them in learning more about their rights. If you have any thoughts or insights on what that could look like, I would deeply appreciate them.

Thanks again for reaching out. Please don't hesitate to contact me again if I can be of assistance.

Sincerely, Dr. Rodey Tricia Rodey, Ph.D.

E-058 · Re: [Title IX Coordinator] [Student] Questions Regarding Recent Title IX Changes and LGBTQIA+ Student Protections

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Tricia Rodey <tcrodey@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Oct 1, 2026, 9:14 PM
Topics	Plate readers · Surveys
Thread	Same conversation: E-057

Dear Dr. Rodey,

Thank you for taking the time to give such a detailed response. I really appreciate you answering each of my questions and clarifying how the recent federal changes interact with the protections already in place within SPASD.

It is reassuring to know that the district's nondiscrimination, anti-bullying, and anti-harassment policies remain in effect and that students should not expect changes to how concerns involving LGBTQIA+ students are handled. I also appreciate hearing about the work being done to make

Speak Up Speak Out more effective and ensure that concerns receive more attention and follow-up.

When I use "Student Advocate" in my signature, I mean that I work to elevate student voices, help students understand issues that affect them, and create better communication between students and decision-makers.

Over the past several years, I have worked on a number of student and community advocacy projects. This has included gathering student feedback through surveys, working on districtwide student-voice initiatives, sharing student concerns and recommendations with district leadership, and participating in conversations about policies that directly affect students.

I have also worked as a youth community advocate outside of the school district. Most recently, I met with Sun Prairie Police Chief Kevin Warych to discuss the department's automated license plate reader program. We discussed issues including privacy, transparency, data retention, access to information, data sharing, and the potential impact of surveillance technology on the community. I have been working to turn that conversation and the information gathered into a plain-language report so community members can better understand the program and the policies surrounding it.

I am not currently representing a formal student activist organization. Rather, I have been working independently and through student-led efforts to make sure young people have opportunities to understand policies, ask questions of decision-makers, and have their voices taken seriously.

That is also why your idea about helping students learn more about their rights really interests me. I think there could be a lot of value in creating something accessible and designed specifically for students rather than expecting them to navigate complicated legal language on their own.

For example, this could potentially include student-friendly information about Title IX, nondiscrimination and anti-harassment protections, First Amendment rights in schools, student privacy, reporting concerns, and the different district resources available to students. It could also explain the difference between federal protections and protections provided directly through district policy so students understand that their rights do not necessarily begin and end with one federal law.

I would be very interested in meeting with you to brainstorm what this could look like and how students could be involved in developing it. I also think it would be important for students themselves to have a role in deciding what information would be most useful and how it should be communicated.

Thank you again for reaching out and for being willing to have this conversation. I really appreciate the opportunity to work together on something that could help students better understand their rights and feel more confident using their voices.

Sincerely, Zackary Mark

E-059 · Invitation with note: MEETING: Student Voice & District Engagement @ Tue Oct 20, 2026 13:30–14:30 (CDT)

From Michael Morgan (organizer) <mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account), Marlita Bevenue

Date Oct 15, 2026, 7:21 AM

Note: "Thank you everyone for you collaboration and patience! Please let Pao know if this date and time needs to be adjusted if this does not work for your schedule or if there is a change. Thank you."

Conference Room: 1202

Purpose: Director Bevenue and Dr. Morgan would like to know more about the work Student ZM has been doing, hear about their goals, and discuss how their vision can support student voice and engagement across the district. Their goal for this meeting is to build a shared understanding before mapping out potential next steps together.

When: Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 1:30–2:30 PM (Central) Location: Sun Prairie West High School, 2850 Ironwood Dr, Sun Prairie, WI 53590 — West High School-1202 Conference Room Guests: Michael Morgan (organizer), Marlita Bevenue, Zackary Mark

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E-060 · Recap and draft public report: Student Voice & District Engagement, Oct 20

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Michael Morgan; Marlita Bevenue
Date	Oct 20, 2026, 2:50 PM
Attachments	SPASD_Student_Voice_Report_4.pdf
Topics	Weighted grades · Student council · Newsletter · Surveys · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-061, E-097, E-098

Dr. Morgan and Ms. Bevenue,

Thank you both for taking the time to meet today. As promised, here's a short written summary so we all leave with the same notes. I've also attached a draft of my next public report (Student Advocacy Report #4), which is based on our conversation.

Before I publish it, I'd appreciate it if you could look it over and let me know if I misrepresented anything you said. If I don't hear back by Monday, October 26, I'll go ahead and post it.

Quick recap

Communication after serious incidents: What students are told depends on direct impact, the age of the students, and how serious the incident is. Immediate safety comes first. Then the communications office works with the principal and district leadership to confirm facts and decide what each audience needs to know. Names, individual consequences, student records, and personnel matters can't be shared. I noted in the report that Dr. Morgan's answers reflected his own understanding, not a formal district protocol.

What students asked for: short, factual messages even when names can't be shared, naming the specific law when something is off limits, and "you said, we did" updates so students see what happened with their input.

Newsletters: Thank you, Ms. Bevenue, for committing to send district newsletters to all students when they launch in November. That's exactly the kind of change I was hoping to see, and I've highlighted it in the report.

June 2027: We agreed the next step is to ask students across the district what good student voice looks and sounds like, then set goals and benchmarks from those answers. Dr. Morgan, I'm taking your feedback and expanding the survey to reach all three high schools, all four grade levels, and a more diverse range of students.

Weighted grades: This morning the student work group agreed weighting should start with next year's freshmen (Class of 2031) in 2027–28. It goes to the Teaching and Learning Committee on November 2 and the Board on November 9.

Still open

- Sharing the survey through district channels
- A staff partner for a pilot district student advisory council
- A recurring student–district check-in
- One public "you said, we did" update this semester

We ran out of time before the advisory council and equity questions, so I'd love to set up a follow-up meeting. Would sometime in the next few weeks work for you?

Links Climate survey: https://forms.gle/9ULwNASeJFceHkCy8 Website: https://spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app Instagram: @spasdstudentvoice

Thank you again, Zackary Mark

E-061 · Re: Recap and draft public report: Student Voice & District Engagement, Oct 20

From	Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Michael Morgan
Date	Oct 21, 2026, 10:38 AM
Topics	Newsletter
Thread	Same conversation: E-060, E-097, E-098

Hi, Zachary.

Thanks so much for putting together this recap! I really enjoyed our conversation and appreciate the work you're doing to elevate student voices across the district. And yes, as we discussed, beginning in November, we'll also share our district family newsletters with scholars, in addition to parents and caregivers. I think this is a great step toward keeping students informed and connected. I don't have any additional feedback at this point, but Dr. Morgan may have some thoughts to share. Thanks again for your leadership, and I look forward to continuing the conversation!

With gratitude, Marlita A. Bevenue Director, Strategic Communications, Sun Prairie Area School District 501 S. Bird Street, Sun Prairie, WI 53590

E-062 · Student Voice Story

From	Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications
To	Vientiane Yang (Multimedia & Website Specialist, SPASD); Zackary Mark
Date	Oct 21, 2026, 10:26 AM
Thread	Same conversation: E-063, E-064, E-065, E-066

Hi, Zachary and Vien.

I wanted to connect the two of you!

Zackary, thanks again for taking the time to meet with Dr. Morgan and me yesterday. I really appreciate the work you're doing to elevate student voices at Sun Prairie West and across the district. I think it's a great story to share with our school community!

Vien is our Multimedia Strategist and would love to connect with you for a brief interview about your student voice advocacy work, what inspired you to get involved, and what you hope to accomplish.

Zackary, could you coordinate a time for this Thursday with Vien that works with your schedule? I'll let you two take it from here! Thanks again, and I look forward to seeing this story come together!

With gratitude, Marlita A. Bevenue

E-063 · Re: Student Voice Story

From Zackary Mark
To Vientiane Yang
Date Oct 21, 2026, 11:19 AM
Thread Same conversation: E-062, E-064, E-065, E-066

Hi Vien, it is a pleasure to meet you. I am free anytime between 12:40 and 3:50 tomorrow. It would be great to meet you then. If you'd like, I can coordinate with the SPW office to find a room for us to meet. I can't wait to meet you!

Best, Zackary Mark

E-064 · Re: Student Voice Story

From Vientiane Yang, Multimedia & Website Specialist, SPASD
To Zackary Mark
Date Oct 21, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-062, E-063, E-065, E-066

Hi Zackary,

It is nice to meet you! I'm excited for the interview. Let's aim for 1pm tomorrow if that works. If you can secure a room that would be great, feel free to loop me in if the admins or office staff are asking.

In addition to the interview, I'll also be taking your headshot. Just wanted to give you a heads-up!

Let me know if you have any questions.

Thanks, Vientiane Yang Multimedia & Website Specialist | (608) 834-6568 | 501 S. Bird Street, Sun Prairie, WI 53590 | Pronouns: He/His/Him

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E-065 · Re: Student Voice Story

From Zackary Mark
To Vientiane Yang
Date Oct 21, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-062, E-063, E-064, E-066

Room 1007, in the front office at 1:00 pm. Can't wait to meet you tomorrow!

Best, Zack

E-066 · Re: Student Voice Story

From Vientiane Yang
To Zackary Mark
Date Oct 21, 2026
Thread Same conversation: E-062, E-063, E-064, E-065

Sounds great! See you tomorrow.

E-067 · Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Antoine Reed, Superintendent
Date	Oct 29, 2026, 7:31 PM
Attachments	One-page outline
Topics	Weighted grades · Student council · Newsletter · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-068, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-077, E-078

Dear Dr. Reed,

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Zack Mark. I am a student at Sun Prairie West High School and the founder of SPASD Student Voice, a student-led effort focused on safety, communication, transparency and student voice across the district. Thank you for the time you have given to students this fall.

I am writing to formally propose a spring 2027 pilot of a district-wide Student Advisory Council. A one-page outline is attached for your review.

Background

Students have worked with the district on several issues this fall. The weighted grades work group, led by Dr. Mould, included students early, and the plan is scheduled for a Board committee preview on November 2 and a Board presentation on November 9. The district also committed on October 20 to a student newsletter, which was confirmed in writing on October 21.

These steps show what is possible when students are included early. However, there is currently no standing structure in which students from every school meet with district leadership on a regular schedule. A council would make that kind of collaboration routine and would give the district a reliable way to test plans with students before they are rolled out.

Proposal summary

- **Membership:** 12 to 16 students in grades 9 to 12: four to six each from East and West, and two from Prairie Phoenix Academy, chosen through an open application. At least one seat per school would go to a student

not already in a leadership role.

- **Meetings:** monthly, 60 minutes, rotating between buildings, with transportation support for students who need it.
- **District role:** you or a designee would attend at least every other meeting, and one staff liaison would attend all meetings.
- **Accountability:** a public summary after each meeting and a report to the Board twice a year.

Proposed timeline

- November to December 2026: pilot approved and a staff liaison named
- January 2027: two-week application window at each high school
- February to May 2027: four monthly meetings
- May 2027: joint review to decide whether to continue in 2027-28

Requests

1. Approval of a spring 2027 pilot
2. Designation of a district staff liaison
3. A 20-minute meeting in November to plan the launch

I recognize that the Student Senate restart or another existing structure may be a better home for this work, and I would welcome your guidance on how the council could build on what is already in place. I am glad to adjust the proposal based on your feedback.

Thank you for your consideration. I look forward to hearing from you.

Respectfully,

Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School

E-068 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Dr. Antoine Reed, Superintendent
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 9:00 AM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-077, E-078

Hey Zackary, I love this idea. I will find time to connect with you on this after you run this by your principal. Invite me to join the conversation!

E-069 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Peggy Shoemaker, Sun Prairie West
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 10:52 AM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-077, E-078

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

I hope you're doing well. Yesterday I sent Dr. Reed a proposal for a spring 2027 pilot of a district-wide Student Advisory Council, and he replied that he likes the idea and asked me to run it by you first. He'd like to be invited to join the conversation, so I've copied him here.

The short version of the proposal:

- 12 to 16 students in grades 9–12: four to six each from East and West, and two from Prairie Phoenix Academy, chosen through an open application, with at least one seat per school for a student not already in a leadership role
- Monthly 60-minute meetings from February to May 2027, rotating between buildings

- A district staff liaison at every meeting, and a public summary after each one
- A joint review in May to decide whether to continue

I also want to make sure it works alongside the Student Senate rather than competing with it, so I'd really value your thoughts on how the two could fit together.

Would you have 20–30 minutes in the next week or two to talk? I'm free during non-core class times on A and B days from 12:15 to 3:50 p.m. Dr. Reed, if any of those times work for you, I'd love for you to join.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-070 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Principal Peggy Shoemaker
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 11:51 AM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-077, E-078

Zack,

Thank you for reaching out. I am uncertain about the purpose of this group. Our Student Senate is just beginning and we are working hard for West. I also know that the School Board has student representatives as well. What would you hope to accomplish with the Student Advisory Council? It seems as if it would be a duplication of efforts, at least at West,

Ms. Shoemaker

E-071 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Peggy Shoemaker
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 12:16 PM
Topics	Weighted grades · Student council · Newsletter · Board of Education
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-070, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-077, E-078

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for the quick reply and for being honest about your concerns. I agree the Student Senate is important, and I don't want to take anything away from what you're building at West. I'd like to explain a little more about what I have in mind, because I think it can support the Senate rather than compete with it.

What it would be: A small group of 12 to 16 high school students from East, West, and Prairie Phoenix that meets once a month with district leaders. It would only focus on district-wide decisions, things that affect every school, and it would share a short public summary after each meeting so other students know what was discussed and what happened.

Why it would exist: This fall, some of the biggest issues for students were district-level: weighted grades, how the district communicates with students after serious incidents, and the new student newsletter. Students were included in each of those, but it happened one case at a time, usually because a student or staff member reached out. The council would make that routine, so the district has a regular group of students from every school it can check plans with before they roll out, and students have a predictable way to hear back about what happened with their input.

How it's different:

- Student Senate: focuses on one school and works with the principal on building-level issues at West. The council wouldn't take on building issues. Anything specific to West would go to the Senate.
- Board student representatives: as I understand it, they represent students at Board meetings, once items are already on the agenda. The council would work earlier, while district plans are still being shaped, and

could help the student representatives hear from more students before Board meetings. I'd like to learn more about how they're chosen so the two fit together.

- Work groups like weighted grades: focus on one issue for a set time. The council would be ongoing and could help find students for future work groups.

How it could avoid duplication at West: West's seats could come from the Student Senate, so the Senate stays the voice for West and the council simply connects it with students at the other schools. The Board's student representatives could also be members. If it fits better, it could even be a once-a-month meeting of existing student leaders from each school instead of a new group.

I'm very open to changing the proposal based on your feedback. Would you have 20 minutes to talk about it in the next week or two? Dr. Reed, I'd welcome your thoughts as well.

Thank you, Zack

E-072 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Principal Peggy Shoemaker
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 3:37 PM
Topics	Weighted grades · Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-077, E-078

Hi Zach, This sounds like more of a District Student group so I am going to opt out for now. We appreciate your ongoing support in working on the weighted grades issue.

Ms. Shoemaker

E-073 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From Zackary Mark

To Principal Peggy Shoemaker; Dr. Antoine Reed

Date Oct 30, 2026, 3:41 PM

Topics Weighted grades · Student council

Thread Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-077, E-078

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for taking the time to read it and for the kind words about the weighted grades work. I understand, and I appreciate you letting me know.

Dr. Reed, since Ms. Shoemaker sees this as a district-level group, I'd love to take you up on connecting about it. Would you have 20 minutes in the next couple of weeks to talk about next steps for a spring pilot, including who might serve as the district staff liaison? I'm free during non-core class times on A and B days from 12:15 to 3:50 p.m., and I'm happy to work around your schedule.

Thank you both, Zack Mark

E-074 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From Dr. Antoine Reed, Superintendent

To Zackary Mark; Karen Richmond

Date Nov 2, 2026, 12:31 PM

Topics Student council

Thread Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-075, E-076, E-077, E-078

Hi Zackary, Karen, I know November may be tough, but is it a time I can get to Zachary to hear him out? If so, I can make it happen, even if it's before school starts.

E-075 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Karen Richmond, Executive Assistant for the Superintendent and Board Leadership
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Nov 2, 2026, 6:35 PM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-076, E-077, E-078

Hi Zack,

Do you have availability to meet with Dr. Reed before school either this Wednesday, Nov 4th or next week Wednesday on Nov 11th?

Thanks, Karen

E-076 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Karen Richmond
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 2, 2026, 7:43 PM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-077, E-078

Hi Ms. Richmond,

Thank you for reaching out and helping coordinate this.

I would be available to meet with Dr. Reed on either Wednesday, November 4 or Wednesday, November 11. My preference would be sometime between 7:30 and 8:00 a.m.

I'm happy to accommodate whichever date works best for Dr. Reed.

I appreciate the opportunity to discuss the proposal and explore the next steps for establishing a district-wide Student Advisory Council.

Thank you again!

Best, Zack Mark

E-077 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Karen Richmond
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 11:36 AM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-078

Hi Zack,

Dr. Reed would be able to meet you at SPW in the main office at 7:50am tomorrow morning. Would that work?

Thanks, Karen

E-078 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Karen Richmond
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 1:59 PM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-067, E-068, E-069, E-070, E-071, E-072, E-073, E-074, E-075, E-076, E-077

Hi Ms. Richmond,

Thank you for coordinating this!

Yes, 7:50 a.m. tomorrow morning at Sun Prairie West works perfectly for me.

Please extend my thanks to Dr. Reed as well. I appreciate him taking the time to meet with me and hear more about the proposed District-Wide Student Advisory Council.

I look forward to discussing the proposal, potential next steps for the Spring 2027 pilot, and how we can establish a meaningful, sustainable structure for student voice across the district.

Thank you again for your help!

Best, Zack Mark

E-079 · Request for Assistance: Including Sun Prairie East Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Jim Ertel, Sun Prairie East (also sent to Sarah Dianich, Sun Prairie East, at 10:59 AM)
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 10:20 AM
Topics	Weighted grades · Student council · Newsletter · Board of Education · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-103, E-112, E-207, E-208

Dear Mr. Ertel,

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Zack Mark. I am a student at Sun Prairie West High School and the founder of SPASD Student Voice, a student-led effort that brings student feedback on safety, communication, transparency, and fairness to district leaders.

Background. This fall, Student Voice has:

- Participated in the district's weighted grades work group, whose plan goes to the Board of Education on November 9
- Secured a district commitment, confirmed in writing on October 21, to publish a student newsletter
- Launched a public website and regular progress reports (spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app)
- Proposed a district-wide Student Advisory Council to Dr. Reed for spring 2027

Why I am writing. So far, most student participation has come from one school. For student input to represent the whole district, it needs to include students from Sun Prairie East.

Request. Would you be willing to help in one of the following ways?

1. Connect me with a staff member, such as a student council or club advisor, who could share the opportunity with interested students
2. Share a brief invitation with East students (I would send it to you for approval first)
3. Advise me on the best way to reach East students

If the Student Advisory Council moves forward, East would hold four to six seats, and I would like interested students to be aware of it early.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully, Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School; Founder, SPASD Student Voice

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E-080 · Request for Assistance: Including Prairie Phoenix Academy Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Nehemirah Barrett, Prairie Phoenix Academy
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 10:20 AM
Topics	Student council

Dear Mr. Barrett,

(Same introduction and background as the Sun Prairie East letter.)

Why I am writing. Prairie Phoenix Academy students have a perspective that is often missing from district conversations, and I want to make sure it is included. The Student Advisory Council proposal reserves two seats for Prairie Phoenix students.

Request. Would you be willing to help in one of the following ways?

1. Connect me with a staff member who could share the opportunity with interested students
2. Share a brief invitation with your students (I would send it to you for approval first)
3. Advise me on meeting times, locations or transportation needs that would make participation realistic for Prairie Phoenix students

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully, Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School; Founder, SPASD Student Voice

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E-081 · Request for Guidance: Including Prairie View Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Michelle Jensen, Prairie View Middle School (the same letter went to Shawn Bartelt at Patrick Marsh and Mark Roth at Central Heights)
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 10:20 AM
Topics	Weighted grades · Student council · Newsletter · Surveys · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-082, E-083

Dear Ms. Jensen,

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Zack Mark. I am a student at Sun Prairie West High School and the founder of SPASD Student Voice, a student-led effort that brings student feedback on safety, communication, transparency, and fairness to district leaders.

Background. This fall, Student Voice has participated in the district's weighted grades work group, secured a district commitment to publish a student newsletter, launched a public website with regular progress reports (spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app), and proposed a district-wide Student Advisory Council to Dr. Reed for spring 2027.

Why I am writing. Many district decisions affect middle school students as much as high school students, and I would like Prairie View students' perspectives to be heard, particularly from 8th graders preparing for high school.

Request. Because these are middle school students, I would only reach out through channels that you and your staff approve. Would you be willing to help in one of the following ways?

1. Connect me with a staff member, such as a student council advisor, who could gather student input or share the opportunity
2. Share a brief invitation or survey with students (I would send it to you for approval first)

3. Advise me on the best way to include Prairie View students

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully, Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School; Founder, SPASD Student Voice

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E-082 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Prairie View Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Principal Michelle Jensen, Prairie View Middle School
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 3:53 PM
Thread	Same conversation: E-081, E-083

Thanks, Zach.

Which topic/topics are you primarily looking for feedback from them?

E-083 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Prairie View Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Michelle Jensen
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 3:55 PM
Topics	Student council · Surveys · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-081, E-082

Hi Ms. Jensen,

Thank you for getting back to me!

I'm primarily interested in gathering student perspectives on a few district-wide topics:

1. Student Safety & Communication: How students receive information following significant school incidents and whether they feel informed and supported.
2. Student Voice & Representation: How middle school students feel their perspectives are included in district decisions and what opportunities they'd like to have to participate.

3. Transition to High School: Particularly for 8th graders, what questions, concerns, and priorities they have as they prepare to enter high school.
4. District Communication: How effectively the district communicates announcements, policy changes, and important information to students.

I would especially value feedback from 8th graders because they are preparing to transition into high school and can offer a perspective that isn't always represented in district-level conversations.

I'm not looking to create additional responsibilities for your staff. I'd be happy to provide a short, district-approved survey or work with an existing student leadership group if that would be easier.

Thank you again for your willingness to help. I appreciate the opportunity to make sure Prairie View students have a voice in these conversations.

Best, Zack Mark

The District-Wide Student Council (from November 4)

After the November 4 morning meeting with Dr. Reed, the proposal grew from a high school advisory council into a District-Wide Student Council: 3–5 representatives from every middle and high school, grades 6–12, meeting with district leaders and Dr. Reed. At noon that day, invitations went to every middle and high school principal, each copied to Dr. Reed. What was said at the meeting itself is not recorded here.

E-084 · Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Prairie Phoenix Academy

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Nehemirah Barrett, Prairie Phoenix Academy
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 4, 2026, 12:00 PM
Topics	Student council · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-092

Dear Mr. Barrett,

I am reaching out to invite Prairie Phoenix Academy to participate in the development of a District-Wide Student Council for the Sun Prairie Area School District.

The proposed council would bring together approximately 3–5 representatives from each middle and high school, with student representation across grades 6–12. I want the council to reflect the full range of student experiences in SPASD, including students whose educational paths and school experiences may look different from those at a traditional comprehensive middle or high school.

Prairie Phoenix Academy's emphasis on building relationships, creating belonging, maintaining high expectations, communication, and accountability is especially relevant to this effort. Those ideas should be reflected in a council that gives students from different educational settings a genuine opportunity to shape district conversations.

I would appreciate your help identifying 3–5 students enrolled at Prairie Phoenix Academy who may be interested in representing their peers. I would want the selection process to be flexible and accessible, recognizing that students may have different schedules, responsibilities, and experiences.

The council's proposed areas of focus include student mental health and well-being, engagement and belonging, academic experiences, district events, family and community engagement, and student recommendations to district leadership.

Would you be available for a brief phone call or meeting to discuss how Prairie Phoenix Academy could participate and what structure would work

best for your students? I would also appreciate your recommendation for a staff point of contact who could help coordinate participation.

Thank you for considering this. It is important that a districtwide student council represents more than the largest or most traditional school communities. Prairie Phoenix Academy students should have a meaningful voice in the work as well.

Best, Zackary Mark Student Voice | District-Wide Student Council Initiative

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The same invitation, adapted to each school, went at the same time to Sun Prairie East (Principal Jim Ertel and Sarah Dianich), Sun Prairie West (Principal Peggy Shoemaker), Prairie View (Principal Michelle Jensen), Patrick Marsh (Principal Shawn Bartelt) and Central Heights (Mark Roth), all copied to Dr. Reed. Each letter tied the council to that school's own priorities, for example West's AVID, Developmental Designs and restorative practices, and Patrick Marsh's family engagement plan with its School Community Organization. Each asked for 3–5 student representatives (not only students already in leadership roles) and a staff point of contact.

E-085 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Patrick Marsh

From	Principal Shawn Bartelt, Patrick Marsh Middle School
To	Zackary Mark; Tiffany Kvalheim, school counselor
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 5, 2026, 9:01 AM
Topics	Student council

Good morning Zackary,

I think this is a wonderful idea! Creating opportunities for students to connect across buildings while developing their leadership skills is a great way to build relationships and strengthen our school community.

I'm including our school counselor, Mrs. Kvalheim, in this email, as she can help identify students who may be a good fit. She works closely with our Peer Ambassadors student group, and I envision 3–5 students from that group participating in this opportunity.

Is there a time next week that would work for you to connect virtually and discuss the next steps?

Enjoy your day!

E-086 · Re: District-Wide Student Council | Sun Prairie West Participation and Staff Sponsor

From	Principal Peggy Shoemaker, Sun Prairie West
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Nov 5, 2026, 9:29 AM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-087, E-090

Hello Zach, Perhaps a good starting point would be to go to Student Council to find student representation for your club. If you are looking for a faculty advisor, I suggest making sure you are registering with the ATHLETIC/ACTIVITIES as a club. Feel free to reach out to any faculty member from West who might be interested.

Ms, Shoemaker

E-087 · Re: District-Wide Student Council | Sun Prairie West Participation and Staff Sponsor

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Peggy Shoemaker
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 5, 2026, 9:57 AM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-086, E-090

Hi Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for the direction. I'll reach out to West's Student Council to find interested students and connect with the Athletics/Activities office about registering.

One quick question so I go through the right process: since the council would include students from every middle and high school and meet with Dr. Reed, should it still be registered as a West club, or is there a different

path for a district-level group? Either way, I'll follow whatever process works best.

I'll also reach out to West staff who might be interested in serving as a sponsor.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-088 · Registering a new student group: District-Wide Student Council

From	Zackary Mark
To	Eric Nee, Sun Prairie West
Date	Nov 5, 2026, 10:03 AM
Topics	Student council

Hi Mr. Nee,

My name is Zack Mark, and I'm a student at West. Ms. Shoemaker suggested I reach out to you about registering a new student group.

I'm starting a District-Wide Student Council for Sun Prairie. It would include 3–5 students from each middle and high school who meet regularly with district leaders and Superintendent Dr. Reed to share student input. Patrick Marsh has already agreed to take part, and I'm reaching out to the other schools now.

Could you help me with a few questions?

1. Is there a form or application I need to fill out to register?
2. What do you need from a staff sponsor?
3. Since the group includes students from other schools, is there anything different about registering it at West?
4. Do you have any suggestions for a West staff member who might have room to sponsor a new group? I know a lot of teachers are already busy with other activities, so I'd appreciate your recommendation. I'd handle the planning and communication myself, so the sponsor role should be fairly light.

I'm happy to stop by your office or meet whenever works best for you.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-089 · Could I share a District-Wide Student Council opportunity at your next meeting?

From Zackary Mark

To Gavin Christianson, Student Council adviser, Sun Prairie West

Cc Dr. Antoine Reed

Date Nov 5, 2026, 10:06 AM

Topics Student council

Hi Mr. Christianson,

My name is Zack Mark, and I'm a student at West. Ms. Shoemaker suggested I connect with Student Council about a new district-wide opportunity.

I'm starting a District-Wide Student Council for Sun Prairie. It would bring together 3–5 students from each middle and high school to meet regularly with district leaders and Superintendent Dr. Reed. Topics would include student well-being, belonging, academics, activities and other districtwide issues. It's meant to work alongside Student Council and Student Senate, not replace them, and give West students a voice at the district level too.

I'm looking for 3–5 West students across grades 9–12 who'd be interested, and I'd also love any members who want to help spread the word.

Would it be okay if I came to your next meeting for about 5 minutes to explain it and answer questions? If that doesn't work, I'm happy to send a short flyer you could share with members instead.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-090 · Re: District-Wide Student Council | Sun Prairie West Participation and Staff Sponsor

From Principal Peggy Shoemaker
To Zackary Mark
Date Nov 5, 2026, 12:08 PM
Topics Student council
Thread Same conversation: E-086, E-087

I definitely see what you mean. Since this is a District club, I really don't know what your next step would be....I think the West Athletics would not be the right move then,,,

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E-091 · District-Wide Student Council | Question on Registering a District-Level Group

From Zackary Mark
To Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 5, 2026, 12:49 PM
Topics Student council

Dear Dr. Reed,

I hope you're doing well. I'm following up on the District-Wide Student Council.

Ms. Shoemaker gave me some helpful direction. She suggested starting with West's Student Council to find student representatives and said that, for a faculty advisor, clubs usually register through the Athletics/Activities office.

When I asked whether that would still apply since the council would include students from every middle and high school, she agreed that it is a district group, so registering through West Athletics probably would not be the right fit. Neither of us was sure what the correct next step would be.

Could you point me toward the right process for setting up a district-level student group? Specifically:

- Who should the council register with, if not an individual school's Activities office?

- Should the staff sponsor come from one school, the district office, or should each school have its own point of contact?

I'm still planning to connect with West's Student Council and reach out to staff who might be interested, so I can keep things moving while we figure out the official path.

Thank you for your time and support.

Best, Zackary Mark

E-092 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Prairie Phoenix Academy

From	Principal Nehemirah Barrett, Prairie Phoenix Academy
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 5, 2026, 4:47 PM
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-084

Hi Zack,

I apologize for the delayed response. It has been a busy week, but I wanted to make sure I responded to your message.

First, I want to commend you for taking the initiative to advocate for student voice across our district. It is great to see students stepping into leadership roles and creating opportunities for their peers to be heard.

I appreciate you being intentional about including Prairie Phoenix Academy in this work. Our students bring valuable perspectives and experiences, and I agree that their voices should be represented in districtwide conversations.

I am supportive of this initiative and would be interested in learning more as the planning moves forward. As the structure and expectations for the council become clearer, we can explore how Prairie Phoenix students can meaningfully participate.

Thank you again for your leadership and for thinking of our students. Keep up the great work!

Best, Mr. Barrett

The Board's student representatives

E-093 · Question about the Board's student representatives

From Zackary Mark

To Karen Richmond, Executive Assistant for the Superintendent and Board Leadership

Date Nov 4, 2026, 12:00 PM

Thread Same conversation: E-094

Hi Ms. Richmond,

I hope you're doing well. Students have been asking about the School Board's student representatives, and I want to make sure I share accurate information.

The district website says the Board appoints two non-voting student members who serve one-year terms. Could you help me with two questions?

1. How are the student representatives chosen, and when does the application open each year?
2. What's the best way for students to share ideas or concerns with them?

I'll share your answer with students word for word through SPASD Student Voice. Thank you for your help.

Best, Zack Mark

E-094 · Re: Question about the Board's student representatives

From Karen Richmond
To Zackary Mark
Date Nov 5, 2026, 11:52 AM
Topics Board of Education
Thread Same conversation: E-093

Hi Zack,

Thank you for reaching out with your questions. Student representatives actually serve a two-year term, taking office at the end of their sophomore year and serving through the end of their senior year. The recruitment process for new junior representatives usually gets underway in December, and applications generally open in mid-January for current sophomores. The School Board Member Selection Committee will interview candidates and vote on a candidate for each open seat, typically prior to Spring Break. I'm including the link to Board Procedure 3: Student Representatives to the School Board, which may help in answering any other questions you might have.

Students are always welcome to reach out to the student representatives at any time; the current SPW reps are [two students, names removed in this record]. The student representatives have been discussing ways to be more visible at their schools, feel free to connect with them to get more details.

Please let me know if you have any other questions.

Thanks! Karen

Follow-ups (November 4–6)

E-095 · Thank you, and next steps on the student council pilot

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Antoine Reed
Cc	Karen Richmond
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM
Topics	Student council

Dear Dr. Reed,

Thank you for meeting with me before school on November 4. I appreciated you taking the time to hear about the student council pilot.

Here's what I understood as our next steps:

- Email Administration at SPE, SPW, PPA, PMMS, PVMS, & CHMS
- Develop Pilot Program for a District Student Council
- Create a schedule and calendar with ideas for talking points

Please let me know if I missed anything. With your permission, I'd like to share a short summary on SPASD Student Voice, so students know where things stand.

Thank you again, Zack Mark

E-096 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Sun Prairie East

From	Sarah Dianich, LT Principal Substitute, Sun Prairie East
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Principal Jim Ertel; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 3:13 PM
Topics	Student council · Newsletter

Good afternoon, Zackary -

Apologies for the delay. I truly appreciate your advocacy. Just to confirm, the Student Voice group has been approved as a district/school sponsored activity, correct? If so, I can:

1. Connect you with a staff member - once we have your invitation, we can ask our student council advisors to share it.

2. Share a brief invitation with East students - I could put this in our weekly newsletter.
3. Advise you on the best way to reach East students - I would say that a clear, concise invitation (slide, poster) that we could share in SP30 might be the most effective way to reach East students.

Have a great weekend.

E-097 · Re: Recap and draft public report: Student Voice & District Engagement, Oct 20

From	Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr., Director of Systemic Equity and Inclusion
To	Marlita Bevenue
Cc	Zackary Mark
Date	Nov 4, 2026, 11:44 AM
Thread	Same conversation: E-060, E-061, E-098

Good morning Zachary,

I'm a little late to the conversation, but I want to echo Marlita's sentiments. I appreciate your leadership, thoughtfulness, and commitment to elevating student voice across our district. Thank you for taking the time to meet with us and for your continued advocacy on behalf of your peers.

I look forward to continuing our conversations and exploring opportunities to strengthen student voice and engagement across our system. Dr. Morgan

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E-098 · Re: Recap and draft public report: Student Voice & District Engagement, Oct 20

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Michael Morgan; Marlita Bevenue
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM
Topics	Student council · Newsletter · Surveys
Thread	Same conversation: E-060, E-061, E-097

Dr. Morgan,

Thank you for the kind words, and thank you again to both of you for meeting with me in October.

I'd like to set up the follow-up meeting we talked about so we can cover the items we ran out of time for: the pilot student advisory council and a staff partner for it, sharing the student survey through district channels, a recurring student-district check-in, and one "you said, we did" update this semester.

Would any time in the next two to three weeks work for you both? I'm generally free before 8 AM or after school, and I'm happy to work around your schedules.

Ms. Bevenue, I'm also looking forward to the first district newsletter going out to students this month.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-099 · An idea for the student newsletter: Board agendas in plain language

From	Zackary Mark
To	Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM
Topics	Newsletter

Hi Ms. Bevenue,

Thank you again for opening the district newsletters to students. One idea for a recurring piece: a two- or three-sentence, plain-language summary of what's on the next Board agenda that affects students, with a link to the full agenda and how to sign up for public comment.

Students often don't know a decision is coming until it's already made. A short heads-up would help, and I'd be happy to help draft or review the first few if that's useful.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-100 · Two ideas for hearing from students

From Zackary Mark

To Board President Diana McFarland

Date Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Topics Weighted grades · Board of Education

Dear President McFarland,

Thank you for the Board's openness to students this year, from the Act 95 hearing in January to the weighted grades presentation on November 9. I have two ideas I'd like to ask about.

First, would the Board consider a short, recurring student update on regular meeting agendas, for example, five minutes once a month? It could be given by the Board's student representatives, with input gathered from students at every high school. It would give the Board a steady read on what students are seeing before decisions reach a vote, and give students a predictable way to be heard.

Second, students often ask what Board members actually do. Would you, or another Board member, be willing to answer five short written questions for SPASD Student Voice? I'd post the answers word for word.

1. What does a typical week look like for a Board member?
2. What's the hardest kind of decision the Board makes?
3. How do student comments change your thinking?
4. What do you wish students knew about the Board?
5. What's the best way for a student to reach the Board?

I'd be glad to talk about either idea. Thank you for considering them.

Respectfully, Zack Mark

E-101 · Could you check two student guides for accuracy?

From Zackary Mark
To Keith Medema
Date Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM
Topics Weighted grades
Thread Same conversation: E-106

Hi Mr. Medema,

I made two short guides on the SPASD Student Voice site for students: an Act 95 checklist ("I might be top 10%, now what?") and an AP vs. dual credit vs. capstone chart. Before more students use them, would you be willing to check them for accuracy? Both are on the Learn tab at spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app. Any corrections are welcome.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-102 · A 30-minute lesson on a real SPASD decision

From Zackary Mark
To Caryn Peters
Date Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM
Topics Weighted grades

Hi,

Would you be interested in a 30-minute class activity on a real district decision? Students would learn how weighted grades move from a work group to a Board vote (10 minutes), play the "You're on the Board" simulation (10 minutes), and write optional comments to the Board (10 minutes). Everything is on the Learn tab of spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app. I'm happy to lead it or just share materials.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-103 · Re: Request for Assistance: Including Sun Prairie East Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Sarah Dianich, Sun Prairie East
Cc	Principal Jim Ertel; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 8, 2026, 2:43 PM
Attachments	SP30 slide and poster
Topics	Student council
Thread	Same conversation: E-079, E-112, E-207, E-208

Hi Ms. Dianich,

Thank you for getting back to me, and for the ideas on reaching East students.

To answer your question directly: not yet. The council isn't formally approved as a district or school sponsored activity. When I met with Dr. Reed on November 4, he asked me to reach out to each school's administration and build a pilot plan, which is the step I'm on now. I've kept him copied so he can correct anything I've missed.

I made the slide and poster you suggested for SP30 and attached both. They describe it as a student-led pilot and ask interested students to email me. I'm happy to change anything, or to hold them until the pilot is approved if you'd prefer to wait.

When the time is right, I'd be grateful if your student council advisors could pass it along.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-104 · A free way for local businesses to support student voice

From Zackary Mark
To Sun Prairie Area Chamber of Commerce
Date Nov 9, 2026, 8:00 AM
Topics Newsletter

Hello,

My name is Zack Mark, and I'm a student in the Sun Prairie Area School District. I run SPASD Student Voice, a student-led project that helps students and families ask the district questions and see the answers.

I'm looking for local businesses willing to put a small counter card by their register for a month. It has a QR code, and the slogan is "Your school. Your say." There's no cost, and we'd thank each business on our Instagram.

Would the Chamber be willing to share this with members in a newsletter, or point me to a few businesses that might be interested? I'm happy to send the card design or stop by the office.

Thank you, Zack Mark

Follow-ups (November 7–10)

E-105 · Questions about the superintendent licensing situation

From Zackary Mark
To President Diana McFarland and members of the Board of Education
Date Nov 7, 2026, 7:00 AM

Dear President McFarland and members of the Board,

My name is Zack Mark, and I run SPASD Student Voice. I'm writing about the WMTV 15 report on Dr. Reed's Wisconsin superintendent license.

According to that report, DPI denied Dr. Reed's application on October 7, and DPI says it told Dr. Reed and President McFarland in August that he wasn't eligible. The report also says his contract requires a valid Wisconsin license at all times.

I'm not writing to attack Dr. Reed. Licensing rules for out-of-state hires are complicated, and I've appreciated his openness to working with students. But students and families learned about this from a news report. That's the part I think the board needs to address.

I'd like to ask the board to answer these questions publicly:

1. When did the full board learn that Dr. Reed was not eligible for a Wisconsin license?
2. Why wasn't this shared with the public before the October 26 meeting?
3. Who is currently authorized to carry out the duties that require a licensed superintendent?
4. Does the board plan to enforce, waive, or renegotiate the licensing requirement in the contract?
5. What is the realistic timeline for Dr. Reed to become fully licensed, and what happens if that doesn't work out?

Clear answers to these would go a long way toward rebuilding trust. I'm happy to talk with any of you about this, and I plan to share the board's response with students through SPASD Student Voice.

Thank you for your time.

Zack Mark

E-106 · Re: Could you check two student guides for accuracy?

From	Keith Medema, School Counselor, Sun Prairie West
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Nov 9, 2026, 2:10 PM
Topics	Weighted grades
Thread	Same conversation: E-101

Hi Zack, As you know we are still waiting for some final decisions regarding weighted grades. The other items look accurate. Once we learn more details regarding the weighted grades, please schedule a time to meet with me so that we can review the items to ensure that everything is correct. Thanks, Mr. Medema

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E-107 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Central Heights

From Principal Mark Roth, Central Heights Middle School
To Zackary Mark
Cc Jennifer Loranger
Date Nov 10, 2026, 7:05 AM
Topics Student council
Thread Same conversation: E-108

Hello Zackary,

Thank you for the information. Central Heights has a Student Council that meets regularly with our building leaders to share their student voice within our building. As you describe a district wide organization, I think it would be best to start with our current building group of leaders. Jen Loranger is our staff member that leads our Student Council. Could you reach out to her to begin this process?

E-108 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Central Heights

From Zackary Mark
To Principal Mark Roth; Jennifer Loranger
Cc Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 10, 2026, 10:59 AM
Topics Student council
Thread Same conversation: E-107

Hi Mr. Roth,

Thank you for getting back to me and for connecting me with Ms. Loranger. Starting with your current Student Council makes a lot of sense.

Hi Ms. Loranger,

It's nice to meet you. I'm working on a District-Wide Student Council that would bring together a few student representatives from each middle and high school to share feedback with district leaders. Since your Student Council already meets with building leaders, it seems like a natural fit for Central Heights.

Would you have 15 to 20 minutes for a quick call, Google Meet, or in-person meeting in the next week or two? I can walk you through how the council would work and answer any questions. I'm usually free after school, but I'm happy to work around your schedule.

Thank you both, Zack Mark

E-109 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Patrick Marsh Students in SPASD Student Voice

From Principal Shawn Bartelt, Patrick Marsh
To Zackary Mark
Date Nov 9, 2026, 12:48 PM
Thread Same conversation: E-110, E-111

Good afternoon,

3pm on Thursday works best for Mrs. Kvalheim and me. Would you want to connect virtually or come to Patrick Marsh to meet with us?

We are looking forward to connecting with you!

Mr. Bartelt

E-110 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Patrick Marsh Students in SPASD Student Voice

From Zackary Mark
To Principal Shawn Bartelt; Tiffany Kvalheim
Cc Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 10, 2026, 11:03 AM
Thread Same conversation: E-109, E-111

Good morning,

3pm on Thursday works great for me as well. Could we meet in person at Patrick Marsh? Thank you & I can't wait to meet you both!

Best, Zack Mark

E-111 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Patrick Marsh Students in SPASD Student Voice

From Tiffany Kvalheim, School Counselor, Patrick Marsh
To Zackary Mark
Cc Principal Shawn Bartelt; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 10, 2026, 11:18 AM
Thread Same conversation: E-109, E-110

Hi Zack,

We look forward to meeting you as well. I sent us a calendar invite. With it being the end of the day here, cars will be lining up in our main driveway. I would recommend entering the staff driveway off of Stone Quarry Rd and parking in any space that is available. We will meet you in the front office. Thank you, Tiffany

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E-112 · Re: Request for Assistance: Including Sun Prairie East Students in SPASD Student Voice

From Sarah Dianich, LT Principal Substitute, Sun Prairie East
To Zackary Mark
Cc Principal Jim Ertel; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 10, 2026, 12:23 PM
Thread Same conversation: E-079, E-103, E-207, E-208

Thank you for your response, Zackary -

Unfortunately, I cannot share this with students until this is a school-sponsored program. Do you have a timeline for that?

Follow-ups (November 10–11)

NEW IN v3.1 E-207 · Re: Request for Assistance: Including Sun Prairie East Students in SPASD Student Voice

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To Sarah Dianich <skdiani@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Nov 11, 2026, 10:35 AM

Thread Same conversation: E-079, E-103, E-112, E-208

Good afternoon, Ms. Dianich,

Thank you for letting me know. That makes sense.

I don't have a firm timeline yet. I've asked Dr. Reed how a district-level student group should be registered and who would sponsor it, and I'm meeting with schools this month to build the pilot plan he asked for. I'll hold the slide and poster until the council is approved, and I'll let you know as soon as it is.

Thank you for your patience, and for being willing to help when the time comes.

Best, Zack Mark

NEW IN v3.1 E-208 · Re: Request for Assistance: Including Sun Prairie East Students in SPASD Student Voice

From Sarah Dianich <skdiani@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Nov 11, 2026, 11:33 AM

Thread Same conversation: E-079, E-103, E-112, E-207

Sounds good, thank you, Zack!

NEW IN v3.1 E-209 · Re: Student voice survey: draft for your review before December

From Carolyn Pao (for Dr. Michael Morgan) <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc Dr. Michael Morgan <mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Nov 10, 2026, 12:10 PM
Topics Surveys
Thread Same conversation: E-210, E-211

Hello Zack (it's Pao)!

Thank you for reaching out and I will be happy to assist to set up some time for Dr. Morgan to meet with you virtually. Are these still the times that are your non-core class times? [Times listed.] If so, please let me know what would be the best date/time that would work for you: Tuesday, November 17; Wednesday, November 18; or Thursday, November 19, 12:15–3:50 p.m.

Pao Administrative Associate, The Department of Systemic Equity & Inclusion

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NEW IN v3.1 E-210 · Re: Student voice survey: draft for your review before December

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Carolyn Pao <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Nov 11, 2026, 10:38 AM
Topics Surveys
Thread Same conversation: E-209, E-211

Hi Ms. Pao,

Thank you for helping set this up. Yes, those are still my non-core class times.

Wednesday, November 18, between 12:30 and 3:30 would work best for me. If that's taken, anytime between 12:15 and 3:30 on Thursday, November 19, also works.

Thank you, Zack Mark

NEW IN v3.1 E-211 · Re: Student voice survey: draft for your review before December

From Carolyn Pao <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc Dr. Michael Morgan <mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Nov 11, 2026, 11:10 AM
Topics Surveys
Thread Same conversation: E-209, E-210

Thank you Zack for the prompt response!

I scheduled a virtual 1-hour meeting on November 18 from 1:50-2:50 pm. I also included Marlita in case she can make it!

Let us know if you have any additional questions or concerns.

Best, Pao

NEW IN v3.1 E-212 · Records Request Acknowledgement

From SPASD Records Request <recordsrequest@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
Date Nov 11, 2026, 3:11 PM
Topics Weighted grades · Records requests · Safety & mental health

Good afternoon,

This email serves as formal acknowledgement of your records request which you submitted to our records request email that was received by our office on November 11, 2026. The Office of the Superintendent is the official custodian of District records. In your request you asked for the following District records:

"1. Contracts and data privacy agreements for any student monitoring or device management tools used on district Chromebooks or networks.

2. Materials from the weighted grades work group that haven't been shared with members yet, including any data the district is using to guide the decision.

3. Aggregate data on safety incidents at district schools for the 2024–25 school year and the current year so far. I'm only looking for totals and

categories, with no individual student information."

Please note that under District Policy KBG the district must complete this request as soon as practicable and without delay or inform you if that will not be possible. The District may also charge you a fee to locate these records if the cost will exceed $50. I will let you know if that is a possibility before we run the request and we may ask you to prepay those costs before we proceed. In addition if you would like copies of anything the charge is 10 cents per sheet (if over 10 pages).

Pertinent policies and procedures: Policy KBG, Access to Public Records; Exhibit KBG-E(1) Access to Public Records; Exhibit KBG-E(2) Public Records Fees.

Sun Prairie Area School District, Office of the Superintendent

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October 20 Meeting: Pre-Read & Discussion Guide

Prepared by Zackary, October 15, 2026. An independent, student-led summary for discussion, not an official SPASD document.

Meeting at a glance

This meeting's aim is shared: agree on one or two concrete next steps that make student voice a regular, documented part of how SPASD listens and decides.

- When: Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 1:30–2:30 PM
- Where: Sun Prairie West High School, Room 1202
- Who: Dr. Michael Morgan, Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion · Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications · Zackary Mark, Student Advocate, SPWHS
- Coordinated by: Carolyn Pao

Agenda

- 1:30 — Welcome, purpose, and how we'll keep notes
- 1:35 — Work since January: what's moved and what's still open
- 1:50 — Goals and vision, including a District Student Advisory Council
- 2:05 — Building a district-wide student group
- 2:15 — Next steps: owners and dates

Work since January

Since January 2026, student input has helped produce a Student Senate at West, student seats in two leadership searches, and an active weighted grades policy effort.

- Oct 1 — Title IX changes and LGBTQIA+ protections, with Dr. Tricia Rodey: district protections confirmed unchanged; reporting through Speak Up Speak Out being strengthened; idea raised for a student-friendly know-your-rights resource.

- Aug 27 — Student voice, leadership, climate and Senate follow-up, with Dr. Taren Turner and Janet Thomas: discussion of lasting structures for student–district collaboration.
- Aug 18 — How the district budget is built, with Matt Clark: shared understanding of the five-year forecast, staffing costs and fund balance.
- August — Student voice under new leadership, with Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed: discussed a district-wide Student Advisory Council that lasts through leadership changes.
- Apr 27 — Student Senate election at SPWHS: 9 senators elected, 3 per rising grade.
- Apr 13 — Superintendent finalist session: students questioned every candidate.
- Apr 3 & 7 — SPWHS principal interviews: students served on the interview panel.
- Mar 2 — Student advocacy meeting, with Dr. Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Principal Peggy Shoemaker and staff: student seats in the principal search; Senate planning; clearer mandated-reporting info for students.
- Feb 26 – now — Weighted grades work group, with Dr. Curtis Mould, students and staff: consensus on a 5.0 scale; caregiver survey finalized; Board first reading targeted for early November.
- Jan 26 — Act 95 public hearing, Board of Education: 31 students presented survey findings and a recommendation.
- Jan 13 — Student Safety, Trust & a Proposed Framework, Board of Education: Board response Jan 20; led to the meetings above.

The same transparency questions have also been raised with the city, through meetings with Police Chief Kevin Warych on license plate reader cameras.

What students have said

Most students in early outreach said they feel physically safe at school; the gap is trust that adults will follow through when they speak

up.

- Safety and communication: after serious incidents, students often learn what happened from rumors or social media first.
- Consistency and accountability: discipline and follow-up can feel different from one building to the next.
- Voice and follow-through: students feel heard symbolically rather than systemically, and rarely learn what their input changed.

> "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen." — a student, winter 2026

These early responses were voluntary and not a statistical sample. The bilingual climate survey (12 questions, English and Spanish, open to students, families, staff and community) is meant to fill that gap; results to date will be shared at the meeting.

- 31 students: Act 95 group that presented at the January 26 Board hearing (Act 95 group materials)
- 38%: high schoolers in a district survey interested in weighting all classes (SPASD weighted grades staff survey)
- 9 senators: elected at SPWHS in April 2026, 3 from each rising grade (April 2026 progress report)
- 5% / 10%: Act 95 class-rank cutoffs for guaranteed UW–Madison / other UW admission (2023 Wisconsin Act 95)
- 3 reports: public reports on student safety, voice and progress, February to spring 2026

Survey link: forms.gle/9ULwNASeJFceHkCy8

The proposal: a District Student Advisory Council pilot

The proposal is a one-semester pilot of a small, district-wide student council with a staff partner, reviewed before it expands. Every detail below is a starting point for discussion.

- Members: students from Prairie View, Patrick Marsh and Central Heights middle schools, East, West and Prairie Phoenix Academy,

across grades and backgrounds

- Selection: a short application plus a fair draw, so it reaches beyond the students who are already involved
- Staff partner: one named district staff member who keeps records and follow-through, without directing recommendations
- Meetings: regular, on a set calendar with district leadership; agendas posted 24–48 hours ahead, minutes within 72 hours
- Role: advisory; consulted on major student-facing changes before they are final
- Relationship to existing groups: works alongside the SPW Student Senate and the student Board representatives, not in place of them
- Pilot length: one semester, then a review of what worked

How a student concern would become action:

1. Students raise an issue through the survey, a Senate, a club or a council member.
2. The council gathers input from more schools and documents it.
3. A written recommendation goes to district leadership.
4. The district responds in writing: yes, no, or not yet, and why.
5. A short public update tells students what changed, what didn't, and why.

Where each office could fit:

- Strategic Communications: student-facing messages after serious incidents, channels that reach students, and a home for public updates (step 5).
- Systemic Equity & Inclusion: a membership that reaches students who are usually underrepresented, Spanish-language access, and climate and belonging across buildings.

Discussion questions

Starred ones are the priority if time runs short.

Where we agree on the goal

- ★ If student voice in SPASD is working well by June 2027, what would each of us see that we don't see today?
- Has a student ever changed a district decision this year? If so, how did students find out?
- Which district goals this year could students help with most?

Communication (Strategic Communications)

- ★ After a serious incident, how is it decided what students are told, how fast, and by whom? What legally can't be shared, and how can we explain those limits to students?
- Which channels does the district know actually reach students, and how is that measured?
- What would a twice-a-year "you said, we did" update need in order to be realistic: who writes it, where it lives, and who approves it?

Equity and inclusion (Systemic Equity & Inclusion)

- ★ Which student groups are hardest for the district to hear from today, and what has worked when you have reached them?
- How should council members be chosen so it isn't the same small group of already-involved students?
- What existing focus groups, affinity groups or listening sessions could a council build on instead of starting from scratch?

Making a student group last

- ★ Which office or role is the right long-term home for a district student council?
- What upcoming decisions this year could get student input before they are final?
- What would make this pilot worth continuing after one semester, and what would tell us to change course?
- How should a council connect with the SPW Student Senate, the student Board representatives, and the superintendent?

Commitments

- ★ What is one thing each of us will do in the next 30 days?
- Who owns follow-up, and when do we meet next?

Next steps (owners and dates to be filled in at the meeting)

- Share the climate survey through district channels
- Name a staff partner for a pilot advisory council
- Set a recurring student–district check-in
- Publish one "you said, we did" update this semester
- Other steps agreed in the meeting

A written recap will follow within two school days.

October 20 Meeting: Slides

21-slide deck for the October 20 meeting (an earlier 16-slide draft had the same content). Slides that repeat the pre-read are not repeated here.

Questions to ask at the start: Is it OK if I record or take notes? Can you help share the survey? May I leave a handout with you? Can we set future meetings?

Where it started: the Student Safety & Trust Framework (January 13, 2026)

- Acknowledge & communicate: tell students when serious incidents happen, even when details can't be shared.
- Explain safety & reporting: one clear, district-wide overview of how concerns are reported and resolved.
- Consistent protocols: the same conduct and safety standards in every SPASD building.
- Stronger student voice: formal advisory structures with a required response from administration.
- Proactive wellness: advisory time, manageable counselor caseloads, clear paths to help.
- Review & reflect: regular climate surveys and public reporting on progress.

Ten months of conversations

Jan 13 Safety & Trust Framework (Board) · Jan 26 Act 95 hearing (Board of Education) · Feb–now weighted GPA group (Dr. Mould) · Mar 2 advocacy meeting (Student Senate) · Apr 3 & 7 principal interviews (student panel) · Apr 13 superintendent finalists · May 5 2024 concerns (Nicholas Reichhoff) · Jul 10 ALPR cameras (Chief Warych) · August Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed · Aug 18 district budget (Matt Clark) · Aug 27 voice & mental health (Dr. Turner) · Sep 25 ALPR follow-up, Flock to Axon · Oct 1 Title IX & LGBTQIA+ (Dr. Rodey) · Oct 7 Public

Safety Committee (City Hall)

What has already moved

- Done: Student Senate launched at SPWHS for 2026–27, seeded by the Act 95 groups
- Done: students interviewed principal candidates and met superintendent finalists
- Done: LGBTQIA+ protections confirmed in writing after the federal Title IX change
- In progress: weighted grades policy, criteria now, Board first reading targeted for November
- In progress: faster review of reports through changes to Speak Up Speak Out

The gaps that remain

- Student-facing incident messaging: students still hear about serious incidents through rumors and social media first.
- Reporting, explained for students: when reports escalate, when families are told, and what students can expect.
- Voice beyond one building: the Senate covers West. Middle schoolers, East and PPA students need a regular path in, too.
- Closing the loop: students rarely hear back on what changed, what didn't, and why.

Status from Student Advocacy Report #2: communication improvements "in development," system-level implementation "pending."

Five goals for 2026–27

1. Field the climate survey district-wide and share the results publicly
2. Pilot a District Student Advisory Council with middle and high schools
3. Set regular student–district meetings on a calendar, not by request

4. Back the Student Senate's first action plan, including weighted grades
5. Publish "you said, we did" updates so students see where input went

The council idea was discussed with Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed in August as a way to make student voice "a consistent part of SPASD rather than something that changes with leadership transitions." The council would have a written charter and a staff owner, so it survives any one superintendent or student. Step 5 of the process, the public update, "is the one students almost never see today, and it's the one that builds trust."

Where the two offices fit, as listed on the slides: Strategic Communications helps students understand the why, not just the what (messages after serious incidents, channels that reach students, a home for "you said, we did" updates, getting the survey to every family). Systemic Equity & Inclusion helps make sure every student has a way in, not the same few (seats for PPA and underrepresented groups, Spanish-language access from day one, climate and belonging across buildings, a student-built know-your-rights guide).

The climate feedback survey

Open to students, families, staff and community members. 12 questions in English and Spanish. Results shared only in aggregate. Four focus areas, set in meetings with district leaders: a Student Senate or advisory structure; student involvement in leadership decisions; communication and transparency on safety, policy and services; trust and consistency across schools.

Sample questions: Do students have a meaningful voice in district decisions? Rate communication to students about important issues, 1 to 5. Should students have a role in choosing principals or superintendents?

The pieces already exist

- SPW Student Senate: 9 elected senators building their first action plan
- Act 95 & weighted grades students: East and West students already working with district staff
- SPASD Student Voice: the survey, public reports and @spasdstudentvoice
- Missing link: one district-level table where they meet, plus middle schoolers and PPA, with a staff owner who keeps it going.

Closing slide: "Student voice should move beyond being heard to being meaningfully connected to action."

October 20 Meeting: Pamphlet & Handout

Tri-fold pamphlet (outside and inside) and the one-page meeting handout.

WHY IT MATTERS

SAFE, BUT NOT ALWAYS HEARD

In outreach across SPASD in early 2026, most students said they feel physically safe at school. Fewer were sure adults follow through when they speak up.

Safety & communication
After incidents, students often learn from rumors first.

Consistency & accountability
Follow-up can feel different from building to building.

Voice & follow-through
Students feel heard symbolically, not systemically.

> *"Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen."*
>
> A student, winter 2026

GET INVOLVED

ADD YOUR VOICE

Take the climate survey
12 questions in English or Spanish. For students, families, staff and community members.

forms.gle/9ULwNASeJFceHkCy8

Follow along
Instagram: @spasdstudentvoice

Get in touch
Zackary Mark
zackarymark160@gmail.com
(608) 940-7356

An independent, student-led effort. Not an official publication of the Sun Prairie Area School District. Survey answers are shared only in aggregate.

SPASD STUDENT VOICE

STUDENT VOICE, BUILT TO LAST

How students and district leaders can turn feedback into action across the Sun Prairie Area School District.

Prepared by Zackary Mark
Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School
October 2026

Pamphlet, outside

01 · WHERE WE'VE BEEN

FROM ONE EMAIL TO A SEAT AT THE TABLE

Jan	Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board; Act 95 students present at a public hearing
Feb	Weighted grades work group starts with district staff
Mar	Student advocacy meeting with school and district leaders
Apr	Students interview principal candidates, meet superintendent finalists, and elect a Student Senate
Aug	Conversations on budget, mental health and student voice, including new Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed
Fall	LGBTQIA+ protections confirmed after federal Title IX changes; weighted grades policy work continues

02 · WHAT'S CHANGED

REAL RESULTS, SO FAR

31 students in the Act 95 group

9 Student Senators elected at West

38% of high schoolers surveyed interested in weighted grades

3 public progress reports

Already done

✓ Student Senate launched for 2026–27

✓ Students on the principal interview panel

✓ Students heard from superintendent finalists

Still open

Clearer messages to students after incidents, reporting explained in plain language, and a way for students to see what their input changed.

03 · WHERE WE'RE GOING

A DISTRICT STUDENT ADVISORY COUNCIL

Who: students from every middle and high school, PPA included

When: regular meetings with district leaders

What: climate, communication, and input before decisions

Built to last: a charter and staff partner that outlive any one leader

How input becomes action

1. Students raise an issue
2. The council gathers more input
3. A written recommendation goes in
4. The district answers in writing
5. **Everyone sees what changed**

STUDENT VOICE SHOULD MOVE BEYOND BEING HEARD TO BEING MEANINGFULLY CONNECTED TO ACTION.

Pamphlet, inside

MEETING HANDOUT · TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026 · SPWHS ROOM 1202

STUDENT VOICE & DISTRICT ENGAGEMENT

For Dr. Michael Morgan, Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion, and Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications. Prepared by Zackary Mark, Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School.

PURPOSE

Make student voice a regular, documented part of how SPASD listens and decides, so it lasts beyond any one student, principal or superintendent.

WORK SINCE JANUARY 2026

- Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board (Jan 13)
- Act 95 group of 31 students presented to the Board (Jan 26)
- Weighted grades work group with Dr. Curtis Mould (Feb to now)
- Advocacy meeting that helped launch the SPW Student Senate
- Students on the principal interview panel and superintendent finalist session
- Conversations with Dr. Reed, Dr. Turner, Ms. Thomas, Mr. Clark and Dr. Rodey
- Bilingual climate survey and three public progress reports

WHAT STUDENTS TOLD US

Safety & communication: after incidents, students often hear rumors first.

Consistency: follow-up feels different from building to building.

Follow-through: students feel heard symbolically, not systemically.

PROPOSAL: A DISTRICT STUDENT ADVISORY COUNCIL

Who: students from all three middle schools, East, West and PPA, across grades and backgrounds

When: regular meetings with district leadership, with agendas and minutes

What: school climate, communication, student experience, input before decisions

Built to last: a written charter, a staff partner, and public "you said, we did" updates

WHERE YOUR OFFICES FIT

Strategic Communications: student-facing messages, channels that reach students, and a home for public updates.

Systemic Equity & Inclusion: making sure every group has a way in, Spanish access, and climate and belonging across buildings.

QUESTIONS FOR TODAY

1. What does meaningful student voice look like to your offices?
2. Where could students give input before a decision, not after?
3. Who on staff could own an ongoing student group?
4. How should students hear back on what changed and why?

NEXT STEPS

Meeting handout

October 20 Meeting Notes (both meetings)

Both meetings on October 20 were audio recorded with permission. The raw auto-transcripts are not reproduced here: they are garbled in places and include other students' names. These notes come from Zackary's handwritten notes and the recordings. District staff statements are summarized, not quoted word for word.

Student Voice & District Engagement — 1:30–2:30 PM, Room 1202

Handwritten notes, typed up:

- Who: Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr., Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion; Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications
- Where: Sun Prairie West High School, Room 1202
- Time: 1:30 p.m. → 2:30 p.m.
- Reminders: audio recording; handouts; survey; future meeting

Q1 (slide 7): after a serious incident, how is it decided what students are told, how fast, and by whom?

- What counts as a "serious incident"?
- Some incidents don't directly impact students
- Age, severity, etc. decide whom and when
- Leadership decides who sends it
- Can't share: confidential records
- HS = emails; certain info protected by law
- Employee protections

Comms team

- Works with leaders of individual schools
- Confirm facts, determine what students need to know
- Review/coordination — Ms. Bevenue
- No names

District newsletters

- Families, and students as part of the household
- Not intentional that students didn't get them
- Thinking about audience
- Not withholding info
- Comms looks at it through multiple lenses
- Info from students isn't verified
- Communicate with students directly

June 2027 question

- Survey students about what student voice should look like / sound like
- Then set goals
- Student/family newsletters — November
- About 8,500 students, 4K–12
- Benchmarks → goals
- Student body perspectives

From the recording:

- Dr. Morgan said his answers were his own understanding, not a formal district communication protocol. He gave the example of a student struck by a vehicle the week before at another school: students at West likely wouldn't get a message because it didn't directly affect them.
- Ms. Bevenue described the steps: safety first, then her office works with the principal and district leadership to confirm facts and decide what each audience needs to know. Messages come from the principal, district leadership or the superintendent depending on severity, and more information follows as it's confirmed. Names, individual consequences, student records and personnel matters can't be shared.
- Zackary said he'd never received a district newsletter in four years. Ms. Bevenue said newsletters launching in November with Dr. Reed will go to all students. Dr. Morgan called it a process improvement,

not intentional.

- Zackary asked for short factual messages even without names, naming the specific law when something can't be shared, and "you said, we did" updates.
- On June 2027: Dr. Morgan said the first step is to survey students on what good student voice looks and sounds like, then set goals with benchmarks (a few changes by June 2027, more by fall 2027, and onward). Ms. Bevenue said students should be able to name something that changed because they spoke up, and hear back on every idea, even when the answer is no.
- Dr. Morgan's feedback: the survey should reach all three high schools, all four grade levels, and a racially and gender-diverse range of students.
- Time ran out before the advisory council and equity questions.

Weighted Grades Work Group — 10:00–10:40 AM (Google Meet)

From the recording:

- The 5.0 scale criteria from Oct 15 stand: capstone classes, tryout-based music courses, and classes earning industry certification or college credit, except college classes that match what the high school offers or don't transfer to UW schools.
- Example given: Calc 2 at Madison College would be weighted because it transfers to UW schools, even though the high school offers Calc BC. Start College Now and a Madison College PE class would not.
- Next step: counselors go through the full list of Madison College classes. Weighted classes will be marked in the course guide.
- Roll-in decision: students agreed it should start with next year's freshmen (Class of 2031) in 2027–28, because current students already chose classes under the old system. Zackary agreed. Ms. Wendorf confirmed Infinite Campus can handle it.
- Students raised concerns about clear language and communication when only freshmen have weighted grades. Dr. Mould said there's

no way to make everyone happy, so clarity and transparency matter most.

- Dr. Mould will put together a one-page "decision on a page" communication package for the group to review.
- Students on the SPW Student Senate will share it with the Senate the following Wednesday.
- Next: the student group previews the decision at the Teaching & Learning Committee on Monday, November 2 at 4:45 PM at the District Service Center (board members Melissa Grayson and Amanda Davis sit on it), then the Board meeting on November 9, with final approval expected at the end of November. Zackary said he works both of those days.
- Next work group meeting: the following Tuesday.

Student Advocacy Report #4 (October 2026)

Sent to Dr. Morgan and Ms. Bevenue as a draft on October 20 so they could flag anything inaccurate before it was published. On October 21, Ms. Bevenue replied that she had no additional feedback and confirmed in writing that district family newsletters will go to students starting in November.

From heard to "here's what changed"

What students learned from district leaders about incident communication, the first "you said, we did" commitment, and what student voice should look like by June 2027. Meeting with SPASD district leaders, Tuesday, October 20, 2026. Prepared by Zackary Mark, Student Advocate.

01 At a glance

Two SPASD directors met with student advocates and made one concrete commitment on the spot.

- Commitment: district newsletters launching in November will go to all students, not just families.
- Incident communication: what students hear depends on direct impact, age and severity. Some details can't be shared by law.
- Shared goal: by June 2027, students should be able to name something that changed because they spoke up.
- What's next: a wider, more representative survey on what good student voice looks and sounds like.

02 Who we met and why

- Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr. — Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion, SPASD
- Marlita Bevenue — Director of Strategic Communications, SPASD
- Zackary Mark — Student Advocate, SPASD Student Voice

The goal was to move student voice from being heard to being connected to action. We ran out of time before discussing a district student advisory council and equity questions, and plan to pick those up at a follow-up meeting.

03 How incident communication works today

Safety comes first, facts come second, and the message comes after that. Dr. Morgan noted his answers reflected his own understanding, not a formal written district protocol.

What decides whether students are told:

- Direct impact. An incident at one school is unlikely to be shared with students at a school it didn't affect.
- Age of students. Messages are shaped to be age-appropriate.
- Severity. More serious incidents get more communication and come from higher up.

The steps, as Ms. Bevenue described them:

1. Make sure everyone is safe and accounted for.
2. Communications works with the principal and district leadership to confirm facts.
3. Decide who is affected, what each audience needs, and what's ready to share.
4. Her team prepares and reviews the message.
5. It comes from the principal, district leadership, or the superintendent, based on severity.
6. More information follows as it's confirmed.

What can't be shared, and why:

- Names of students involved — student privacy laws; many involve minors
- Individual consequences and discipline — protected student records
- Grades and other student records — protected student records
- Personnel matters — employee protections; directors often don't have the details either

Both directors stressed accuracy. Rumors on social media can spread faster than the district can verify facts, and sending wrong information would hurt trust more than a short delay.

04 What students asked for

Hear something reliable from the district, even when details can't be shared, because silence gets filled by rumors.

- Short, factual messages: even with no names, "a medical incident closed this area, here's what you need to know" takes five minutes and stops rumors.
- Name the law: when something can't be shared because of a law, say which one. Many students will look it up.
- Trust students' understanding: students often feel information is held back because adults assume they won't get it. Most do.
- "You said, we did" updates: follow up on what actually happened, even if it's "nothing changed yet, here's what's happening."

Ms. Bevenue agreed students should hear directly from the district so they have a reliable source: clarify what's known, correct inaccurate information, and explain what's still being learned.

05 You said, we did: newsletters to all students

Starting in November, district newsletters will go to every student, not only to families.

- You said: in four years of high school, I had never received a district newsletter, and neither had many students I know.
- The district said: students were assumed to get family newsletters as part of the household. Dr. Morgan called it a process improvement, not intentional.
- The commitment: Ms. Bevenue will make sure newsletters go to all students when they launch in November with Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed.

This is exactly the kind of change student voice is supposed to produce. We'll report back once the first newsletter goes out.

06 What success looks like by June 2027

Students should be able to name something that changed because they spoke up, and the goals should come from students themselves.

- Ask students first: with about 8,500 students from 4K to 12th grade, Dr. Morgan said the first step is to survey students in age-appropriate ways on what student voice working well looks and sounds like. For the youngest learners, that may mean asking families.
- Set goals with benchmarks: not every idea can happen by June. A realistic plan might commit to a few changes by June 2027, a few more by fall 2027, and keep going into 2028.
- Close the loop: Ms. Bevenue said students should know where to bring an idea and hear back what happened, even if the answer is "we can't do that, and here's why." She encouraged students to be specific.
- What would show progress: a district-wide student survey, a district student advisory council with middle and high schoolers, and regular "you said, we did" updates.

07 Weighted grades update

The student work group agreed weighted grades should start with the Class of 2031 in 2027–28.

- Which classes: a 5.0 scale for capstone classes, tryout-based music courses, and classes earning industry certification or college credit.
- Exceptions: college classes that don't transfer to UW schools, or that match electives or requirements the high school already offers.
- Why freshmen: current students already chose classes under the old system, so switching now wouldn't be fair.

Timeline: week of Oct 26 — shared with the Student Senate · Nov 2, 4:45 PM — student preview, Teaching & Learning Committee · Nov 9 — Board of Education meeting · late November — expected final Board approval.

08 Next steps and what's still open

- Send district newsletters to all students — Ms. Bevenue — committed, November
- Expand the climate survey to all high schools, all grade levels, and a racially and gender-diverse range of students — Zackary Mark — in progress
- Draft questions on what good student voice looks and sounds like — Zackary Mark — in progress
- Share the survey through district channels — not yet named — open
- Name a staff partner for a pilot district student advisory council — not yet named — open
- Set a recurring student–district check-in — not yet named — open
- Publish one public "you said, we did" update this semester — not yet named — open

The survey changes come from Dr. Morgan's feedback that results should reflect diverse perspectives, not the same small group of involved students.

09 How we got here

Jan 13 — Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board · Jan 26 — Act 95 students present at a public hearing · Feb — weighted grades work group begins · Mar 2 — student advocacy meeting with leaders · Apr — principal interviews; Student Senate elected · Aug — meetings with Dr. Reed, Dr. Turner, Mr. Clark · Oct 1 — LGBTQIA+ protections confirmed in writing · Oct 20 — first "you said, we did" commitment.

> "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen." — a student, winter 2026 outreach. This is the gap this work exists to close.

About this report: an independent, student-led report, not an official publication of the Sun Prairie Area School District. It is based on notes and an audio recording from the October 20, 2026 meeting, recorded with permission, and the student weighted grades work group meeting that morning. District statements are summarized, not quoted word for

word, and Dr. Morgan's answers reflect his own understanding rather than formal district policy. Both directors were offered a chance to flag inaccuracies before publication.

3. Weighted Grades & Act 95

From the January Act 95 hearing to the November Board meeting: the working document, timeline, emails and the caregiver survey.

IN THIS PART

Act 95 Timeline	p. 208
Working Document	p. 209
Project Timeline	p. 218
Emails & Meeting Invites	p. 219
Caregiver Survey: Key Findings (October 22, 2026)	p. 235

Act 95 Timeline

Source: Wisconsin Legislative Council act memo for 2023 Wisconsin Act 95 (docs.legis.wisconsin.gov), plus district dates from this record.

Date	What happened
Feb 22, 2024	2023 Wisconsin Act 95 takes effect.
2024–25 school year	High schools with at least 15 students in a class must rank students at the end of 11th grade, **based only on GPA**, identify the top 5% and 10%, notify students in the top 10%, and put the rank on the transcript.
2025–26 admissions	Guaranteed UW admission begins: top 10% of a Wisconsin high school class to any UW campus except UW-Madison; top 5% to UW-Madison.
Dec 2025 – Jan 2026	Students survey 903 SPASD students about class rank and weighted GPA.
Jan 26, 2026	Student Act 95 group presents findings at the Board's public hearing.
Feb – Oct 2026	Weighted grades work group, with students, builds the plan.
Oct 16–22, 2026	District caregiver survey: 531 responses, 70% support.
Nov 2 and Nov 9, 2026	Plan previewed with Board members, then taken to the Committee of the Whole.
Late Nov 2026	Final Board vote expected.

Why it matters: because rank must be based only on GPA, how the GPA is calculated (weighted or not) decides who lands in the top 5% and 10%.

Working Document

Agenda (2/26/26)

Invitees: the Act 95 / weighted grades student group, plus staff: Bryn Horton, Jim Ertel, Jordain Blank, Kristine Wendorf, Michael Morgan, Peggy Shoemaker, Stephanie Leonard, Sarah Chaja-Clardy.

Topics

1. Who else should be at the table? (and who wasn't at the table during Act 95 that should be this time around for the weighted grade conversation)
   - Inviting those who are being impacted most: underclassmen and potentially middle schoolers.
   - Underrepresented groups not currently represented: PPA/JEDI.
   - West ideas: 8th graders/underclassmen getting increased voices; reaching out to club/EC leaders for input on their programs.
   - East ideas: different career tracks (i.e. tech ed); students with different GPAs; students with different club and EC focus.
2. Initial idea generation — how should we collect feedback from students, staff and caregivers?
   - East ideas: If we use so many surveys, students might become desensitized and may not fill them out accurately. Surveys are still the best way to access caregivers and teachers.
   - West ideas: Surveys for teachers and caregivers; focus groups for students.
3. Sub-team identification (by group at first, later by task):
   - Student (TBD) / Staff (survey) / Caregiver (survey)

To Dos

- A policy brought to the board by end of May, with comprehensive community understanding of the process.

Notes

- NEXT MEETING ON 3/12 (THURSDAY)
- How can we divide the labor to achieve our goals?
- Capturing underclassmen opinion
- How can we accurately represent our student body? PPA/JEDI are underrepresented.
- Reaching out to students and teachers in different ways: more formal via emails from Curt; less formal via peer-to-peer outreach.
- Aim to capture accurate percentages of student body groups (ex: IEP, 504, African American, Free and Reduced Lunch).
- Aim to meet again/have email communication by next Tuesday, 3/2.
- Any questions regarding Infinite Campus should be directed to kkwendo@sunprairieschools.org (Kristine Wendorf).
- People found the focus group to be very effective.

3/12/26 GPA Calculation Notes

- The top page shows our current GPA process (unweighted).
- Sum of GPA weights remains the same; however, the sum (GPA value) is weighted.
- Bonus points have a similar outcome to weighting grades.
- Options: weighting classes on a 5-point scale, or giving bonus points to challenging classes.
- In consensus on using a 5.0 scale rather than awarding bonus points to courses.

Staff survey notes:

- In the survey, include the video from the board meeting and the slideshow created; note shortcomings/nuances.
- After survey data is collected, look at the courses which departments refer to.

- Referring back to the gym class situation: there is no need to weight all of the courses recommended by staff ("easy/mandatory" courses at Madison College, P.E., "Start College Now").
- Prior to spring break.

Next meeting: work on staff/caregiver survey. Additional comment: Should this be implemented for rising freshmen only, or next year's freshmen AND sophomores? Caregiver survey team: Zackary Mark and three other students

Draft 1 — Weighted GPA: Parent & Caregiver Survey

Right now, our district uses an unweighted GPA, where all classes are on the same 4.0 scale (for example, an A = 4.0 in every course). A weighted GPA gives extra grade points for more rigorous courses (such as AP, IB, dual credit, or honors). For example, an A in an AP course might count as 4.5 or 5.0 instead of 4.0. We are exploring whether a weighted GPA system would be appropriate for our district. Your responses will help inform recommendations this spring.

1. What is your relationship to the student(s) you support? (Parent / Legal guardian / Other primary caregiver / Other)
2. What grade level(s) are your student(s) currently in? (6th or below / 7th–8th / 9th / 10th / 11th / 12th / Other)
3. How familiar are you with our current GPA and weighting practices? (Very / Somewhat / A little / Not at all)
4. Have you or your student(s) previously been in a school/district that used a weighted GPA system? (Yes, my student(s) / Yes, I did / No / Not sure / Other)
5. Overall, how do you feel about our district adopting a weighted GPA system? (Strongly support → Strongly oppose)
6. To what extent do you agree (Strongly agree → Strongly disagree): A weighted GPA would meaningfully impact student stress and pressure. / ...would meaningfully impact students' course selection. / ...could unintentionally disadvantage some students (for example, students with less access to advanced courses). / ...would better

recognize the rigor of advanced courses (AP, IB, dual credit, honors, etc.).

7. What is one potential benefit you see in adopting a weighted GPA system? (Short answer)
8. What is one potential concern you have about adopting a weighted GPA system? (Short answer)
9. If we move forward, what information or support would be most helpful? (Clear written explanation of how GPA is calculated / Examples of weighted vs. unweighted transcripts / Guidance for talking with my student about course choices / Information sessions / Translated materials / Q&A opportunities / I don't need additional support / Other)
10. Is there anything else you would like the committee to consider? (Short answer)

Draft 2 — Caregiver Survey: Weighted Grades (the "SPE" East-side draft)

SPASD has historically used an unweighted grading/GPA system, with every class being of equal importance on a 4.0 scale. That is, an A in an AP, dual enrollment, or regular level class would all factor into students' GPA as a 4.0, a B as 3.0, and so on. Recently, some students have shown interest in adopting a weighted grading system. With this, certain advanced classes would be graded on a higher scale (ex. 5.0), while regular classes would remain on a 4.0 scale. All responses are completely anonymous.

1. What grade level(s) are your student(s) currently enrolled in? (K-5th / 6th-8th / 9th / 10th / 11th / 12th / Not yet enrolled but will be / No longer enrolled but were previously)
2. What high school(s) are your student(s) enrolled in / will attend? (Sun Prairie East / Sun Prairie West / Prairie Phoenix Academy / Sun Prairie Virtual School (JEDI))
3. On a scale from 1-5 (5 = full support), what would your opinion on SPASD adopting a weighted grading system be?

4. Please elaborate on why you ranked the above question as you did. (Long answer)
5. If SPASD were to adopt a weighted grading system, what classes would you like to see weighted on a higher scale? (AP / Dual enrollment / STEM Academy at Madison College / Early College Credit / Start College Now / Audition music classes / Advanced/capstone electives / Other)
6. Any other questions, comments, or concerns? (Long answer)
7. If you would like to be part of future feedback, include your full name and email. (Short answer)

Review notes comparing the drafts

East: Overall — are we sending this to elementary? Feedback: yes, send to elementary; long-term focus. West: Q1 not needed (relationship data). Q2 similar question — just align. Q3 overall feedback — leave; restructure to focus on which classes to weight. Q4 not necessary. Q5 not necessary — we've established we're going to move forward with weighted grades. Q7 and Q8 are similar; Q10 is similar and could be combined with Q7 and Q8. Q9 keep — open ended.

Final Survey Draft: Caregiver

Caregiver Survey — Weighted Grades. SPASD has historically used an unweighted grading/GPA system, with every class being of equal importance on a 4.0 scale. Recently, some students have shown interest in adopting a weighted grading system in our district. With this, certain advanced classes would be graded on a higher scale (ex. 5.0), while regular classes would remain on a 4.0 scale. This form is intended to collect data on student caregivers' opinions. All responses are completely anonymous, and all questions are optional.

1. What grade level(s) are your student(s) currently enrolled in?
2. What high school(s) are your student(s) currently enrolled in / will they attend?

3. On a scale from 1-5 (5 being full support, 1 being no support), what would your opinion on SPASD adopting a weighted grading system be?
4. Please elaborate on why you ranked the above question as you did.
5. If SPASD were to adopt a weighted grading system, what classes would you like to see weighted on a higher scale? (See the high school course guide.) AP / Dual enrollment/credit / STEM Academy at Madison College / Early College Credit / Start College Now / Audition music / Advanced/capstone electives / Other
6. What factors did you consider when responding to the above question (ex. rigor, time commitment, college credit)?
7. As SPASD moves forward with weighted grades, what resources would help support your family (ex. information sessions, detailed explanations of our weighting system)?
8. Are there any other questions, comments, or concerns you have regarding this issue?
9. If you would like to be part of future feedback on this topic, please include your full name and email address.

Staff Weighted Grades Informational Survey

A recent district-wide survey of high school students showed that 38% were interested in implementing a weighted grading system for all classes, even though that was not the primary question the survey asked. Further student focus groups supported this statistic. Because of this and ongoing work to decide how to determine which students qualify for Wisconsin Act 95, we are seeking staff feedback on how to effectively implement weighted grading. The school board presentation and video (5:10–56:20) are linked for more information.

1. Which department are you in? (Health and PE / Multilingual Learner / English / Family and Consumer Science / AVID / Agriculture / Art / Business Education / Social Studies / Math / Music / Science / Technology and Engineering / World Languages / Administration / Other)

2. What do you believe should be the priority when considering which courses to weight? (ex: course rigor, effort required, college credit received, number of prerequisites)
3. Are there any courses in your department you would like to see weighted in the future? If so, which and why?
4. If SPASD were to adopt a weighted grading system, which classes would you like to see weighted? (AP / Dual enrollment/credit / STEM Academy / Early College Credit / Start College Now / Audition music / Advanced electives (ex. ProStart) / Other)
5. Any other questions, comments, or concerns?

Weighted Grades — Infinite Campus Information Sharing Doc (linked)

Weighted Grades Meeting — Sept 23, 2026

- Welcome and introductions
- Review of the work and previous decisions
- Picking up where we left off: review only, no discussion. Review of project timeline. Caregiver survey — finalize/complete. Decision points remaining.
- Developing criteria for weighting. Goal: not to name specific classes that should or should not be weighted, but to create criteria that will be applied to classes.
- When to apply weighting
- Choosing future meeting dates (Tuesdays or Thursdays)
- Question for future consideration: Will we implement a valedictorian system?

Weighted Grades Meeting — Oct 1, 2026

- Welcome and introductions
- Review of the work and previous decisions
- Caregiver survey draft — to-do: final version confirmation; sending dates and responsibilities

- Forming sub-teams (to sub or not to sub… that is the question). Possible teams (sign-up): Criteria Team (for classes/weighted grades); Roll-in Team
- Schedule next meeting

Weighted Grades Meeting — Oct 15, 2026

- Welcome and introductions
- Review of the work and previous decisions
- Sub-teams: Criteria Team

Criteria "grounding" activity: Weighted grades should recognize _____ because _____.

Weighted grades should recognize course rigor because we should reflect challenge, effort and talent.

- Recognize the amount of pre-requisites.

Recommendation: a 5.0 weight scale, applied to:

- Capstone classes (inclusive of try-out based music courses, repeatable).
- AP courses.
- Classes that earn industry certification or college credit, except for those classes that are equivalent to courses and/or elective credit offered at the high school, and courses that do not transfer to UW colleges/universities for credit.

What does this mean in practice, and why? For classes that are taken through the STEM program, many are equivalent to credit (like PE) that students would earn at the high school level, and the rigor of those classes is equivalent.

Reference sources: Data Source Doc; Presentation.

- Schedule next meeting

Research: How Other Wisconsin Districts Weight Grades

Wauwatosa (Wauwatosa West & East High)

- Weighted: Advanced Placement and dual credit courses through UW–Green Bay only — even for transfer or virtual courses, only those classes are weighted.
- Scale: .025 credits added for every .5 credits; 5.0 scale.
- Seniors/college admissions: transcripts state that weighted grades were introduced during the 2025–2026 school year.
- Why chosen: accessible to all students at both high schools; taught by Wauwatosa teachers; curriculum integrity has external oversight (College Board for AP; UW–Green Bay for dual enrollment); students can earn college credit.
- Not retroactive for 10th → 12th graders.

Elmbrook (Brookfield East High)

- Adds 0.025 per completed semester/half-credit (total 0.05 extra per one-credit course) on a traditional 4.0 scale.
- Weighted: Advanced Placement, Level 5 World Language, specific advanced classes beyond standard capstones, Early College Credit Program, Start College Now.
- No official class rank.

Middleton

- AP courses on a 5.0 scale.
- Open to weighting more courses after looking at 1–2 years of data.
- Wanted to make the "smallest change possible" because Act 95 only affected about 30 people in each graduating class.
- Concern noted: a weighted GPA could increase pressure on students to take AP courses rather than choosing classes based on their true interests. Weighting other higher-level classes could help.

(Three further district research templates were left blank.)

Links in the original document

- Wisconsin Act 95 text: https://docs.legis.wisconsin.gov/2023/related/acts/95

- SPASD course guide: https://www.sunprairieschools.org/east-high/sun-prairie-high-school-academics/course-guide-scheduling
- Board meeting video: https://u.peg.tv/s/ydwehr
- Board presentation slides: https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1LL67KnNBKLerXPWYQe2-S_p7_-At9B_v2QcT2_1JAXY/edit
- Wauwatosa grading: https://www.wauwatosaschools.org/page/highschoolgrading
- Middleton article: https://mhscardinalchronicle.com/6961/news/mhs-switches-to-weighted-gpas/
- Plus links to the 2026–27 West and East High Student & Family Handbooks, the Elmbrook and Middleton handbooks, and several working Google Docs/Forms.

Project Timeline

Weighted Grades — Project Timeline (transcribed from a handwritten image)

- Mid August — Meet with school admin
- Early September — Meet with student School Board reps
- Mid September — Regroup with Weighted Grades student team: next steps; decisions
- Early October — Draft 1 / meeting. Discussion: In what way should Student Services and faculty be involved in the decision? Draft of policy changes.
- Mid October — Draft 2 / meeting
- Early November — Final draft completed; prepare Board meeting presentation. Board meeting: approval of plan and FIRST READING of policy. Question: Is Board approval required for implementing weighted grades, or just a presentation? Belief that approval is required.
- December — Second and final reading of policy / approval

Work process/documentation: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1wzEWuJ6bJj5WU8qIwLva4d-IpO-RYH54wPTOKaEQeWA/edit

Emails & Meeting Invites

E-113 · Updated invitation: Introductory Meeting – Weighted Grades @ Thu Feb 26, 2026 10:08 – 10:40 (CST)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades student group, with district staff

Date Feb 26, 2026, 10:11 AM

Topics Weighted grades · Surveys

Meeting: Introductory Meeting – Weighted Grades When: Thursday, February 26, 2026, 10:08–10:40 AM (Central) Organizer: Curtis Mould Staff invited: Bryn Horton, Jim Ertel, Jordain Blank, Kristine Wendorf, Michael Morgan, Peggy Shoemaker, Stephanie Leonard, Sarah Chaja-Clardy (plus the student group)

Description: Sharing draft surveys and feedback for students, staff, caregivers. Working doc: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1wzEWuJ6bJj5WU8qIwLva4d-IpO-RYH54wPTOKaEQeWA/edit

"Greetings! Let's get the weighted grades party started! This will be our kick-off. For starters we'll discuss: 1) Who is interested. If you are not interested in participating, please send me a quick email saying you're not interested. If you cannot attend but are interested, please decline, and do not send me an email — I'll continue to include you..."

E-114 · Invitation: ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg @ Thu Mar 12, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Feb 26, 2026, 10:52 AM
Topics Weighted grades · Surveys

Meeting: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades When: Thursday, March 12, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Join: Google Meet, meet.google.com/atv-kvoq-ovq; phone (US) +1 904-601-2225, PIN 186625852

Agenda:

- Welcome to new participants
- Review of Caregiver Survey
- Review of Staff Survey
- Discussion of initial student feedback ideas

Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

E-115 · Re: ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Mar 18, 2026, 8:49 AM
Topics Weighted grades · Surveys
Thread Same conversation: E-116, E-117

Greetings all — we will be meeting today, March 18th for the weighted grade conversation. This was on my calendar, but no invite to the large group. If this is unexpected or the process owners for the survey are not available today, I will reschedule upon our return from break. My apologies for the oversight.

E-116 · ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Mar 20, 2026
Topics Weighted grades · Surveys
Thread Same conversation: E-115, E-117

Please see linked Staff survey: https://forms.gle/5vSjVFTVKNWV3m5b6

Meeting: ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg When: Wednesday, March 18, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Join: Google Meet, meet.google.com/stu-hxic-pxc; phone (US) +1 574-400-6064, PIN 940288862 Agenda: Survey Team work Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-117 · Re: ACT 95 Weighted Grade Team Mtg

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Apr 13, 2026, 8:57 AM
Topics Weighted grades · Surveys
Thread Same conversation: E-115, E-116

Hi all ~

We're getting ready to send out the caregiver survey later this week, and the staff survey is on round 2 of distribution. Look forward to a calendar invite for next week. Thank you!

Curt

E-118 · Caregiver Survey

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the Act 95 / Weighted Grades work group
Date Apr 27, 2026
Topics Surveys

Greetings – please see the attached link for the caregiver survey (Survey LINK IS HERE) – if you are on the survey team – THANK YOU. If you have comments or feedback, please use the comments on the Google Doc (Caregiver Combined tab).

I think we need at least three more meetings: review data; draft recommendation; develop communication and presentation.

Good luck to all of you who have exams – I'll do my best to balance meetings with the upcoming AP season.

Curt Mould Director of Digital Media, Innovation and Strategy | Robotics Advisor Sun Prairie Area School District | 608-834-6531

E-119 · [Student] Weighted GPA

From A fellow Act 95 group student (on behalf of several students)
To Curtis Mould
Cc Zackary Mark
Date Sep 3, 2026, 12:57 PM
Topics Weighted grades
Thread Same conversation: E-120

Dear Dr. Mould,

I hope your summer was excellent! A few of us in last year's ACT 95 group were curious if you had anything planned for us to further our work improving the district, such as the weighted GPA program we had in progress last year. We are excited to continue to work with you and make this district a better place for everyone!

We can't wait for your response, thank you!

E-120 · Re: [Student] Weighted GPA

From	Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark and the student who wrote; cc: Jim Ertel, Peggy Shoemaker, Diana McFarland, Bryn Horton, Dr. Antoine Reed, Dr. Taren Turner, Sarah PrankeKlang, the Student School Board Representatives
Date	Sep 4, 2026, 8:19 AM
Topics	Weighted grades
Thread	Same conversation: E-119

Good morning!

Welcome back to school — I hope you've had a great start so far.

Thanks for asking — your timing is great.

WE ARE going to continue the weighted grades conversation. This is a topic of continued focus and importance, and our goal is to have a new framework for weighted grades to the Board by the end of November. This timeline is important, because updates need to be included in the course guides which are finalized in December. As you recall, we left the work last spring in a good place, and we will be picking it back up shortly.

I'd also like to introduce you via email to Dr. Taren Turner (Asst. Superintendent of TLE) and Sarah PrankeKlang (Director of Secondary TLE). They will also be playing roles in this work as the process for discussion and approval and we near making significant decisions.

I've copied those already named, and have included your building principals and Student School Board Reps (two of them are on the student grading work team), as well so we are all receiving the same message.

Next steps:

- Connect with Student School Board reps regarding 2026-27 work plan
- Calendar 1st student work group meeting (week of Sept. 14th)

I am assuming since you are reaching out that you are still interested in being a part of the conversation, and therefore I will be sure you're both included on the calendar invitation. More information, including an agenda and a place to capture thoughts/questions/concerns will be sent out next week.

In the meantime, have a wonderful long weekend. I am looking forward to seeing the work team again soon.

Onward! Curt

E-121 · Invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #1 @ Wed Sep 23, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From	Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group (37 people)
Date	Sep 14, 2026, 10:18 AM
Topics	Weighted grades

Meeting: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #1 When: Wednesday, September 23, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Join: Google Meet, meet.google.com/ehc-crqx-rod; phone (US) +1 813-666-8639, PIN 231151132 Note: Conflicted with the Student Senate WIN time, 10:00–10:30 AM.

E-122 · Updated invitation with note: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #1

From	Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group
Date	Sep 23, 2026, 8:56 AM
Topics	Weighted grades

Description changed — ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

"Greetings — we will have a brief introductory conversation today at 10:08 (SP30) — moving forward we will schedule on Tuesdays or Thursdays to avoid conflicts with SPWHS Student Senate meetings. Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting."

When: Wednesday, September 23, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-123 · Invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2 @ Thu Oct 1, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From	Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group (38 people, including Jim Ertel and Sarah PrankeKlang)
Date	Sep 23, 2026, 10:30 AM
Topics	Weighted grades

Meeting: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades When: Thursday, October 1, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Join: Google Meet, meet.google.com/ctf-whai-pvh; phone (US) +1 515-518-1791, PIN 128871244 Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting. Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-124 · [Student] meeting notes (Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2)

From	a student on the work group
To	Zackary Mark and two other students on the work group
Date	Oct 1, 2026
Topics	Weighted grades · Surveys

Key Outcomes

The team finalized the caregiver survey for weighted grades, incorporating formatting changes and a new question regarding implementation timelines. The survey will be translated into Spanish and distributed early next week. Additionally, the group established a research plan to analyze weighted grading criteria from neighboring school districts before their next meeting.

Decisions Made

- Survey Formatting: Changed multiple-choice questions (1, 2, and 5) to checkboxes to allow for multiple selections.
- Question Enhancements: Converted the "factors considered" and "resources" questions from open-ended to multiple-choice with an "Other" option to increase response rates. Added a follow-up elaboration question for those who select "Other."

- Implementation Timeline: Added a forced-choice question asking caregivers if weighted grades should apply immediately to all current students (retroactively) or only to future students/incoming freshmen.
- Distribution Method: The survey will be sent via Google Forms using Infinite Campus or Blackboard.

Action Items

- District staff: Translate the survey into Spanish and distribute it early next week.
- Student Group: Research student handbooks from specific districts (Wauwatosa, Elmbrook, Middleton, Verona, and Oregon) to identify weighted grading criteria and link findings in the notes document.
- Sarah PrankeKlang: Create a dedicated "homework" tab in the notes document for district research.

Next Steps

- Next Meeting: Scheduled for October 15th.
- Agenda for Oct 15: Review the collected caregiver survey data and develop specific criteria for applying grade weighting based on the district research.

E-125 · Invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #3 @ Thu Oct 15, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From	Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group (38 people)
Date	Oct 1, 2026
Topics	Weighted grades

Meeting: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #3 When: Thursday, October 15, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting. Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-126 · Invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2 @ Tue Oct 20, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group (38 people)

Date Oct 19, 2026, 9:10 AM

Topics Weighted grades

Meeting: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2 (invite title as sent) When: Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting. Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-127 · Updated invitation: Weighted Grade – 26/27 Meeting #2 @ Tue Oct 20, 2026 10:00–10:40 (CDT)

From Curtis Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark and the 2026–27 weighted grades work group

Date Oct 20, 2026, 10:01 AM

Topics Weighted grades

This event has been updated. Changed: conferencing (new Google Meet link). When: Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central) Agenda is included in the notes for this meeting. Attachment: ACT95 – Part 2: Weighted Grades

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E-128 · Spreadsheet shared with you: "Sun Prairie Schools Weighted Grades: Caregiver Survey (Responses)"

From Curtis Mould (via Google Sheets) <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and the weighted grades work group
Date Oct 21, 2026
Topics Weighted grades · Surveys

Curtis Mould has invited you to comment on the following spreadsheet: Sun Prairie Schools Weighted Grades: Caregiver Survey (Responses).

"You are all now able to see the survey results from caregivers. Like last year, I will need an astute member of the student team to make sense of these results, conduct the analysis and identify the most salient nuggets and do so promptly. I'll leave it to you to decide who.

Best - Dr. Mould"

(Zackary's analysis, dated Oct 22, is in the Caregiver Survey: Key Findings section.)

E-129 · Nov 2nd meeting

From Curt Mould <cdmould@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark and four other student work group members
Cc Dr. Taren Turner, Tara Vandehei, Melissa Grayson, Amanda Davis
Date Oct 29, 2026, 1:51 PM
Topics Weighted grades · Board of Education
Thread Same conversation: E-131

Greetings! The teaching and learning committee meeting has posted for next Monday, and one of the items on the agenda is weighted grades. This would be a fairly informal discussion with board members about the process and the decisions and to answer any questions that might come up. This meeting is very conversational, and while it is a formal board committee, it does not have the same formality as a full board meeting (we are all sitting around a table). We will not need to have a presentation ready, but I will have the one pager ready.

Are any of you able to join the meeting next week? It occurs from 445 until 545, and meets at the district office on Bird Street.

Please reply and let me know.

Thank you,

Curt Mould Director of Digital Media, Innovation and Strategy · Robotics Advisor · Sun Prairie Area School District · 608-834-6531

E-130 · Weighted Grades: Student Participation on November 2 and November 9

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Curtis Mould
Date	Oct 29, 2026, 7:32 PM
Topics	Weighted grades · Surveys · Board of Education

Dear Dr. Mould,

I hope you are doing well. Thank you again for including students in the weighted grades work group. As the plan moves to the Board, I would like to confirm a few details so that students can prepare and so that I can share accurate information with students and families.

1. **Board of Education meeting (November 9):** What role would you like students to have in the presentation, and approximately how much time will we have? Should students who wish to speak during public comment register in advance?
2. **Final vote:** Has a date been set for the Board's final vote? I understand the goal is to finalize the plan in time for the December course guides, and I would like to let students and families know when it will be decided.
3. **Caregiver survey:** May the key findings from the October 22 caregiver survey be shared publicly? Students have asked how families responded, and I want to report it accurately.

Once I have these details, I will share the dates and any public comment instructions through SPASD Student Voice so that interested students and families can participate.

Thank you for your time and for your leadership on this work.

Respectfully,

Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School

E-131 · Re: Nov 2nd meeting

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Curtis Mould and the student work group
Date	Oct 29, 2026, 2:58 PM
Thread	Same conversation: E-129

I unfortunately will not be able to attend the Committee Meeting on the second of November, due to a work conflict. Please let me know, however, if anything changes.

Best, Zack Mark

E-132 · Re: Nov 2nd meeting (replies)

From	Dr. Curtis Mould and four student work group members
To	The work group, Dr. Taren Turner, Tara Vandehei, Melissa Grayson, Amanda Davis
Date	Oct 29–30, 2026

Between Oct 29 and Oct 30, four students from West and East replied that they could attend. Dr. Mould: "Glad you can attend! Tara, can you add [the student] to the invitation, please?"

E-133 · For Monday's committee meeting: what families said

From	Zackary Mark
To	The four student work group members attending Nov 2; Dr. Curtis Mould
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 11:17 AM
Attachments	Caregiver Survey: Key Findings (PDF)
Topics	Weighted grades · Surveys · Board of Education
Thread	Same conversation: E-134, E-135

Hi all,

Thanks for going to the Teaching and Learning Committee meeting on Monday. I can't make it because of work, so I wanted to pass along a few things that might help if Board members ask questions.

From the caregiver survey (531 responses, October 16–22): a short summary of support, the timing split between families of current high schoolers and families with younger kids, which classes families want weighted and why, and how many asked for a clear written explanation. It's worth having a clear answer for why we chose to start with next year's freshmen (current students already picked their classes under the old rules), and a good written FAQ will matter.

(The caregiver figures are in the Caregiver Survey: Key Findings section.)

If you get a chance afterward, could you let me know what questions came up and whether a date was set for the final vote? Thanks again!

Zack

E-134 · Re: For Monday's committee meeting: what families said

From A student work group member

To Zackary Mark, the other student members, Dr. Mould

Date Oct 30, 2026, 2:48 PM

Thread Same conversation: E-133, E-135

Thank you for putting this together Zack! We will make sure to keep you updated.

E-135 · Re: For Monday's committee meeting: what families said

From Another student work group member

To Zackary Mark, the other student members, Dr. Mould

Date Oct 30, 2026, 7:31 PM

Thread Same conversation: E-133, E-134

Thank you so much Zack!

E-136 · Shared with the work group: weighted grades presentation and staff survey

From	Dr. Curtis Mould (via Google Drive)
To	Zackary Mark and the student work group
Date	Nov 2, 2026, 11:04–11:25 AM
Topics	Weighted grades · Surveys · Board of Education

Dr. Mould shared three files on the morning of the November 2 committee meeting:

- "ACT95 – Weighted Grades Presentation" (Google Slides), for the November 9 Board meeting
- "Staff Weighted Grades Informational Survey (Responses)" (Google Sheets)
- "Analysis: Staff Weighted Grades Informational Survey" (Google Docs)

(The staff survey analysis is a school-account file this record can't open; it will be added if a copy is provided.)

E-137 · Invitation: Presentation Rehearsal @ Mon Nov 9, 2026 5:00–6:00 PM (CST)

From	Dr. Curtis Mould
To	Zackary Mark and six other student work group members
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 3:28 PM
Topics	Board of Education

Presentation Rehearsal. Meet in Room 200 at the PLC, 220 Kroncke Drive. Board meeting starts at 6. When: Monday, November 9, 2026, 5:00–6:00 PM (Central)

E-138 · Invitation: Weighted Grade Convo @ Tue Nov 17, 2026 10:00–10:40 AM (CST)

From Dr. Curtis Mould

To Zackary Mark, the student work group, Sarah PrankeKlang, Peggy Shoemaker, Dr. Taren Turner, Jim Ertel

Date Nov 3, 2026, 3:30 PM

Topics Weighted grades

Weighted Grade Convo, on Google Meet. When: Tuesday, November 17, 2026, 10:00–10:40 AM (Central)

E-139 · A family FAQ on weighted grades, for your review

From Zackary Mark

To Dr. Curtis Mould

Date Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Topics Weighted grades

Thread Same conversation: E-140

Hi Dr. Mould,

Since most caregivers asked for a clear written explanation, I drafted a short family FAQ on the SPASD Student Voice site using only what's been shared publicly. After November 9, I plan to add the Board's questions and the students' answers. Would you be willing to review it for accuracy? It's on the Updates tab at spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-140 · Re: A family FAQ on weighted grades, for your review

From	Dr. Curtis Mould
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 1:46 PM
Topics	Weighted grades
Thread	Same conversation: E-139

Thank you, this link is blocked by our internal filter. Can you place in a Google Doc that can be shared easily?

Curt

On November 8, after learning the Student Voice site is blocked on the school network, Zackary sent the family weighted grades FAQ to Dr. Mould as a PDF, and the Act 95 checklist and course-type chart to Mr. Medema as a PDF.

On November 10, the Sun Prairie West welcome center reserved Conference Room 1006 so the student work group could join the November 17 Weighted Grade Convo together.

Caregiver Survey: Key Findings (October 22, 2026)

Released for the public record after Dr. Mould said the findings could be shared (per Zackary, November 10, 2026).

Written by Zackary for the weighted grades work group, October 22, 2026, after Dr. Mould asked a student to analyze the caregiver survey. The raw responses are not reproduced here because some families left names and emails for follow-up.

The short version

531 caregivers answered in the first week, and 70% support weighted grades. The biggest risk for the plan is timing, not whether to weight.

1. Support is strong and even. 70% rated it a 4 or 5. Support was about the same at West (68%) and East (73%).
2. Timing splits by family. Caregivers of current high schoolers want it applied now, 69% to 31%. Families with only younger kids want to start next year, 74% to 26%. Our Oct 20 plan starts with next year's freshmen, so the families most invested are the ones it leaves out.
3. Rigor is the reason. Supporters say over and over that harder classes should count more. AP is the clear favorite to weight (85%).
4. Opponents worry about fairness and simplicity. The top reasons: all classes have value, keep the 4.0 simple, and students without access to AP fall behind.
5. Families want it explained. 72% asked for a detailed written explanation. Undecided caregivers mostly said they need more information, not that they disagree.

Who answered

531 responses came in from Oct 16 to Oct 22, and 62% arrived on the first day (328).

- Families with a current high schooler (grades 9–12): 320
- Families with only K–8 students: 204

- Sun Prairie West families: 263
- Sun Prairie East families: 245
- Other or no school listed (virtual, Prairie Phoenix, blank): 23

Families could list more than one grade, so the rows overlap. The East and West counts are close, so neither school's families dominate the results.

Support for weighted grades

70% of caregivers support weighted grades, and only 19% oppose them (526 ratings). Support barely changes by group: 68% at West, 73% at East, and 70% for families both with and without a current high schooler. Opposition is strong among the few who hold it: most opponents chose 1, not 2.

When it should start

Overall it's close to a tie, but the split by family is large (462 clear timing answers): families with a current high schooler want it now, and families with younger kids want to wait. Each group mostly picked the option that helps their own child. That's normal, but it means the families with the most at stake are the ones our plan leaves out. 61 caregivers skipped this question, mostly people who oppose weighting entirely.

Which classes, and why

AP is the clear favorite: 85% want AP weighted. That matches our recommendation.

- Classes to weight: AP 85% · dual enrollment 46% · STEM Academy 17%
- Factors they weighed: rigor 75% · college credit 57% · time commitment 56%
- How they want to learn about it: detailed written explanation 72% · information sessions 40%

The course list in our export is cut off, so options listed after STEM (including capstones) can't be counted. The full spreadsheet would fix that. Rigor beating college credit supports our choice to weight capstones, not only classes that earn credit.

What families wrote

388 caregivers explained their rating. Supporters mostly talk about effort, while opponents talk about fairness. Quotes are anonymous and copied as written.

- Support (4–5), 276 explained: harder classes should count more (about half name rigor, effort or AP); Act 95 and direct admit; other districts already do it; the current system discourages AP. "Harder schedules should be rewarded." · "Extra incentive to take advanced classes" · "This is long overdue!"
- Unsure (3), 41 explained: need more information; want the pros, cons and reasoning first. "Need more information. Pros and cons." · "Hate to pressure students"
- Oppose (1–2), 70 explained: all classes have equal value; keep the 4.0 simple; equity for students without AP access; stress; colleges recalculate GPA anyway. "Every class should have equal importance." · "The scale stops at 4 for a reason." · "It's not equitable"

A warning sign about the survey itself: a few opponents said it reads as if the decision is already made. The timing question had no "don't adopt it" option, and 44 caregivers who rated it a 1 skipped that question. The communication package should show that feedback can still change the plan.

Questions families want answered

147 caregivers left a comment or question. These five came up most and belong in the communication package's FAQ.

1. Does it apply to my student, and when does it start? The most common question (about 23 comments), often about a current junior or senior. Some asked whether GPAs would be recalculated

going back.

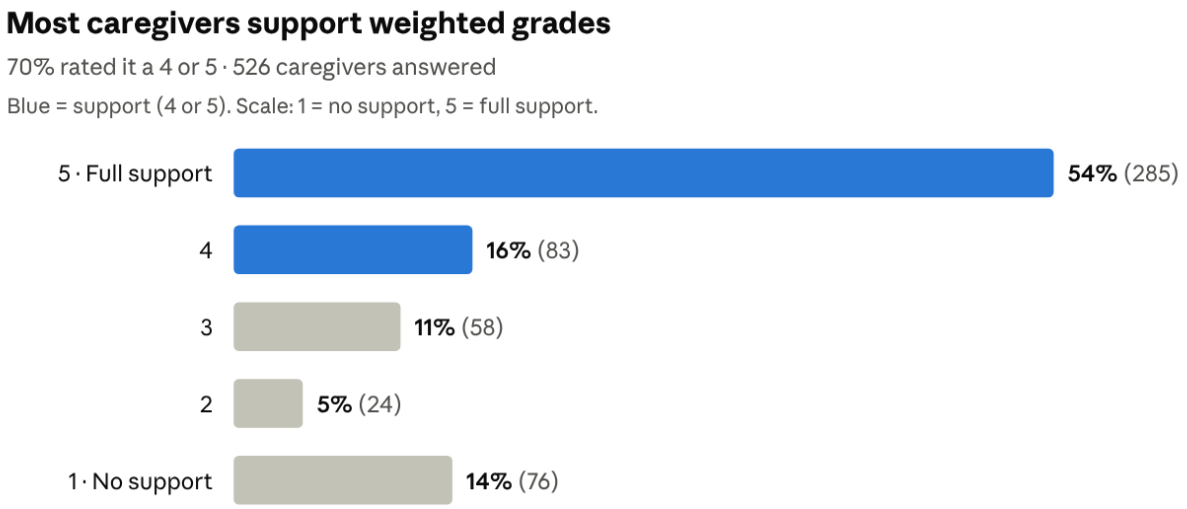
2. How does it affect Act 95 and college admissions? Families asked how it ties to the Wisconsin guarantee and whether colleges use the weighted GPA.
3. Which classes count? People asked about audition music classes, electives, dual credit and capstones. Some said college credit alone shouldn't earn a weight.
4. Is it fair to students without access? Families asked whether every student can get into weighted classes.
5. Why change now, and is it already decided? A few wanted the reasons behind the change and proof the survey matters.

Recommendations for the work group

- Oct 27 (work group): decide how we answer families of current high schoolers before anything goes public. Option A: keep "next year's freshmen only" and give a short, honest reason, for example that current students chose classes under the old rules and changing them mid-course isn't fair. Option B: weight classes taken from 2027–28 on for every student, without recalculating past grades. Either way, say plainly that past grades won't be recalculated.
- One-page communication package: lead with the reason (rigor), list exactly which classes count, and add a five-question FAQ built from the section above. 72% asked for a written explanation, so the written piece matters more than events.
- Nov 2 and Nov 9 (Board): bring three numbers: 70% caregiver support, 78% of students choosing a weighted option in the Act 95 survey, and the 69% to 31% timing split. Name the split ourselves rather than letting Board members hear it first from parents.
- Address equity directly. Opponents' strongest point is access. Show how students get into AP and capstone classes and what support exists, so weighting doesn't look like a reward only for students who already have access.

Method and limits

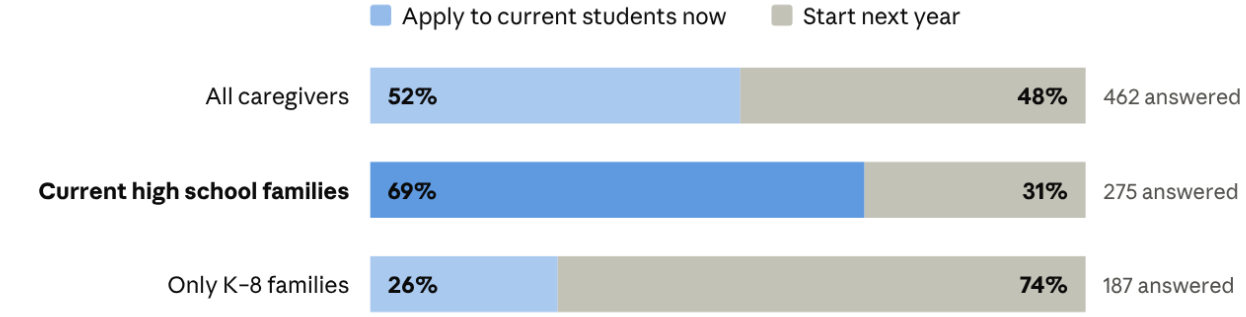
- Source: the PDF export of the caregiver survey responses (531 rows, Oct 16–22). Percentages are of all 531 unless a question's own count is given.
- The survey is self-selected, so it shows who chose to answer, not every family in the district.
- The PDF cuts long answers off after about 45 characters. Comment themes are based on those first words, so treat the theme counts as rough.
- Student comparison figures come from the Dec 2025 – Jan 2026 Act 95 student survey (903 responses).
- Names and emails that some families left for follow-up are not included.



Support for weighted grades, caregiver survey

Families of current high schoolers want it applied now

When should weighted grades start? Share of each group that answered



Work group plan (Oct 20): start with next year's freshmen. Blanks and unreadable answers left out.

When it should start, by family

4. District Budget

Questions, notes and a plain-language explainer from the August budget meeting.

IN THIS PART

Next Year's Budget (2027–28)	p. 241
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Meeting Notes (August 18)	p. 250
Explainer: How the SPASD Budget Works	p. 256

Next Year's Budget (2027–28)

The 2027–28 district budget hasn't been released yet. When it is, this page will explain it in plain language using the same format as the August budget explainer in Part 4: where the money comes from, where it goes, what changed from last year, and when the public can comment.

Question Packet for Matt Clark

DISTRICT BUDGET & LONG-TERM FINANCIAL PLANNING — Meeting Briefing & Question Packet Prepared for Matt Clark, Director of Business & Finance, Sun Prairie Area School District. Prepared by Zackary Mark, Sun Prairie West High School. Meeting focus: Budgeting process, long-range planning, financial pressures, priorities, and student impact. Target length: 45–60 minutes.

Purpose

This packet is designed to help structure a student-led conversation about how SPASD makes financial decisions, how it plans beyond one school year, what constraints it faces, and how financial choices translate into student and staff outcomes.

The goal is understanding first, evaluation second. The strongest questions are designed to uncover the assumptions, tradeoffs, timelines, and measurable outcomes behind the numbers.

Important note: Some figures below are historical or were published for the 2024 referendum. They are included as context, not as claims about the current 2026–27 budget. Where a current figure is needed, the question packet asks Mr. Clark to provide the latest number.

1. Executive Briefing

Why this meeting matters

SPASD identifies Business Services as responsible for fiscal management, long-range financial planning, new facility planning, transportation, purchasing, payroll, accounts payable, and open enrollment. The district also publicly provides annual meeting reports, budget information, enrollment projections, financial audits, bond information, debt structure, and long-term debt-service information.

The district's current Business Services page lists a 2026–27 Strategic Based Budget & Staffing Planning Calendar and a 2025–26 Adopted Budget, alongside a 2026 UW Applied Population Lab enrollment projection report. That makes this meeting an opportunity to connect documents that are publicly available with the decision-making process behind them.

Core objective

- Understand the district's budget cycle from assumptions to Board approval.
- Understand how SPASD models multiple years rather than balancing only one annual budget.
- Identify the largest recurring financial pressures and which are within district control.
- Understand how enrollment, staffing, state funding, property values, debt, and referenda interact.

- Understand what financial indicators the district watches to avoid future structural deficits.
- Connect financial decisions to measurable outcomes for students, staff, programs, and facilities.

Student-voice connection

Existing SPASD advocacy work has emphasized student voice, transparency, consistency, and follow-through. The financial version of that principle is simple: students should be able to understand, at an age-appropriate level, why major financial decisions are made and what outcomes those decisions are intended to produce.

Prior work around Act 95, weighted grading, Student Senate, and districtwide student engagement gives a useful lens for asking not only "What does this cost?" but also "What problem does this spending solve, and how will we know it worked?"

2. Research & Data Snapshot

A. What SPASD currently makes public

- Business Services says it is responsible for fiscal management and long-range financial planning.
- The district lists a 2026–27 Strategic Based Budget & Staffing Planning Calendar.
- The district lists a 2025–26 Adopted Budget, prior adopted budgets, financial audits, a bond-rating report, current debt structure, and long-term debt-service information.
- The district lists a 2026 UW-APL enrollment projection report and a 2023 Roffers community growth/projections report.
- SPASD provides a Revenue Caps 101 video and links to the Wisconsin budget process.

B. 2024 operating referendum context

The 2024 SPASD referendum asked voters to authorize up to $25 million in additional annual operating authority. The district described the funding as a way to stabilize the budget, support competitive

compensation, and support programming for a growing and increasingly complex student population. Voters approved the measure 57% to 43%.

The district's referendum materials allocated the authority conceptually across three major areas: $4 million for educational programming, $7 million for competitive staff compensation and benefits, and $14 million to stabilize operating expenses.

The district stated that without the referendum it projected a $6 million deficit for 2025–26 and a deficit growing to $14 million in subsequent years. These were pre-referendum projections and should be treated as historical context. The key current question is how the actual financial position compares with those projections.

C. Tax and funding context

In its 2024 tax-impact explanation, SPASD said 187 new students joined the district that year and that enrollment growth affected staffing, transportation, and other costs. The district also cited changes in state aid, special education and language-service needs, private-school voucher/charter costs, and debt payments as factors affecting the tax levy.

The district reported that the 2023–24 mill rate was $9.86 and said it had declined from $13.06 in 2019–20. The district also reported that from 2010–2024 it received $3,300 less per student than it would have received if state funding had kept pace with inflation, according to its referendum materials.

D. Wisconsin finance constraint

Wisconsin's revenue-limit system constrains how school districts can raise certain operating revenues through property taxes. DPI's revenue-limit system uses pupil membership and other inputs to calculate district revenue limits. This is why a district's budget conversation cannot be reduced to "just spend less" or "just raise taxes." The relevant question is which revenue sources and spending categories are flexible, restricted, recurring, or one-time.

3. Priority Questions for Matt Clark

Use these as a conversation map rather than a checklist. The best follow-up question is usually: "What does that look like in the numbers?"

A. Budget construction

1. Can you walk me through the SPASD budget process from the first assumptions to the final Board-approved budget?
2. What are the major decisions that have to be made before the public sees a proposed budget?
3. Which parts of the budget are relatively fixed, and which parts can the district realistically change within one year?
4. What assumptions are most important in building the 2026–27 budget?
5. How does the district test whether those assumptions are realistic?

B. Long-term financial planning

6. How many years into the future does SPASD formally model its finances?
7. What does the district's long-term financial model currently show for the next 3, 5, and 10 years?
8. What are the biggest financial risks in that model?
9. What assumptions would have to change for the district to move from a stable outlook to a structural deficit?
10. What financial indicators would give you an early warning that the district is heading toward a problem?

C. Revenue and state funding

11. How dependent is SPASD on state aid versus local property taxes and other revenue sources?
12. How does Wisconsin's revenue-limit system affect the district's ability to respond to rising costs?
13. What state-level changes would have the biggest positive or negative effect on SPASD's long-term finances?

14. How does enrollment growth translate into additional revenue, and how quickly does the cost of serving those students appear?

4. Deep-Dive Questions

D. Staffing and compensation

15. What percentage of the operating budget is tied to employee compensation and benefits?
16. How does SPASD determine whether compensation is competitive with neighboring Dane County districts?
17. How are staffing decisions made when enrollment changes?
18. How does the district balance competitive pay with maintaining class sizes and student programs?
19. How are hard-to-fill positions or specialized services accounted for in long-term planning?

E. Enrollment, facilities, and growth

20. How are the 2026 UW-APL enrollment projections being incorporated into financial planning?
21. What enrollment trend would require the district to change staffing, boundaries, facilities, or programming?
22. How does the district financially plan for major facility maintenance before a building reaches a crisis point?
23. How do operating costs of buildings factor into long-term facilities decisions?
24. How are debt payments and future capital needs modeled alongside the operating budget?

F. Referendum and accountability

25. The 2024 referendum was presented as a long-term response to structural financial pressure. What has changed since voters approved it?
26. How closely are actual revenues and expenses tracking the assumptions used when the referendum was presented?

27. What outcomes are being used to determine whether referendum-supported spending is producing the intended student and staff benefits?
28. What would make the district consider seeking additional operating authority before the referendum's stated five-year roll-in period ends?
29. How does the district ensure recurring referendum revenue is not used to create an unsustainable future spending commitment?

G. Student impact

30. When the district has to choose between competing priorities, how is student impact weighed?
31. Are there districtwide metrics that connect spending to student outcomes, staffing stability, program access, or school climate?
32. How can students better understand the district's financial decisions without reducing complex issues to slogans?
33. Is there a meaningful role for students or a student advisory group in conversations about budget priorities?

5. Numbers & Documents to Request

- Current financial position: Current-year revenue, expenditures, projected year-end position, fund balances, and major variances.
- 2026–27 budget: Adopted or proposed total budget, major fund categories, major revenue sources, and major expenditure categories.
- Multi-year forecast: 3-, 5-, and ideally 10-year forecast with major assumptions.
- Staffing: FTE trends, compensation/benefit share of expenditures, and major staffing assumptions.
- Enrollment: Current enrollment, 3–5 year trend, and 2026 UW-APL projection assumptions used in budgeting.
- Debt: Outstanding principal, annual debt service, maturity schedule, and major future capital obligations.

- Fund balance: Current reserves by fund, district policy targets, and how reserves are used in long-term planning.
- Referendum tracking: Actual referendum revenue received and how it has been allocated compared with the original plan.
- Capital planning: Major facility projects expected in the next 5–10 years and how they are financed.
- Risk analysis: Top 5 financial risks and the indicators the district monitors for each.

A particularly useful question: "If you could give a student one chart that explains the district's financial position better than anything else, what would you put on it?" That question forces the conversation toward the indicators the finance office actually uses, rather than a pile of disconnected budget numbers.

6. Suggested 45–60 Minute Meeting Flow

- 0–5 min — Introduction: Thank Matt for meeting; explain that the goal is to understand the system, not audit him.
- 5–15 min — How the budget works: Ask for the annual budget cycle and the biggest decision points.
- 15–30 min — Long-term outlook: Focus on multi-year forecasting, enrollment, staffing, state funding, and structural risks.
- 30–42 min — Referendum & priorities: Compare the 2024 assumptions with current reality; ask about outcomes and sustainability.
- 42–52 min — Student impact: Ask how spending decisions connect to student outcomes and student voice.
- 52–60 min — Documents & next steps: Request key documents, clarify follow-up, and identify one useful next conversation.

Live notes: Key numbers / Biggest financial pressure / Biggest long-term risk / Most important assumption / Student impact connection / Documents promised / Follow-up date / person / One idea worth pursuing.

Closing test: Before leaving, you should be able to explain in plain language: where the district gets its money, where most of it goes, what limits the district's choices, what the next five years look like, and what would cause that outlook to change.

7. Sources & Research Notes

- SPASD Business Services: district responsibilities, budget information, 2026–27 Strategic Based Budget & Staffing Planning Calendar, 2025–26 Adopted Budget, financial transparency resources, enrollment projections, debt information. https://www.sunprairieschools.org/departments/business-finance
- SPASD 2024 Referendum materials: historical context on the $25 million recurring operating referendum. https://www.sunprairieschools.org/community/past-referenda/ref2024
- SPASD Engagement Main and SPASD Engagement Notes (project materials).
- Wisconsin DPI School Finance: 2025–26 Revenue Limit information. https://sfs.dpi.wi.gov/safr_ro/all_revlimit_fte.asp?year=2026

Prepared for a student-led informational meeting. This packet is not an official SPASD financial document and does not substitute for the district's adopted budget, audit, or official financial statements.

Meeting Notes (August 18)

District Budget & Long-Term Financial Planning — Meeting Preparation Notes (with notes from the meeting) Meeting with: Matt Clark, Director of Business & Finance, Sun Prairie Area School District. Prepared by: Zackary Mark. Purpose: Understand district budgeting, long-term financial planning, and how financial decisions affect students and staff.

1. Opening

Thank Mr. Clark for meeting. Explain that I'm trying to better understand how district-level decisions are made, particularly financial decisions, from a student/community perspective, and that I keep records of meetings and correspondence so I can accurately document what I learn. Notes: Budget finalized every October. Monday there is a proposed budget meeting.

2. Understanding the District Budget

1. How does SPASD develop its annual budget from beginning to end?

Notes: 80% of expenses are staff; also busing, supplies, utilities. Revenue = expenses. Student numbers determine revenue (UW Applied Population Lab). 2-year budget cycle set by the Wisconsin government — how much money we get determines how much we can spend.

2. Who is involved in developing the budget, and what responsibilities does each person or department have?
3. At what point does the School Board become involved?

Notes: Meeting Monday with the school board. Formulas determine it. Budget talk starts in February, runs to October adoption — 8–9 months building the budget.

4. What are the biggest sources of revenue for the district?
5. How much flexibility does the district have over how those revenues are spent?

6. What expenses make up the largest portions of the district budget?
7. How does the district determine which programs or services receive funding?
8. When the district has competing priorities, how are those priorities ranked?

3. Long-Term Financial Planning

9. How far into the future does SPASD typically plan financially?

Notes: 5-year budget forecast in February of every year — where will SPASD be in 5 years. Year-to-year process.

10. What does the district's long-term financial planning process look like?
11. What financial assumptions are most important?

Notes: Enrollment drives revenue/everything. Staffing is the majority. Resident membership and revenue limit → tax levy → enrollment. State aid is a big assumption.

12. How does the district account for changes in enrollment when planning several years ahead?
13. What are the district's biggest long-term financial risks right now?

Notes: Challenge is the state aid amount. Not much risk otherwise. Percent of funding is under inflation — funding is not what it should be; a Wisconsin problem. Trend: less enrollment coming in; housing costs high; small classes currently. Referendum: $25 million passed in 2024.

14. Are there expenses or pressures that will become more significant over the next 5–10 years?
15. How does the district prepare for unexpected financial changes?

4. Staffing & Compensation

16. How significant are staffing costs within the overall budget?
17. How does the district balance competitive compensation with financial stability?

Notes: $7 million of the referendum went to compensation; wage study; an operational deficit is eventually likely.

18. How do staffing shortages or changing needs affect long-term planning?

Notes: Big short-term impact; long-term worry about maintaining current staffing. Special needs: different funding "bucket" — state funds special ed at about 30% of actual expense; general funding goes toward anything and helps fund the total; net zero at the end of the year. Staff based on needs and IEPs, no matter the cost.

19. When adding or eliminating positions, what financial and educational factors are considered?
20. How does the district evaluate whether staffing investments produce meaningful benefits for students?

5. Student Impact

21. How does SPASD evaluate the effect of financial decisions on students?

Notes: Initiatives taken into account; needed money aligned to what is said to be needed; Board and Superintendent tell them what is needed.

22. Are student outcomes considered when determining whether a program continues receiving funding?
23. How does the district balance efficiency with maintaining programs students value?
24. How can students better understand how financial decisions affect their daily experience?

Notes: Keep asking specific questions; open door policy; student reps with the board.

25. Are there opportunities for students to provide input on major financial priorities?

Notes: Specific feedback through student reps on the Board of Education.

6. Difficult Financial Decisions

26. What are some of the most difficult financial decisions recently?

Notes: State government, federal government, property taxes. About $2 million from federal grants. Title grants allocate money for the neediest schools — $160,000 less than last year. Cuts usually come from grants; Title funding is primarily used for Title staff. Don't want to cut from Title schools.

27. When reductions are necessary, how does the district decide where?

Notes: 80% is staff, determined by students. Class size guidelines; reductions informed by class-size ratio; non-renewing staff if not needed.

28. How does the district prevent short-term decisions from creating long-term problems?

29. Programs the district would like to invest in but can't?

Notes: Big-picture ideas and superintendent goals: half-day vs. full-day 4K talks; PPA funding; Board priorities.

30. What financial decision does the public most commonly misunderstand?

Notes: Majority misconception is that state aid = more revenue. In fact revenue limit minus state aid = tax levy, so more state aid means property tax relief — less taxes for people.

7. Transparency & Community Understanding

31. What financial information should community members pay more attention to?

Notes: Key formulas (5 key formulas); Board meeting Monday; annual meeting open to the public in early October, at SPWHS this year; district goals; up-to-date budget.

32. How can the district make financial information easier to understand?

33. How transparent should the district be about long-term projections and challenges?

Notes: Almost fully. Board is public: current, future, what we can do, challenges, decisions. Transparency is key.

34. What public information would you recommend reviewing?
35. Common misconceptions you frequently encounter?

8. Looking Forward

36. If you could change one thing about how districts are funded?

Notes: Tie state aid (the amount per student) to inflation.

37. What financial issue will have the greatest impact over the next five years?

Notes: Revenue per pupil not tied to inflation; not enough state funding; declining enrollment, projected to go down.

38. What should students and community members pay attention to?

Notes: Advocate at the state level — alderperson, Congress person; tell stories about schools; state budget decisions; the state funds private schools differently.

39. What is a financially healthy school district?

Notes: Fund balance metric — like a savings account, as a percentage of the budget. Healthy fund balance is more than 15–20%; SPASD is at 21%. Long term it won't decrease. Annual audit; money left over.

40. What would financial success look like five years from now?

Notes: Balanced budget! Find ways to be responsible, transparent, and effective; tied to student outcomes.

9. Questions to Dig Deeper

"Could you explain what that looks like in practice?" / "What does that mean for students specifically?" / "How does the district measure whether that investment was successful?" / "Has that changed compared with previous years?" / "What would happen if that assumption changed?" / "Who ultimately makes that decision?" / "Is

that something the public can see?" / "What is the biggest factor people tend to overlook?" / "If you were in my position trying to understand the district's finances, what would you look at first?"

10. Closing

Ask what financial documents, reports, or resources Mr. Clark recommends reviewing, and whether other district officials could help. Thank him.

Main goal: The goal of the meeting is not simply to learn how much money SPASD has. It is to understand how the district turns limited resources into educational priorities, how it prepares for future financial pressures, and how students and the community can better understand and participate in those decisions.

Explainer: How the SPASD Budget Works

One-page explainer published on the SPASD Student Voice website, from the August 18, 2026 meeting with the Director of Business & Finance.

The short version: the district's money mostly pays for people, the amount it gets depends on how many students enroll, and Wisconsin's per-student funding hasn't kept up with inflation.

- Biggest cost: about 80% of spending is staff. The rest covers busing, supplies, and utilities.
- Revenue: driven by enrollment through state formulas. Revenue must equal expenses.
- Budget calendar: built over 8–9 months, starting in February, adopted in October.
- Long-term plan: a 5-year forecast is updated every February.
- 2024 referendum: $25 million passed; about $7 million went to staff pay after a wage study.
- Savings: fund balance is about 21%. Around 15–20% is considered healthy.
- Federal Title grants: about $160,000 less than last year. These fund the highest-need schools.
- Special education: the state covers roughly 30% of actual cost; general funds cover the rest.

The most common misunderstanding: many people assume more state aid means more money for schools. Under Wisconsin's revenue limit, the district can only collect a set amount. More state aid mostly lowers the local property tax levy instead of raising the total.

Biggest risks ahead:

- Per-student funding not tied to inflation
- Enrollment projected to decline, partly due to housing costs
- Possible operating deficit down the road as costs rise

How to follow along:

- Watch Board of Education meetings and the annual public budget meeting each fall
- Talk to the student representatives on the Board
- Tell state lawmakers how school funding affects your school

6. More Emails: City, Police, District & State (June–Nov. 2026)

Emails with the city, police, district and state officials outside the main threads above.

IN THIS PART

District Budget, Mental Health & Cell Phones (August)	p. 259
Meeting with Janet Thomas & Dr. Turner (August)	p. 264

District Budget, Mental Health & Cell Phones (August)

E-161 · Request for Guidance on Districtwide Discussion Topics

From Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>

To Karen Richmond <krrichm@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Aug 4, 2026, 8:00 AM

Topics Budget · Safety & mental health

Thread Same conversation: E-162

Hi Karen, I hope you are doing well. I am reaching out because I am interested in continuing my engagement with the Sun Prairie Area School District and learning more about several districtwide topics that impact students, staff, and the broader community.

I would appreciate your guidance on who the appropriate district leaders would be to speak with regarding these areas:

- District budget and long-term financial planning
- Student mental health supports and resources
- Cell phone policies and their impact on the learning environment

Rather than reaching out to multiple people without knowing the best point of contact, I was hoping you could help direct me to the appropriate administrators for these conversations.

My goal is to better understand the district's priorities, challenges, and decision-making processes while continuing to have constructive conversations about issues affecting students and the community.

For organization purposes, I maintain a separate record of my community engagement correspondence, including emails and meeting notes, to ensure information and conversations are accurately documented and not lost over time.

Thank you for your help and for pointing me in the right direction. Thank you, Zackary Mark

E-162 · Re: Request for Guidance on Districtwide Discussion Topics

From Karen Richmond <krrichm@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>

Date Aug 4, 2026, 11:07 AM

Topics Budget · Safety & mental health

Thread Same conversation: E-161

Hi Zachary, Thank you for reaching out with your questions. Below are the district leaders that would best be able to answer your questions.

- District budget and long-term financial planning: Matt Clark, Director of Finance and Business Services, or Jewel Mucklin, Assistant Superintendent of Operations
- Student mental health supports and resources: Jennifer Apodaca or Janet Thomas, Directors of Student Services
- Cell phone policies and their impact on the learning environment: Dr. Turner, Assistant Superintendent of Teaching Learning and Equity

Please feel free to reach out with any other questions. Thank you, Karen Karen Richmond, Executive Assistant to Superintendent and Board Leadership, (608) 834-6502, krrichm@sunprairieschools.org, 501 S. Bird Street, Sun Prairie, WI 53590

E-163 · District Budget and Long-Term Financial Planning

From Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
To Matt Clark <mpclark@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Aug 4, 2026, 5:00 PM
Topics Budget
Thread Same conversation: E-164, E-165, E-166

Hello Mr. Clark, I hope you are doing well. Karen Richmond suggested that I reach out to you regarding the district budget and long-term financial planning.

I have been working to better understand how district-level decisions are made and would appreciate the opportunity to meet with you to learn more about the district's budgeting process, long-term financial priorities, current challenges, and how financial decisions support students and staff across the district.

As part of my ongoing community engagement, I keep a dedicated record of my correspondence, meeting notes, and other communications related to district and community conversations. Doing so helps ensure that information is accurately documented and preserved over time.

If you have time in the coming weeks, I would greatly appreciate the opportunity to meet at a time that works best for you. Thank you for your time and consideration. Sincerely, Zackary Mark

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E-164 · Re: District Budget and Long-Term Financial Planning

From Matt Clark <mpclark@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
Date Aug 4, 2026, 9:57 PM
Topics Budget
Thread Same conversation: E-163, E-165, E-166

Hi Zackary, I'd be happy to discuss this with you. Send over some days and times that work for you over the next few weeks and I'll cross check that with my availabilities. Would you prefer to meet in person, over Microsoft Teams, or phone call? I'm flexible with whatever you'd prefer. Thanks, Matt Matt Clark, Director of Business & Finance, (608) 834-6510, 501 S. Bird Street, Sun Prairie, WI 53590

E-165 · Re: District Budget and Long-Term Financial Planning

From Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
To Matt Clark <mpclark@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Aug 6, 2026, 6:14 PM
Topics Budget
Thread Same conversation: E-163, E-164, E-166

Hi Mr. Clark, Thank you for getting back to me. Unfortunately, I'll be out of town next week, so I won't be available to meet then. My schedule opens up beginning the week of August 17:

- Monday, August 17: 8:00 a.m. to 10:00 a.m.
- Tuesday, August 18: 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.
- Wednesday, August 19: 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.
- Thursday, August 20: 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.
- Friday, August 21: 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.

I'd prefer to meet in person if that works for you. If possible, I would appreciate 45 minutes to an hour, but I completely understand if your schedule only allows for a shorter meeting. Thank you again, and I look forward to meeting with you and learning more about the district's budgeting process and long-term financial planning. Best, Zackary Mark

E-166 · Re: District Budget and Long-Term Financial Planning

From Matt Clark <mpclark@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
Date Aug 11, 2026, 9:42 AM
Topics Budget
Thread Same conversation: E-163, E-164, E-165

Hi Zackary, I just sent an invite for August 18th. Please let me know if there is anything I can do ahead of time to aide in answering your questions. Matt

E-167 · Invitation: Budget Conversation @ Tue Aug 18, 2026 11:30am – 12:15pm (CDT)

From Matt Clark <mpclark@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
Date Aug 11, 2026
Topics Budget

You have been invited by Matthew Clark to attend an event named Budget Conversation on Tuesday Aug 18, 2026, 11:30am – 12:15pm (Central Time – Chicago).

E-168 · District Cell Phone Policy

From Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
To Dr. Turner (trturne@sunprairieschools.org)
Date Aug 4, 2026, 5:00 PM
Topics Safety & mental health

Hello Dr. Turner, I hope you are doing well. Karen Richmond suggested that I reach out to you regarding the district's cell phone policies and their impact on the learning environment.

I would appreciate the opportunity to meet with you to better understand the district's philosophy behind its cell phone policies, how those decisions are made, the feedback the district has received, and how the district evaluates the impact these policies have on student learning and classroom environments.

As part of my ongoing community engagement, I keep a dedicated record of my correspondence, meeting notes, and other communications related to district and community conversations. This allows me to accurately document information that is shared and ensure conversations are not lost over time.

If you have time in the coming weeks, I would greatly appreciate the opportunity to meet whenever your schedule allows. Thank you for your time and consideration. Sincerely, Zackary Mark

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Meeting with Janet Thomas & Dr. Turner (August)

E-169 ·

From	Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
To	Ms. Apodaca (jjapoda@sunprairieschools.org)
Date	Aug 4, 2026, 5:00 PM
Topics	Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-170, E-171, E-172, E-173, E-174, E-175

Subject: Student Mental Health Supports

Hello Ms. Apodaca, I hope you are doing well.

Karen Richmond recommended that I contact you regarding student mental health supports and resources within the Sun Prairie Area School District.

I would appreciate the opportunity to meet with you to learn more about the district's approach to supporting student mental health, the resources currently available to students and families, ongoing initiatives, and the challenges the district is working to address.

As part of my ongoing community engagement, I keep a dedicated record of my correspondence, meeting notes, and other communications related to district and community conversations. This helps ensure that information is accurately documented and available for future reference.

If you have availability in the coming weeks, I would be grateful for the opportunity to meet whenever it is convenient for you. Thank you for your time and for all you do to support students.

Sincerely, Zackary Mark

E-170 ·

From Janet Thomas <jathoma@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>

Date Aug 5, 2026, 3:57 PM

Thread Same conversation: E-169, E-171, E-172, E-173, E-174, E-175

Hello Zackary, I was forwarded your message from Ms. Apodaca. My name is Janet Thomas and I am the other Director of Student Services who helps to lead student supports in the district. I would be happy to meet with you.

Please give me a few days to find some dates and times for a meeting. Dr. Turner, our Assistant Superintendent of Teaching, Learning, and Equity, will also join us. She and I will coordinate our calendars and get back to you soon with a proposed meeting date. Thank you for reaching out.

Looking forward, Ms. Thomas — Janet Thomas, Director of Student Services (She/Her/Hers), (608) 834-6638, jathoma@sunprairieschools.org, 501 S. Bird Street, Sun Prairie, WI 53590

E-171 ·

From Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>

To Janet Thomas <jathoma@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Aug 6, 2026, 6:15 PM

Topics Safety & mental health

Thread Same conversation: E-169, E-170, E-172, E-173, E-174, E-175

Dear Ms. Thomas, Thank you for your response. I truly appreciate your willingness to meet with me. I also appreciate Dr. Turner's willingness to join the conversation. I look forward to learning more about the district's approach to student mental health, the supports currently available, and the work being done to address students' needs.

Unfortunately, I will be unavailable next week, but I would be happy to meet during the week of August 17. My availability:

- Monday, August 17: 8:00 a.m. to 10:00 a.m.
- Tuesday, August 18: 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.
- Wednesday, August 19: 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.
- Thursday, August 20: 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.

- Friday, August 21: 8:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.

If possible, I would appreciate 45 minutes to an hour for the meeting. However, I completely understand if Dr. Turner's schedule only allows for a shorter conversation, and I am happy to work around the availability. Thank you again for coordinating this. Sincerely, Zackary Mark

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E-172 ·

From	Janet Thomas <jathoma@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
Date	Aug 11, 2026, 9:46 AM
Thread	Same conversation: E-169, E-170, E-171, E-173, E-174, E-175

Hello Zackary, Thank you for your patience in scheduling this meeting. As you may know, we are welcoming back administrators, new staff, and all staff over the next few weeks. I've connected with Dr. Turner about our availability. We are able to meet on either: Tuesday, 8/25 between 1:00–3:00 OR Thursday, 8/27 between 11:00–1:00. Might either of those dates work for you? And, please share an agenda of topics that you are interested in so we can be prepared and efficient in our conversation. Looking forward! Janet Thomas

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E-173 ·

From	Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
To	Janet Thomas <jathoma@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Aug 12, 2026, 5:52 PM
Topics	Student council · Safety & mental health
Thread	Same conversation: E-169, E-170, E-171, E-172, E-174, E-175

Hi Janet, Thank you for getting back to me and for working with Dr. Turner to find a time. Thursday, August 27 from 11:00–1:00 works best for me.

For the agenda, I'm thinking of keeping the conversation fairly broad, with a focus on district-level issues and opportunities for student engagement. My rough topics are:

- Student voice and meaningful student involvement in district decision-making

- Opportunities to strengthen student leadership and advocacy across SPASD
- Student engagement and communication between students, administrators, and the Board
- Follow-up and next steps from the Student Senate/student engagement work
- District-wide programs, policies, and initiatives that could be improved through greater student input
- Ways students can contribute to discussions around school climate, belonging, safety, and trust
- Opportunities for continued collaboration between students and district leadership

I'm happy to keep this as a working agenda and adjust based on what you and Dr. Turner think would be most useful to discuss. Thank you again, and I look forward to meeting with you both on August 27. Best, Zackary

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E-174 ·

From	Janet Thomas <jathoma@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>
Date	Aug 13, 2026, 8:07 AM
Thread	Same conversation: E-169, E-170, E-171, E-172, E-173, E-175

Hello Zackary, I've scheduled our meeting for Thursday, August 27th from 11:30–12:30. We can meet at the District Support Center in Dr. Turner's office. Thank you for sharing the draft agenda items. Looking forward, Janet

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E-175 ·

From Janet Thomas <jathoma@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark <zackarymark160@gmail.com>, Dr. Turner

Date Aug 26, 2026, 11:46 AM

Topics Student council · Safety & mental health

Thread Same conversation: E-169, E-170, E-171, E-172, E-173, E-174

Hello Zackary, I am confirming our meeting tomorrow at the District Support Center from 11:30–12:30 with Dr. Turner. Your proposed agenda (shared via email) was as follows: Student voice and meaningful student involvement in district decision-making; Opportunities to strengthen student leadership and advocacy across SPASD; Student engagement and communication between students, administrators, and the Board; Follow-up and next steps from the Student Senate/student engagement work; District-wide programs, policies, and initiatives that could be improved through greater student input; Ways students can contribute to discussions around school climate, belonging, safety, and trust; Opportunities for continued collaboration between students and district leadership. Given that we have an hour available to us, please let us know if there is a particular area of focus that you would like to discuss so that we can be most helpful to you. Looking forward, Janet

7. Surveys

What students and families were asked, and what they said in aggregate.

IN THIS PART

Survey Results at a Glance p. 269
Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback (English / Español) p. 270

Survey Results at a Glance

What the surveys behind this record found, in aggregate. Raw responses are kept private.

Survey	When	Responses	Key findings
Act 95 student survey	Dec 2025 – Jan 2026	903 students	78% of students who picked a ranking option chose a weighted GPA; 55% barely knew about Act 95 beforehand
Caregiver weighted grades survey	Oct 16–22, 2026	531 caregivers	70% support weighted grades; families of current high schoolers wanted it applied now, 69% to 31%; families with younger kids preferred next year, 74% to 26%
Student climate survey (safety, clear info, fairness, stress and support)	Fall 2026, open	Not yet compiled	Totals will be added when compiled
Student Senate election	April 2026	Not available	Turnout and seats will be added if provided (no names)

Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback (English / Español)

Results: individual responses are kept private because some people included names. Aggregate results will be added here once they are compiled.

Student Advocacy Feedback / Comentarios sobre la defensa de los estudiantes (Google Form). Respondent links: https://forms.gle/pQsxiPcCcrp9tB1j6 (April version) and https://forms.gle/HNjvwAmeWgbnXVnt5 (later version). The later version adds a line in both languages pointing respondents to Student Advocacy Report #1, Report #2, and "Additional Materials / Updates" for context.

Section 1 — Language

Please select your preferred language to complete the survey. / Por favor seleccione su idioma preferido para completar la encuesta.

- English (continue to Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback)
- Español (continuar a Comentarios sobre la defensa de los estudiantes y el clima escolar)

Section 2 — Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback (SPASD)

This form is part of an ongoing student-led advocacy initiative focused on strengthening student voice, improving communication systems, and increasing transparency within the Sun Prairie Area School District.

Following recent meetings with district leadership, several key focus areas have been identified: development of a Student Senate or advisory structure; increased student involvement in leadership decisions (including principal and superintendent processes); improved communication and transparency, especially around safety, policies, and student services; and strengthening trust and consistency across schools.

This work is centered on moving student voice beyond occasional feedback and into structured, ongoing participation in decision-making. Your input will directly inform future discussions, reports, and advocacy efforts. Responses may be shared in aggregate (anonymous) form.

1. What is your role? — Student / Parent/Guardian / Staff / Community Member / Other
2. What level school(s) are you connected to? — 4K / Kindergarten / Elementary / Middle School / High School / None of the Above / Other
3. Do you feel students currently have a meaningful voice in district decisions? — Yes / No / Somewhat / Not Sure
4. What would make student voice more effective or impactful? (Short answer)
5. How would you rate communication to students about important issues (safety, policy changes, etc.)? — 1 (Very Unclear) to 5 (Very Clear)
6. Where do you see the biggest gaps in communication? (Short answer)
7. Do you feel there is a strong sense of trust between students and school/district leadership? — Yes / No / Somewhat / Not Sure
8. What factors most influence trust in schools? (Short answer)
9. Should students have a role in leadership decisions (such as principal or superintendent selection)? — Yes / No / Somewhat / Not Sure
10. To the last question respond why or why not you believe this way. (Short answer)
11. Which of the following areas do you believe should be prioritized? — Student Senate / advisory group; Student involvement in leadership decisions; Improved communication systems; Transparency around policies and incidents; Clearer student services processes; Other

12. What specific changes would you like to see moving forward? (Short answer)

Section 3 — Comentarios sobre la defensa de los estudiantes y el clima escolar (SPASD)

Este formulario forma parte de una iniciativa continua de defensa de los estudiantes, liderada por ellos mismos y centrada en fortalecer la voz estudiantil, mejorar los sistemas de comunicación y aumentar la transparencia dentro del Distrito Escolar del Área de Sun Prairie (SPASD).

Tras las reuniones recientes con los líderes del distrito, se han identificado varias áreas clave de enfoque: desarrollo de un Senado Estudiantil o una estructura consultiva; mayor participación de los estudiantes en las decisiones de liderazgo (incluidos los procesos relacionados con directores y el superintendente); mejora de la comunicación y la transparencia, especialmente en lo referente a seguridad, políticas y servicios estudiantiles; y fortalecimiento de la confianza y la coherencia en todas las escuelas.

Este trabajo se centra en llevar la voz de los estudiantes más allá de los comentarios ocasionales, transformándola en una participación estructurada y continua en la toma de decisiones. Sus aportaciones informarán directamente las futuras discusiones, informes y esfuerzos de defensa. Las respuestas podrán compartirse de forma agregada (anónima).

1. ¿Cuál es su función? — Estudiante / Padre/Tutor / Personal / Miembro de la comunidad / Otro
2. ¿Con qué escuela(s) está vinculado? — 4K / Jardín de infancia / Primaria / Escuela media / Escuela secundaria / Ninguna de las anteriores / Otro
3. ¿Considera que los estudiantes tienen actualmente una voz significativa en las decisiones del distrito? — Sí / En cierta medida / No / No estoy seguro

4. ¿Qué haría que la voz de los estudiantes fuera más eficaz o tuviera mayor impacto?
5. Comunicación a los estudiantes sobre temas importantes — 1 (Muy poco clara) a 5 (Muy clara)
6. ¿Dónde observa las mayores deficiencias en la comunicación? (Respuesta breve)
7. ¿Considera que existe un fuerte sentido de confianza entre los estudiantes y el liderazgo de la escuela o del distrito? — Sí / En cierta medida / No / No estoy seguro
8. ¿Qué factores influyen más en la confianza dentro de las escuelas? (Respuesta breve)
9. ¿Deberían los estudiantes desempeñar un papel en las decisiones de liderazgo (tales como la selección del director o del superintendente)? — Sí / En cierta medida / No / No estoy seguro
10. A la última pregunta, responda por qué o por qué no piensa de esta manera. (Respuesta breve)
11. ¿Cuál de las siguientes áreas debería priorizarse? — Senado estudiantil / grupo asesor; Participación de los estudiantes en las decisiones de liderazgo; Mejora de los sistemas de comunicación; Transparencia en torno a las políticas y los incidentes; Procesos más claros para los servicios estudiantiles; Otro
12. ¿Qué cambios específicos le gustaría ver en el futuro? (Respuesta breve)

End of Survey

Thank you for taking the time to share your perspective. This initiative is focused on building stronger, more transparent, and more inclusive systems through collaboration between students, staff, and the broader community. Real progress depends on consistent input, clear communication, and continued follow-through.

Gracias por tomarse el tiempo para compartir su perspectiva. Esta iniciativa se centra en construir sistemas más sólidos, transparentes e inclusivos mediante la colaboración entre los estudiantes, el personal y la comunidad en general. El progreso real depende de una

retroalimentación constante, una comunicación clara y un seguimiento continuo.

8. Instagram, Website, Newsletter & Action Kit

The public side of the work: posts, reels, the website, the district's feature story and the Action Kit.

IN THIS PART

Instagram: @spasdstudentvoice	p. 275
Ask the District Log	p. 281
Website: spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app	p. 281
District Newsletter Feature: Making a Difference Through Student Voice (Nov 3, 2026)	p. 283
Student Voice Action Kit (October 2026)	p. 287
Student Voice Flyer	p. 298

Instagram: @spasdstudentvoice

From screenshots taken October 8 and October 27, 2026.

- Account: SPASD Student Voice (@spasdstudentvoice)
- October 27: 39 posts · 29 followers · 13 following (October 8: 38 posts · 24 followers · 15 following). Also on Threads.
- Bio: "Amplifying student voice across SPASD. Focused on safety, communication & fairness. Turning feedback into action. Join the conversation ↓"
- Links: tinyurl.com/4ww4rkeh and one more
- Highlights: Spotlights, Posts
- Pinned posts: "Your Voice. Our Future. Help Shape SPASD!" (survey QR code), "Student Voice Check-In," "Students: Make Your Voice Heard! — Starting a student-led project to improve safety, fairness & communication across all SPASD schools!"

Accounts followed include: Sun Prairie Schools (@sunprairieschooldistrict), Sun Prairie West High Student Senate (@spweststudie, @spwstudentsenate), SPW Student Council

(@spwstuco, @spweststuco), SPW Athletics Activities, Madison College and Madison College Ambassadors, Wisconsin Student Action (@wistudentaction), KeepStudentsConnectedWI, Empower (@empower.wi), WI Public Education Network (@wiscednetwork), Instagram, and Instagram's Creators.

Other posts visible on the grid include "We're back," a 9/11 remembrance post, and a Labor Day post.

Reels (October 2026)

- "You said, we did" (14 seconds): "Students never got the district newsletter. Not once. Only parents did." → "So we asked. At our October 20 meeting with district leaders." → "Confirmed in writing. October 21, 2026. Small change. Real proof that speaking up works." → "Every promise, tracked. spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app"
- Caregiver survey (20 seconds): "531 families weighed in. The district's caregiver survey, October 16–22." → "But when? That's where families split." → "Families with younger kids: 74% say start next year." → "Full analysis on the site."

Posts and reels (October 29)

Four new feed graphics in the same navy, yellow and blue style, each ending with "Your voice. Your future. Our district."

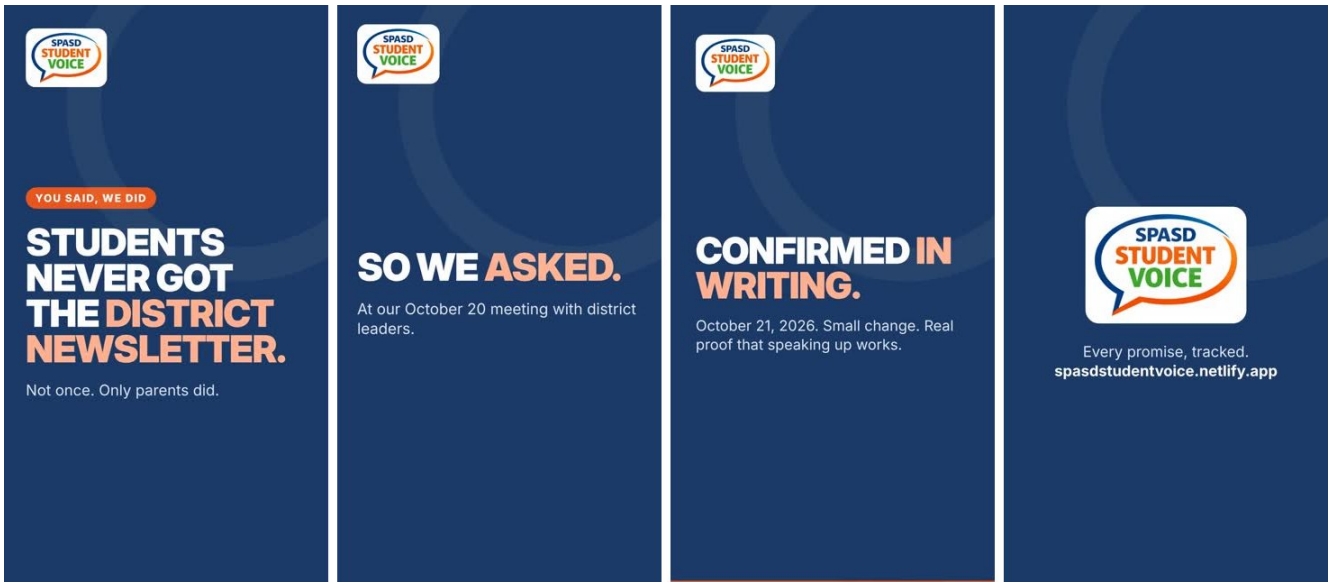
- "Join Student Voice: We need every school." Calls for students from Sun Prairie East, Prairie Phoenix Academy, Patrick Marsh, Prairie View and Central Heights. "No experience needed. If you've ever asked 'why does school work like this?' you're in. DM us to join."
- "Fall 2026 update: You said. We did." Weighted grades: moving (to the Board Nov. 9, final vote expected late Nov.). Student newsletter: won (district committed in writing Oct. 21). Advisory council: asked (proposal sent to Dr. Reed). Ask the District: live (a new question every day).
- "Ask the District #1," a new daily series. Question: "When is the final Board vote on weighted grades, and which students would it apply to?" Status: sent to the district. "Answers get posted word for word.

Got a question? Comment or DM us. Anonymous is fine."

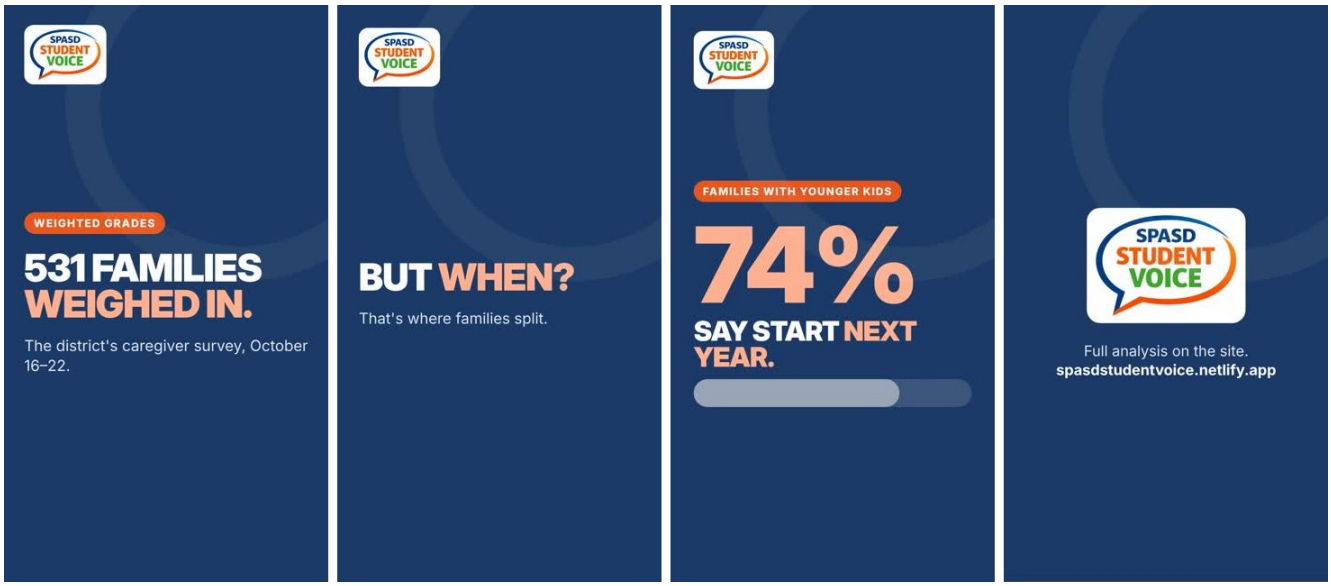
- "2 minutes. Anonymous. This is your turn." Promotes the student survey on safety, clear info, fairness, and stress and support, in English or Español, at tinyurl.com/4ww4rkeh.

Five matching reels (about 16–19 seconds each):

- Ask the District (posted to @spasdstudentvoice Oct 29): one real question every day, sent to district leaders each Friday, answers posted word for word; Question #1 is waiting on an answer.
- This is your turn: the district hears adults all the time; tell them about safety, clear info, fairness, and stress and support; results go straight to district leaders plus the public report, with no names attached.
- Weighted grades go to the Board: harder classes can count more; timeline Nov. 2 Board committee preview, Nov. 9 full Board meeting with students present, final vote expected late November in time for course guides; shaped with students, who sat on the work group from the start; check the posted agenda to sign up for public comment.
- You said, we did: weighted grades moving, student newsletter won (first issue expected in November), advisory council asked (proposal sent to Superintendent Dr. Reed for a spring 2027 pilot), Ask the District live.
- We need every school: Sun Prairie East, Prairie Phoenix, middle schools, and you. "Ever asked 'why is it like this?' Then you're qualified." It takes 1–2 hours a month. Every school, every grade.



Reel: "You said, we did" newsletters (frames)



Reel: caregiver survey (frames)



Feed posts, October 29: Join, You said we did, Ask the District #1, This is your turn



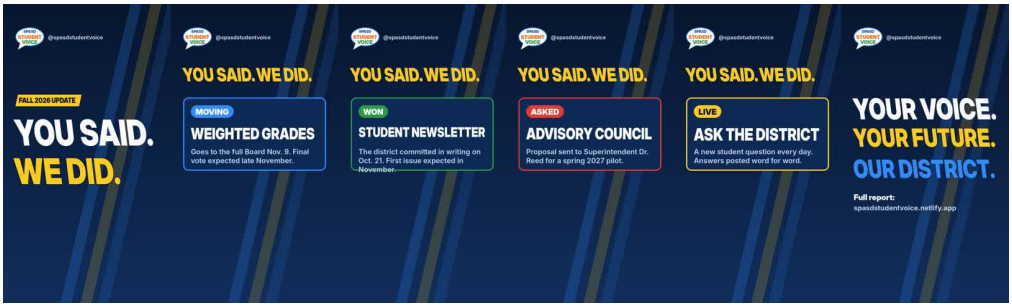
Reel: Ask the District (frames)



Reel: This is your turn (frames)



Reel: weighted grades go to the Board (frames)



Reel: You said, we did, fall update (frames)



Reel: we need every school (frames)

Ask the District Log

The daily "Ask the District" series on @spasdstudentvoice. Questions are sent to district leaders and answers are posted word for word.

#	Question	Status
1	When is the final Board vote on weighted grades, and which students would it apply to?	Sent to the district; waiting on an answer. (The district's own timeline says the final vote is expected late November.)

More questions will be added as they're posted.

Website: spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app

spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app — last updated October 22, 2026. Independent and student-led; not an official SPASD site.

Tabs: Home, Updates, You Said We Did, The Plan, Meeting Log, Reports, Emails, Archive, FAQ & Glossary, Sources, Contact, and a Spanish summary (En español).

- Updates: what's moving, what's stuck, and a timeline since January.
- You Said, We Did: a scoreboard of every promise to students: done, in progress, or waiting. First entry: district newsletters to every student, starting in November, confirmed in writing Oct 21.
- The Plan: the District Student Advisory Council proposal and the asks for October 20.

- Meeting Log: every meeting so far (22 with district, school and city leaders as of Oct 22).
- Reports: Report #4 and earlier progress reports, the budget explainer, weighted grades research, and the plate reader report.
- Emails: letters to district leaders and their replies, word for word (11 threads).
- Archive: this record, one part at a time.
- FAQ & Glossary, Sources, and Contact (district contacts plus a message form).

"Right now" on the home page: the advisory council (first on the list for the follow-up meeting), newsletters to every student (committed), a wider student survey (in progress), weighted grades (Board committee Nov 2, Board Nov 9, final vote late November), the student-rights guide (next step), and mandated-reporting information (still waiting since March 2).

District Newsletter Feature: Making a Difference Through Student Voice (Nov 3, 2026)

Photo from the district's story.



Zackary Mark, from the SPASD feature

From the Sun Prairie Area School District website (sunprairieschools.org), Nov 3, 2026. Copied word for word, except two words about grade level shown in [brackets].

Helping Others Find Their Voice: Zackary Mark's Commitment to Student Advocacy

Student advocacy doesn't always begin with a big idea or meeting with District leaders. For Sun Prairie West High School [student] Zackary Mark, sometimes it starts with finding the courage to do something as simple as sending an email.

Finding the courage to speak up didn't happen overnight for Zackary.

"When I first started this, I didn't have that confidence," Zackary said. "I've grown that, but you have to be able to send an email. Like, that's

basic stuff, and then you gradually go from there."

Outside of school, Zackary has spent the past 10 years practicing karate, a hobby that takes up nearly every afternoon. But when he's not training, his remaining time goes toward student advocacy.

He follows District developments, writes about publicly available information, and shares updates and answers questions through his own online platforms.

What drives Zackary work and his passion for advocacy is helping students understand not only what decisions are being made, but why they're being made and how those decisions affect them.

One idea Zackary has shared to improve communication was "You Said, We Did."

This helps students see how the District follows through on commitments, connecting what leaders say they will do with the actions taken afterward.

"The district said this, that they're gonna do this. Now here's the evidence that they did this," Zackary explained.

For him, it's about building trust.

That same interest in helping students understand District decisions has led Zackary to become involved in conversations about weighted GPA.

Currently, Sun Prairie uses an unweighted 4.0 GPA scale, meaning courses are calculated on the same scale regardless of their level of difficulty. A weighted GPA system would recognize the additional academic demands of more challenging courses, such as Advanced Placement classes. Zackary is one of the students involved in discussions about a proposal to transition to a weighted GPA system; if passed, it would begin with the Class of 2031.

As a [graduating student], Zackary would not benefit from the proposed change, but he believes it's important to consider how the transition would affect students who have already planned their high school courses under the current system.

"The easiest way for me to explain this is that I would love to have a weighted GPA," he shared. "That would look amazing for my transcript for colleges."

While Zackary has collaborated with others on projects such as weighted GPA and Act 95, he often researches, writes, and follows up on issues on his own.

Still, he wishes more students could be part of those conversations.

"I'd love to have a lot more student input and a lot more voice into the decisions that I do," he said.

But Zackary knows speaking up isn't always easy.

For students who may feel uncomfortable reaching out to school or District leaders, Zackary has a simple piece of advice.

"Confidence. Confidence is key."

He encourages students to start with what feels manageable, whether that's writing an email, making a phone call, or eventually attending a meeting.

"You want to start at your comfort level, what will work best for you, and gradually build up those skills because confidence is what you really need, and that doesn't just appear out of nowhere."

After graduation, Zackary hopes to attend either the University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee or the University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, pursuing studies in secondary education, social studies, and political science, along with a minor in Spanish.

His first goal is to become a high school social studies teacher. Eventually, he hopes to pursue a career in law, government, and education policy, where he can continue working toward change on a larger scale.

Zackary hopes the work he is doing will continue to allow more opportunities for students to ask questions and be heard.

"Those two things are really what it's all about; what all I'm doing is about." He shared.

For Zackary, it all comes back to the confidence to speak up, and that's what continues to drive his passion for student advocacy.

Student Voice Action Kit (October 2026)

A 14-page kit Zackary put together after the October 20 meeting and the caregiver survey, also posted on the SPASD Student Voice website. The caregiver survey findings in the kit are already in Part 3, so they aren't repeated here.

Weighted Grades: What Families Need to Know (student draft for the work group)

A short explainer drafted by a student member of the SPASD weighted grades work group, October 2026. This is a recommendation. The School Board makes the final decision.

What's changing: right now, SPASD uses an unweighted 4.0 GPA, so an A counts the same in every class. The work group is recommending a 5.0 scale for the most challenging classes. In a weighted class, an A would count as 5.0 instead of 4.0.

Which classes would be weighted (5.0 scale):

- AP courses
- Capstone classes, including try-out music courses
- Classes that earn college credit or an industry certification

Not weighted:

- College-credit or certification classes that match a class the high school already offers
- Classes that don't transfer for credit to UW colleges and universities

Counselors are reviewing the Madison College class list now. Every weighted class will be marked in the course guide so students know before they choose.

Who it applies to: the recommendation is to start with students entering 9th grade in fall 2027 (the Class of 2031) and add a grade each year after that.

Why not current students? Current high schoolers chose their classes under the old rules. Changing the rules partway through would reward some choices after the fact and not others, and it would change class rank for students who are already being ranked. Starting with a new class means every student in it knows the rules before choosing a single course.

Open question for the work group: 69% of caregivers of current high schoolers asked for it to apply now. One option to consider is weighting classes taken from 2027–28 onward for every student, without recalculating past grades.

Questions families asked:

- Does it apply to my student? Under the recommendation, only to students starting 9th grade in fall 2027 or later.
- Will past grades be recalculated? No. Grades already earned stay as they are.
- How does it connect to Act 95 and college? Act 95 guarantees admission to Universities of Wisconsin schools for students in the top 10% of their class (top 5% for UW–Madison), so class rank matters. Many colleges also recalculate GPAs their own way. [District to confirm how weighted GPA will be used for class rank and shown on transcripts.]
- Is it fair to students who can't take AP? Weighted classes have to be open to every student who meets the prerequisites. [District to add how students get support to access these classes.]
- How can I give input? The plan goes to the Board's Teaching & Learning Committee on November 2 (4:45 PM, District Service Center) and the full Board on November 9. Both meetings are open to the public.

Based on the work group's October 15 and 20 recommendations and the caregiver survey (531 responses, October 16–22, 2026). Items in brackets need district confirmation before this is shared with families. Spanish version to follow.

Weighted Grades Board Kit (November 2 and 9, 2026)

Before you go:

- Nov 2, 4:45 PM: Teaching & Learning Committee preview, District Service Center. Small table, two Board members. Best chance for a real conversation.
- Nov 9: full Board of Education. Check the posted agenda for how to sign up for public comment, usually before the meeting starts. Comments are often limited to 2–3 minutes.
- Bring printed copies of the one-page summary for Board members.

Public comment script (about 2 minutes):

> Good evening, President McFarland and members of the Board. My name is Zackary Mark. I'm a student in the district and a member of the weighted grades work group.
>
> In January, 31 students came to this Board to talk about Act 95. Since then, students have worked alongside district staff to build the plan you're seeing tonight, and I want to share three numbers.
>
> First, 78%. That's the share of students in last year's Act 95 survey who chose some kind of weighted GPA.
>
> Second, 70%. That's how many of the 531 parents and caregivers who answered this month support weighted grades, and it's almost the same at West and East.
>
> Third, 69%. That's how many caregivers of current high schoolers want this to apply to their students now. Our plan starts with next year's freshmen, for good reasons, but those families deserve a clear answer about why, and I'd ask the Board to make sure that answer is part of how this is shared.
>
> This plan rewards students for challenging themselves, and it was built with students at the table. I hope you'll support it, and I hope this is how more decisions get made in our district. Thank you.

Statement to be read for him if he can't attend:

> Members of the Board, I'm sorry I can't be here tonight; I'm at work. I'm a student on the weighted grades work group. Students asked for a fairer way to recognize challenging classes, and this plan does that. Students supported a weighted option in last year's Act 95 survey (78%), and 70% of caregivers support it this month. I'd ask one thing: that the district clearly explain to current high school families why the plan starts with next year's freshmen, since 69% of them hoped it would apply now. Thank you for including students in this decision. — Zackary Mark

Talking points for the Nov 2 committee preview:

- Lead with the reason: the recommendation is built on rigor, and rigor was also caregivers' top factor (75%).
- Name the timing split before a Board member hears it from a parent.
- Ask how weighted GPA will be used for class rank under Act 95. Families asked this more than anything except timing.
- Ask what support exists so every student can access weighted classes. That's opponents' strongest point.
- Offer students' help with the written explanation, since 72% of caregivers asked for one.

One-page handout for Board members: What Students and Families Said

- Act 95 student survey (Dec 2025 – Jan 2026), 903 students: 78% of students who picked a ranking option chose a weighted GPA. 55% barely knew about Act 95 beforehand.
- Caregiver survey (Oct 16–22, 2026), 531 caregivers: 70% support weighted grades. West 68%, East 73%.
- Caregiver survey, timing (462 answered): current high school families 69% apply now; families with only younger kids 74% start next year.
- Caregiver survey, classes: 85% want AP weighted. Top factor: rigor (75%).

- Caregiver survey, communication: 72% want a detailed written explanation.

What families want answered: Does it apply to my student? How does it affect Act 95 and college admissions? Which classes count? Is it fair to students without access? Is the decision already made?

Students' ask: approve the plan, and share it with a clear written explanation that answers current families directly. Both surveys were self-selected.

District Student Advisory Council: Pilot Plan (for Dr. Reed, Dr. Morgan and Ms. Bevenue)

A spring 2027 pilot that can answer the shared goal from October 20: by June 2027, students can name something that changed because they spoke up.

The idea in one sentence: a small group of students from every SPASD middle and high school meets with district leaders on a regular schedule, brings what students are saying, and hears back what happened to it.

- Who: 3–5 students from each middle and high school (about 25–30 total), across grades, and reflecting each school's racial, gender and program mix. This follows Dr. Reed's August suggestion.
- How students join: a short application open to every student (in English and Spanish), plus one seat per school saved for a student recommended by a counselor or teacher, to reach students who don't usually apply.
- Staff partner: one district leader who owns the council, plus a staff contact at each school. This is the first thing needed.
- Meetings: four in the pilot (January, February, April and May 2027), 60 minutes, during the school day or right after, with a virtual option for middle schoolers.
- Agenda: each meeting has one district topic leaders want student input on, one topic students bring, and updates on earlier input.

- Closing the loop: within 30 days of each meeting, the district shares a short "You said, we did" update: what changed, what's in progress, and what can't happen and why.
- Families: a parent team alongside, as Dr. Reed suggested, meeting twice during the pilot.
- Cost: mostly staff time. Possibly snacks, printing and transportation for after-school meetings.

Timeline: November 2026 — name a staff partner and agree on the pilot plan · December 2026 — applications open at every school; wider student survey runs · January 2027 — members selected; first meeting on survey results and priorities · February–May 2027 — three more meetings, each followed by a "You said, we did" update · June 2027 — review the pilot with students, staff and the Board and decide whether to make it permanent.

How we'll know it worked:

- Every middle and high school was represented at every meeting.
- At least three "You said, we did" updates were published.
- Students on the council can name at least one change that came from their input.
- In a June survey, more students say they know where to bring an idea than in December.

The ask: name a staff partner by the end of November so applications can open in December.

Outreach & Growth Plan (November–December 2026)

Goal: get beyond the same small group. Reach every high school, every grade, and students who don't usually speak up, which is what Dr. Morgan asked for on October 20.

Where things stand: 39 Instagram posts and 29 followers, also on Threads; a website that installs as a phone app; a bilingual survey. The reach is still mostly one school and one friend group.

Channels, ranked by reach:

1. District student newsletter (starts November): survey link and blurb in the first issue — Ms. Bevenue (email drafted), by Nov 6
2. SP30 at both high schools: teachers show the survey QR code once — Zack (email drafted), by Nov 13
3. Student Council and Student Senate (West and East): repost the survey and the newsletter win — Zack, by Nov 6
4. Flyers: get approval, then post at both high schools, the library and Kicks Unlimited — Zack, by Nov 13
5. East High students: recruit 2–3 co-leads from East — Zack, by Nov 20
6. Spanish-speaking families: share Spanish posts with ELL teachers and family liaisons — Zack, by Nov 20
7. Middle schools: ask middle school principals to share the survey with 8th graders — Zack, in December after the council pilot is approved

Messages to send:

> DM to Student Council and Student Senate: Hey! I run @spasdstudentvoice. Last week the district confirmed students will start getting the district newsletter in November because we asked for it. We're trying to get the student survey to every grade so district leaders hear from more than a few of us. Would you be willing to repost it to your story? Link's in our bio. Thank you!
>
> DM to students at East: Hey, I'm Zack. I've been working with district leaders on student voice stuff, like weighted grades and getting students the district newsletter. Right now it's way too West-heavy and I want East to have an equal say. Would you be down to help lead it with me? It's mostly sharing what students at East care about and coming to a meeting or two. No experience needed.

Posting calendar: week of Oct 26 — "You said, we did": newsletters (English + Spanish slides), Reel version · Nov 2 — caregiver survey carousel and Reel; story reminder for the Board committee · Nov 9 — story reminder for the Board meeting; recap post after · Nov 16 — district story with the interview (if published); survey push · Nov 23 —

weighted grades final vote result; Thanksgiving post · Nov 30 — November monthly update · Dec 7 — advisory council applications (if approved); survey last call.

What to measure: survey responses by school and grade (goal: at least 25 for every high school and grade); followers (goal: 100 by winter break); messages through the site's form; new co-leads (goal: 3, including at least one from East).

Wider Student Survey: What Good Student Voice Looks Like

The first step toward the June 2027 goal: ask students across the district what student voice working well looks and sounds like, then set goals from their answers. Planned in response to Dr. Morgan's October 20 feedback.

Who we need to hear from:

- Sun Prairie West, grades 9–12: 25+ per grade, through SP30, Student Senate and the newsletter
- Sun Prairie East, grades 9–12: 25+ per grade, through SP30, East co-leads and the newsletter
- Prairie Phoenix Academy and Sun Prairie Virtual: as many as possible, through a staff contact at each
- Middle schools (grade 8): a pilot with one or two schools, principal-approved, short version
- Spanish-speaking students: included in every group, with a Spanish version and ELL teachers

Optional questions on school, grade, and how students describe their identity will check whether the people who answered match the district, and gaps will be reported honestly.

Draft questions (5 minutes):

1. Which school and grade are you in?
2. Do you know where to bring an idea or concern at school? (Yes / Not sure / No)

3. In the last year, did you ever see something change because students asked for it? If yes, what?
4. When something serious happens at school, how do you usually find out? (District/school message, teacher, friends, social media, news, I don't)
5. Rate: "Adults in my school listen to students' ideas." (1–5)
6. What would student voice working well look or sound like at your school? (open)
7. Which matter most to you right now? (pick up to 3: safety, mental health, grades and class rank, schedules, lunch, communication, fairness in discipline, clubs and activities, other)
8. How would you want to hear back about student input? (newsletter, Instagram, in class, website, email)
9. Would you want to be part of a student advisory council? (Yes / Maybe / No)
10. Anything else district leaders should know? (open)

Timeline: November 2026 — share draft questions with Dr. Morgan, translate, get approval to share through district channels · December 1–18, 2026 — survey open, with weekly checks on who has answered · January 2027 — public, anonymous results report and three to five goals with benchmarks, shared with the advisory council at its first meeting · May 2027 — short follow-up survey for the June 2027 check-in.

Privacy: anonymous by default, with no names or student IDs; results shared only as summaries, and quotes only when they can't identify anyone; any serious safety concern a student writes about is passed to district staff, and the survey says so up front.

How to Start Student Voice at Your School (a guide for any student)

1. Start with one clear letter. Write to your principal or School Board about one thing students are worried about. Say what happened, how it affects students, and two or three specific, doable asks. Keep

it respectful. You're asking to be part of the solution, not blaming anyone.

2. Ask for a meeting, then write it down. Ask for 30 minutes. Bring a one-page handout. Take notes, and ask before recording. Within two days, email a short recap ("so we all leave with the same notes"). That recap is what turns a nice conversation into a commitment.
3. Get real input, not just your friends'. Run a short anonymous survey in every language families speak. Share it through teachers and newsletters, not only social media. Report who answered, including who's missing.
4. Keep a public record. Post short updates: what you asked, what you were told, what changed. A free website and an Instagram account are enough. Give district leaders a chance to correct anything before you post it, and set a deadline.
5. Track promises. Keep a "You said, we did" list. Every commitment gets an owner, a date and a status. Celebrate wins publicly; it's the best proof that speaking up works.
6. Join the groups that already exist. Work groups, Student Senate and Board student sessions are where decisions get made. Ask to join them before starting something new.
7. Protect people. Don't post names of students, private phone numbers, or rumors about staff. Stick to facts from public records and the news. If someone tells you they're unsafe, help them reach a trusted adult right away.
8. Make it last after you graduate. Recruit co-leads from different grades and schools early. Share passwords and files with them. Push for something permanent, like an advisory council, so student voice doesn't depend on one person.

Handoff plan for SPASD Student Voice: recruit 3 co-leads by December 2026, including one from East and one underclassman; share the Instagram, website and records with them by March 2027; co-leads run the April and May updates; full handoff by June 2027.

"You Said, We Did": Semester Update (template for the district)

A suggested one-page format the district could publish twice a year (January and June), so every student can see what happened to their input. Suggested by students in the October 20, 2026 meeting with Dr. Morgan and Ms. Bevenue.

- Opening (2–3 sentences): This semester, students shared ideas through [surveys, the student advisory council, Student Senate, meetings]. Here's what we heard and what happened.
- What changed: "Students never got the district newsletter" → newsletters now go to students as well as families (November 2026). "Harder classes should count more toward GPA" → [weighted grades decision, if approved]. [Student input] → [Action] → [Date].
- In progress: "Students want to know when outside agencies get involved and when parents are told" → [student rights guide in progress], next update [date].
- What we can't do, and why: [student input] — [plain reason, naming the law when one applies] — [what we can do instead].
- How to share an idea: [where students bring ideas: the advisory council rep at your school, the student survey, your principal, or a form]. Students should hear back within 30 days.

Tips: keep it to one page, write it for a 9th grader, publish it in the student newsletter and on the district website, and translate it into Spanish.

Student Voice Flyer



SPASD Student Voice flyer, October 2026

9. Tracking & Accountability

What was promised, what is still unanswered, and what this record is waiting on.

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Promises Tracker

Every commitment an official made in writing, with where it came from and where it stands as of November 10, 2026. "Pending" means the date or condition hasn't arrived yet; it is not a judgment that anyone failed.

Who	Commitment	When	Status
Marlita Bevenue, Co mmunications	District family newsletters will also go to students, starting in November	Oct 20 meeting; in writing Oct 21	**Pending**: first issue not yet received
District	Confirmed LGBTQIA+ protections are unchanged	Oct 1	**Kept**
Chief Warych	Send a written ALPR FAQ	Promised Oct 13	**Kept**: sent Oct 16

Who	Commitment	When	Status
SPPD FAQ	The city owns the data; no federal access; no sharing with 287(g) agencies; every search logged with a reason	Oct 16	Statement, not yet a contract term
Chief Warych	No livestreaming with Axon	Oct 27	**Pending** contract and policy
Chief Warych	Axon retention starts as a 14-day, three-month trial; moves to 21 days only if investigations are affected	Oct 27	**Pending** approval
Chief Warych	Searches audited monthly by a Detective Sergeant	Oct 27	**Pending** approval
Chief Warych	Post the ALPR policy (F-18) on the SPPD website if approved	Oct 27	**Pending** approval
Chief Warych	Make the data-sharing MOU a public document after signing	Oct 27	**Pending** signing
Chief Warych	Follow up on whether Flock audit logs are kept	Oct 27	**Open**: no follow-up yet
Chief Warych	Consider a quarterly ALPR transparency report once Axon is approved	Nov 9	**Pending** approval
Dr. Antoine Reed	"Find time to connect" on the student council	Oct 30	**Kept**: met Nov 4
Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr.	Follow-up meeting on the Oct 20 items	Asked Nov 4	**Kept**: meeting set for Nov 18
Karen Richmond	Answer how Board student reps are chosen	Asked Nov 4	**Kept**: answered Nov 5
Principal Bartelt	3–5 Patrick Marsh Peer Ambassadors for the council	Nov 5	**Pending**: planning meeting Nov 12
Principal Barrett	Explore how Prairie Phoenix students can take part once the structure is clear	Nov 5	**Pending**

Who	Commitment	When	Status
Sarah Dianich	Share the invitation with East students once the council is school-sponsored	Nov 6 and Nov 10	Waiting on approval
Mr. Medema	Review the Act 95 guides again after the weighted grades decision	Nov 9	**Pending** vote

Still Unanswered

Questions Zackary has asked in writing that have no answer yet, as of November 10, 2026.

Asked	To	Question
Oct 2; again Nov 6	Mayor Stocker	A 20-minute meeting; would the city consider a non-voting youth seat on a committee or a yearly youth listening session?
Oct 27	Chief Warych	Are Flock audit logs kept after the Flock cameras come out? (He said he would follow up.)
Oct 29	Dr. Mould	Students' role and time at the Nov 9 Board meeting; the date of the final vote
Nov 5	Dr. Reed	How a district-level student group registers, and who should sponsor it
Nov 6	Ms. Bevenue	A recurring plain-language Board agenda preview in the student newsletter
Nov 6	Board President McFarland	A monthly student update on Board agendas; five written questions about the Board for students
Nov 6	Mayor and city staff	Will six ALPR terms be written into the contract or policy before the vote, and when can residents comment?
Nov 7	Board of Education	Five questions about the superintendent licensing situation
Nov 9	City records office	Public records request PD-2399-2026 (Axon estimate, F-18, data-sharing agreements, audit records)

Asked	To	Question
Nov 5	Eric Nee, Sun Prairie West	Registering the District-Wide Student Council as a student group
Nov 5	Gavin Christianson, Student Council adviser, Sun Prairie West	Sharing the council at a Student Council meeting
Nov 6	Caryn Peters, teacher	A 30-minute class lesson on a real district decision
Nov 9	Sun Prairie Area Chamber of Commerce	Would members put a "Your school. Your say." counter card by their register?
Nov 10	Jennifer Loranger, Central Heights	A 15–20 minute meeting about the council

Nov 11	Mayor and Common Council	How the public can weigh in before the Axon contract; regular public reporting; a set review schedule
Nov 11	UW Law School	A legal accuracy review of the ALPR site
Nov 11	HNG News / Adams Publishing; Sun Prairie Media Center	Story pitch on the plate reader switch

Waiting On

Items that will be added as soon as they exist or arrive.

Waiting on	Expected	Source
What the Board asked at the Nov 9 weighted grades meeting	Now	Zackary's notes
Final weighted grades vote	Late November	Board of Education
City budget vote on the Axon cameras	Nov 17	City Council
Dr. Reed's answer on how the council registers	—	Email
Patrick Marsh planning meeting notes	Nov 12	Zackary's notes
Public records requests PD-2399-2026 and PD-2426-2026, and the district request of Nov 11	—	City records office
Letter to the editor, if published	—	Sun Prairie Star
Chamber of Commerce reply and counter card design	—	Email; design file
SP30 slide and poster, ALPR transparency template, family FAQ, Act 95 guides, class lesson	Now	Files from Zackary
Ask the District questions and answers	Ongoing	Instagram
New Instagram posts and November website screenshots	Now	Zackary
Student Senate updates and election totals (no names)	—	Student Senate
Staff weighted grades survey analysis	—	Copy from the school account
The district's first student newsletter	November	District
Updated Policy F-18	After approval	SPPD
Student climate survey totals	When compiled	Survey

Waiting on	Expected	Source
Notes from the Nov 18 follow-up meeting with Dr. Morgan	Nov 18	Zackary's notes
Nov 10–11 emails with Central Heights, Patrick Marsh and the Nov 17 meeting organizers	Next update	Gmail

You Said, We Did: November 2026

A monthly public update. What students asked for, and what happened.

You said	We did	Status
Students wanted to hear about district decisions directly	Asked for student newsletters at the Oct 20 meeting	**Won** — district committed in writing Oct 21; first issue expected this month
Harder classes should count more (78% in the Act 95 survey)	Students helped write the weighted grades plan and previewed it with Board members Nov 2	**Moving** — at the Board Nov 9; final vote expected late November
Students from every school need a way to talk to the district	Proposed a District-Wide Student Council and invited every middle and high school	**Building** — Patrick Marsh signed on; others responding
Residents want to know how plate reader data is used	Got written answers from the Chief, filed a public records request, wrote a letter to the editor	**Asked in writing** — city budget vote Nov 17
How can a student serve on the School Board?	Asked the superintendent's office	**Answered** — recruiting starts in December

Asked vs. Answered

Written asks to each office and whether a written answer came back, as of November 11, 2026. Counts only asks listed in the Promises Tracker and Still Unanswered pages. A slow answer isn't a refusal; many of these are days old.

Office	Answered in writing	Still open
Superintendent's office	Meeting granted (Nov 4); Board rep selection explained (Nov 5)	How the council registers and who sponsors it
Board of Education	—	Monthly student update idea; licensing questions (Nov 7)
Equity & Inclusion / Communications	Newsletter commitment (Oct 21); follow-up meeting set for Nov 18	Board agenda preview idea
Principals	Patrick Marsh, Prairie Phoenix, Central Heights, East, Prairie View replied	West: next step for a district-level club
SPPD (Chief Warych)	FAQ (Oct 16); written answers (Oct 27); open to a transparency report (Nov 9)	Flock audit logs
Mayor and city staff	—	Meeting request (since Oct 2); six terms before the vote; youth seat
Common Council	—	Three questions (Nov 11)

Records Requests

Every public records request Zackary has filed. Wisconsin law requires records custodians to respond "as soon as practicable and without delay"; there is no fixed deadline.

Filed	Agency	Number	What was asked	Status
Nov 9, 2026	City of Sun Prairie (SPPD records portal)	PD-2399-2026	Axon estimate, Policy F-18, data-sharing agreements, audit records	Waiting
Nov 11, 2026	City of Sun Prairie (records portal)	PD-2426-2026	See Zackary's request (the confirmation lists only the number)	Waiting
Nov 11, 2026	Sun Prairie Area School District	—	Contracts and data privacy agreements for student monitoring and device management tools; weighted grades work group materials not yet shared; aggregate safety incident data for 2024–25 and 2025–26 (totals and categories only)	Acknowledged Nov 11; district may charge a fee if search costs exceed $50

Results will be added here, with officer names, case numbers and any student information blacked out.

Public Comment Log

Every time Zackary took part in a public meeting, in person or in writing to a public body. Details come from the meeting log and emails in this record.

Date	Body	How	Topic
Jan 26, 2026	Board of Education (Act 95 public hearing)	Presented with the student Act 95 group	Survey findings and a recommendation on class rank and weighted GPA
Oct 7, 2026	Public Safety Committee	Meeting where the Axon plan was heard (community report sent to the Chief Oct 6)	Plate readers: Flock to Axon
Nov 9, 2026	Board of Education, Committee of the Whole	Student work group (notes pending)	Weighted grades plan
Nov 11, 2026	Mayor and Common Council	Written comment to all alders	Three questions on public input, reporting and review of the plate reader program

Add to this table each time you speak or write to a public body.

Media and Press

Date	Outlet	What
Nov 3, 2026	Sun Prairie Area School District	Feature story: "Making a Difference Through Student Voice" (full text in Part 8)
Nov 8, 2026	Sun Prairie Star (HNG News)	Letter to the editor on plate readers sent; publication not yet confirmed
Nov 11, 2026	HNG News / Adams Publishing; Sun Prairie Media Center	Story pitch on the plate reader switch sent; no reply yet

By the Numbers

The numbers behind this record. Each figure has its date and source.

Figure	What it counts	As of	Source
206	Numbered email cards in this record (E-001 to E-206)	Nov 10, 2026	This record
33	Meetings in the meeting log	Nov 10, 2026	Meeting log
903	Students who answered the Act 95 survey	Jan 2026	Caregiver survey analysis (citing the Act 95 student survey)
78%	Of those choosing a ranking option, share who picked weighted GPA	Jan 2026	Caregiver survey analysis (citing the Act 95 student survey)
531	Caregivers who answered the weighted grades survey	Oct 22, 2026	Caregiver survey analysis
70%	Caregivers who support weighted grades	Oct 22, 2026	Caregiver survey analysis
6	Schools invited to the District-Wide Student Council	Nov 4, 2026	Council invitations
1	Schools signed on (Patrick Marsh)	Nov 5, 2026	Principal Bartelt's email
2	Written district answers on student asks (newsletters to students; LGBTQIA+ protections unchanged)	Oct 21, 2026	District emails, Oct 1 and Oct 21
$235,388.97	Proposed 10-year Axon cost	Draft dated fall 2026	Axon estimate Q-932192-001
2	Instagram accounts and 2 websites run by Zackary	Nov 10, 2026	@spasdstudentvoice, @sunprairiealpr

District-Wide Student Council: Schools

Where each school stands on the District-Wide Student Council, as of November 10, 2026. Every letter was copied to Dr. Reed.

School	Grades	Status	Latest
Patrick Marsh Middle	6–8	SIGNED ON	3–5 Peer Ambassadors; planning meeting with Principal Bartelt and Ms. Kvalheim Nov 12
Prairie Phoenix Academy	9–12	SUPPORTIVE	Principal Barrett will explore how students can take part once the structure is clear
Sun Prairie East	9–12	WAITING	Offered the newsletter and SP30, then said Nov 10 it can't share with students until the council is school-sponsored
Central Heights Middle	6–8	NEXT STEP	Mr. Roth suggested starting with its Student Council; meeting requested with Ms. Loranger (Nov 10)
Sun Prairie West	9–12	UNCLEAR	Principal Shoemaker: not sure of the next step for a district-level club
Prairie View Middle	6–8	TALKING	Principal Jensen asked which topics students would weigh in on (Nov 3 Student Voice letter); no reply yet on the council

What Changed for Students

Concrete things students will notice, and when. As of November 11, 2026.

- **District newsletters will reach students directly.** Committed in writing Oct 21. *Watch for the first issue.*
- **Students sat in on principal interviews and met the superintendent finalists** (spring 2026). *Ask for the same next time a leader is hired.*
- **Sun Prairie West has a Student Senate again** (elected April 2026).
- **Weighted grades may change how GPA and class rank work.** *Final Board vote expected late November.*
- **A District-Wide Student Council is being built** with schools one at a time. *Patrick Marsh is first.*
- **The district will meet with students again on Nov 18** about a student advisory council, sharing the student survey district-wide, a recurring check-in, and a "you said, we did" update.

10. Get Involved

How any student or family member can do what is in this record.

IN THIS PART

Upcoming Public Meetings	p. 314
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How a Decision Gets Made	p. 321
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In Their Words: Anonymous Student & Family Voices	p. 323

Upcoming Public Meetings

Public meetings coming up, and how to take part. Check the official agenda before you go; times can change.

Date	Meeting	How to take part
Thu, Nov 12, 3:00 PM	Patrick Marsh planning meeting for the student council (not public)	—
Tue, Nov 17, 10:00 AM	Weighted grades follow-up with district and school leaders (not public)	—
Wed, Nov 18, 1:50 PM	Follow-up with Dr. Morgan on student voice (not public)	—
Tue, Nov 17	City Council: final 2027 budget vote, including the plate readers	Check the city's posted agenda for the place and how to comment; email the Mayor and your alder before
Late November	Board of Education: final weighted grades vote (date not yet posted)	Sign up for public comment per the posted agenda

Date	Meeting	How to take part
December	Board student representative recruiting begins	Watch for the announcement
Mid-January 2027	Applications open for Board student representatives (current sophomores)	Apply through the district

How to Speak Up

How any student or family member can do what's in this record.

Email a district leader

1. Find the right person. The Who's who page and the district website list roles.
2. Keep it short: who you are, what you're asking, and one clear question.
3. Ask for something specific: an answer, a meeting, or a document.
4. If there's no reply after a week, follow up once, politely.

Speak at a Board of Education meeting

1. Check the posted agenda on BoardDocs (go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf).
2. Sign up for public comment the way the agenda describes, usually before the meeting starts.
3. Plan for about three minutes. Say your name, your school, your point and one ask.
4. Bring a written copy to hand in.

Talk to the Board's student representatives

They serve two-year terms, from the end of sophomore year through senior year. Recruiting starts in December and applications open in mid-January. You can reach the current reps any time.

Ask the city for public records

Wisconsin's public records law lets anyone ask for government records. Police records go through the city's online records portal; other city records go to the City Clerk. Describe exactly what you want and the date range.

Comment on a city decision

Email the Mayor and the committee, speak during public comment in Council Chambers at 300 E. Main St., or ask your alder where they stand. The City Clerk's office can tell you how to sign up.

Email Templates

Fill in the brackets and keep it short.

Asking a district leader a question

Subject: Question about [topic]

Hi [Name],

My name is [your name], and I'm a student at [school]. I've been following [topic] and want to make sure I understand it correctly.

[One or two specific questions.]

Thank you for your time. I'd be glad to talk if that's easier.

[Your name]

Asking for a meeting

Subject: Could we meet about [topic]?

Hi [Name],

I'd like 15–20 minutes to talk about [topic]. I'm free [two or three times]. I can meet in person or online.

Thank you,

[Your name]

Following up

Subject: Following up: [original subject]

Hi [Name],

I wanted to follow up on my email from [date] about [topic]. I know you're busy. If someone else is the right person, I'd appreciate a pointer.

Thank you,

[Your name]

Public records request (Wisconsin)

To the records custodian:

Under Wisconsin's public records law, I request copies of [describe the records] for the period [start date] to [end date]. Please send them electronically if possible. If you deny any part of this request, please explain why in writing. If any part is redacted, please release the rest.

Thank you,

[Your name]

FAQ About These Projects

Is this official? No. SPASD Student Voice and Sun Prairie ALPR are independent, student-led projects. They are not run by the Sun Prairie Area School District, the City of Sun Prairie or the police department.

Who writes it? Zackary Mark. Officials' words are quoted from their own emails, and every email is shown with its sender and date.

Who pays for it? No one. There is no funding and no sponsor.

Why are other students' names missing? Only Zackary's name appears. Other students are described by their role ("a work group member") to protect their privacy.

Is anything left out? Yes: raw survey responses, raw meeting recordings and transcripts, personal matters and unrelated class projects. Nothing was left out to change what an official said.

Can I join? Yes. DM @spasdstudentvoice or @sunprairiealpr, or email studentvoicesp@gmail.com (Student Voice) or sunprairiealpr@gmail.com (plate readers). No experience needed.

What if something here is wrong? Email the project address above. Corrections are listed in the Corrections log with the date they were made.

How a Decision Gets Made

Simplified. Exact steps vary; check the posted agenda for each meeting.

How a school district decision gets made

1. **Staff or a work group drafts it.** Example: the weighted grades work group, with students in it.
2. **A Board committee or the Committee of the Whole discusses it.** Example: Nov 2 (Teaching & Learning Committee) and Nov 9 (Committee of the Whole).
3. **It goes on a regular Board meeting agenda for a vote.** Public comment usually comes near the start.
4. **The Board votes.** A majority passes it.
5. **District staff carry it out.** That's when "you said, we did" gets tested.

Where students can step in: join the work group, email Board members before steps 2 and 3, speak during public comment, and check that step 5 happens.

How a city budget decision gets made

1. **Departments request funding.** Example: SPPD's plan to move from Flock to Axon.
2. **Staff and the Mayor put together a proposed budget.**
3. **Committees and budget work sessions review it.** Example: Oct 27 and Nov 10 work sessions.
4. **The Common Council holds a public hearing and adopts the budget.** Planned for Nov 17.
5. **Contracts and policies follow.** The Axon contract, Policy F-18 and data-sharing agreements come after the money is approved.

Where residents can step in: email alders before step 3, speak at the budget hearing in step 4, and ask for contract terms to be public before step 5.

Lessons for Student Advocates

Practical things that worked this year, from the emails in this record.

- **Send the email.** Most changes here started with one short, polite email to the right person.
- **Ask one clear question.** "Will these six terms be in the contract before the vote?" gets a better answer than a long list of concerns.
- **Follow up once, kindly.** Many replies came after a second email.
- **Put it in writing.** After a meeting, send a recap of what was agreed. That's how the newsletter commitment became a written one.
- **Find the right door.** When someone says "that's not my call," ask who decides and go there.
- **Say what you're not.** Stating that the projects are independent heads off confusion.
- **Keep receipts.** Save every email and note. This archive exists because of that habit.
- **Protect other students.** Use roles, not names, in anything public.
- **Correct mistakes in public.** A corrections log builds more trust than pretending to be perfect.

In Their Words: Anonymous Student & Family Voices

Anonymous words from students and families, copied as written. No names or identifying details.

"Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen." — a student, winter 2026 outreach

"Harder schedules should be rewarded." — a caregiver, October 2026 survey

"Extra incentive to take advanced classes" — a caregiver, October 2026 survey

"Need more information. Pros and cons." — a caregiver, October 2026 survey

"Every class should have equal importance." — a caregiver, October 2026 survey

"It's not equitable" — a caregiver, October 2026 survey

11. Looking Ahead

Drafts and plans for 2027. Nothing here is approved or final.

IN THIS PART

Goals for 2027 (draft)	p. 324
District-Wide Student Council Charter (draft)	p. 325
Council Meeting Notes	p. 326

Goals for 2027 (draft)

Draft for Zackary to edit.

SPASD Student Voice

- Get the District-Wide Student Council approved as a school-sponsored pilot with a staff partner.
- Launch the district-wide student survey in December and publish the results.
- Keep the monthly "You said, we did" report going all year.
- Recruit at least one student contact at every middle and high school.

Sun Prairie ALPR

- See the retention period, audit rules and data-sharing agreement in writing.
- Publish the first quarterly transparency numbers if SPPD releases them.
- Get the records requests answered and posted.
- Have the site legally reviewed for accuracy.

Both

- Plan the handoff so both projects continue after Zackary.

District-Wide Student Council Charter (draft)

Draft for discussion with Dr. Reed and the schools. Nothing here is approved.

Name. SPASD District-Wide Student Council (pilot).

Purpose. Give students from every middle and high school a regular way to share input with district leaders, and report back what changed.

Members. Each participating school chooses 3–6 students through its own process (for example, Patrick Marsh's Peer Ambassadors or a school's Student Council). Members serve for one school year.

Staff partner. A district staff member named by the superintendent's office, plus a staff contact at each school.

Meetings. Once a month during the school year, virtual or rotating between schools. Agendas posted a week ahead.

What it does.

1. Collects student questions and concerns from each school.
2. Meets with a district leader at least once a semester.
3. Publishes a short "you said, we did" update after each meeting.
4. Shares notes publicly without student names.

Decisions. By majority of members present. The council advises; it doesn't set district policy.

Review. At the end of the pilot year, members and the staff partner decide whether to continue and what to change.

Council Meeting Notes

Council meetings haven't started yet. Once they do, notes will go here after each meeting, with students listed by school only.

Appendix

Reference pages: people, the full timeline, corrections, statements and sources.

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Resumen en español (Spanish Summary)	p. 335
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Who's Who

The officials and staff who appear most often in this record, by role. Titles are as of fall 2026.

Name	Role	Appears in
Dr. Antoine Reed	Superintendent, SPASD	Student council, Nov 4 meeting
Karen Richmond	Executive Assistant for the Superintendent and Board Leadership	Scheduling, Board student reps
Diana McFarland	President, Board of Education	Student update idea, licensing questions
Melissa Grayson, Amanda Davis	Board members, Teaching & Learning Committee	Weighted grades preview
Dr. Curtis Mould	Director of Digital Media, Innovation and Strategy; weighted grades work group lead	Weighted grades, caregiver survey

Name	Role	Appears in
Dr. Taren Turner	Assistant Superintendent of Teaching, Learning & Equity	Aug 27 meeting, work group
Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr.	Director of Systemic Equity and Inclusion	Oct 20 meeting
Marlita Bevenue	Director of Strategic Communications	Oct 20 meeting, student newsletter
Peggy Shoemaker	Principal, Sun Prairie West	Student Senate, council
Jim Ertel; Sarah Dianich	Principal; LT Principal Substitute, Sun Prairie East	Council outreach
Nehemirah Barrett	Principal of Alternative Education Programs (Prairie Phoenix Academy)	Council outreach
Shawn Bartelt; Tiffany Kvalheim	Principal; school counselor, Patrick Marsh	Council pilot
Michelle Jensen	Principal, Prairie View	Council outreach
Mark Roth; Jennifer Loranger	Building leader (signs as Principal); Student Council lead, Central Heights	Council outreach
Keith Medema	School counselor, Sun Prairie West	Act 95 guides
Kevin Warych	Chief of Police, SPPD	Plate readers
Mayor Stocker	Mayor, City of Sun Prairie	Meeting request, ALPR terms

Master Timeline

- **Jan 13** — Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board of Education.
- **Jan 26** — Act 95 students present survey findings at a public hearing.
- **Feb 26** — Weighted grades work group begins.
- **Mar 2** — Student advocacy meeting with school and district leaders.
- **April** — Principal interviews, superintendent candidate session (Apr 13), Student Senate elected (Apr 27), Report A published.
- **Jul 10** — First meeting with Chief Warych about Flock cameras.
- **August** — Meetings on the budget (Aug 18), with Dr. Turner (Aug 27) and with the Chief (Aug 17).
- **Sept 23** — Weighted grades work group restarts for 2026–27.
- **Oct 1** — District confirms in writing that LGBTQIA+ protections are unchanged.
- **Oct 6–7** — Community ALPR report sent to the Chief; Public Safety Committee hears the Axon plan.
- **Oct 16** — SPPD sends a written ALPR FAQ.
- **Oct 20–22** — Meeting with district leaders, newsletter commitment, caregiver survey analysis.
- **Oct 27–29** — Chief's written answers, two new Instagram series, advisory council proposal to Dr. Reed.
- **Oct 30** — Dr. Reed: "I love this idea."
- **Nov 2** — Students preview weighted grades with the Board's Teaching & Learning Committee.
- **Nov 3** — Outreach to five more schools.
- **Nov 3** — The district publishes a feature on Zackary's advocacy, "Making a Difference Through Student Voice."
- **Nov 4** — Meeting with Dr. Reed; District-Wide Student Council invitations go to every middle and high school.
- **Nov 5** — Patrick Marsh signs on; Prairie Phoenix supportive.

- **Nov 6** — East offers to share the invitation; The district's Nov 3 newsletter feature, "Making a Difference Through Student Voice," added; follow-ups to the Board President, Dr. Morgan, the Chief and the Mayor.
- **Nov 7** — Letter to the Board of Education with questions about the superintendent's license.
- **Nov 8–9** — Zackary sent East an SP30 slide and poster; public records request and letter to the editor on plate readers; Chief open to a quarterly transparency report.
- **Nov 9** — Weighted grades plan goes to the Board's Committee of the Whole.
- **Nov 10** — Central Heights points the council to its Student Council; caregiver survey analysis released for the public record.
- **Coming up** — Nov 12 Patrick Marsh planning meeting, Nov 17 weighted grades follow-up and city budget approval, late November weighted grades vote.

Corrections Log

Changes made to correct earlier versions of this record. Routine additions are listed in "What Changed in Each Update."

Date	What changed
Oct 28, 2026	The Chief corrected the city budget schedule: there was no Nov 3 meeting. The meeting log was fixed.
Oct 30, 2026	Officials' personal cell numbers were removed. A second copy of the source documents was removed.
Nov 6, 2026	A drafted newsletter was replaced with the district's own Nov 3 article, copied word for word.
Nov 10, 2026	Zackary's school email address was replaced with "(school account)" on every card. A note in a forwarded email that didn't belong in the public record was removed. Grade-level words in the district article were bracketed. The caregiver survey analysis was restored after Dr. Mould said it could be shared (per Zackary).

Version History

Version	Date	Pages (full edition)	Highlights
3.1	Nov 11, 2026	see cover	Topic tags, thread links and bookmarks on every email; topic index; clickable indexes; part contents; new pages on records requests, public comments, decisions, Act 95, plate reader terms, other cities' incidents, council charter draft, goals; Nov 10–11 emails; large-print and text editions
3.0	Nov 10, 2026	344	Executive summary, trackers, two public volumes, numbered emails, color-coded parts, QR codes, index
2.x	Nov 9, 2026	288	Weighted grades, council and plate reader updates through Nov 9
1.x	Oct–Nov 2026	—	First combined archive of emails, meetings, surveys and reports

Independence, Funding & AI Use

Independence and funding

This record and both projects are independent and student-led. They are not affiliated with, approved by, or speaking for the Sun Prairie Area School District, the City of Sun Prairie, or the Sun Prairie Police Department. No one pays for this work, and no organization sponsors it.

How AI tools were used

Zackary uses AI tools to help draft, organize and format writing, including parts of this record. Facts, quotes and numbers are checked against the original emails and documents, and officials' emails are copied as written. If you find an error, it's Zackary's to fix, and corrections are logged at the back.

Handoff Plan

How these projects keep going when Zackary graduates or steps back. This is a plan, not a commitment from anyone named.

What exists

- Two Instagram accounts (@spasdstudentvoice, @sunprairiealpr) and two websites on free hosting.
- This record, rebuilt from the same sources each update.
- Open threads with the district, the city and SPPD (see Still Unanswered and the Promises Tracker).

Handoff steps

1. **Find two successors per project** before spring, ideally from different schools and grades, so one graduation doesn't end the work.
2. **Shared access.** Move both Instagram accounts and website logins to a shared project email, not a personal one. Turn on two-step sign-in.
3. **Introductions by email.** Introduce successors in writing to Dr. Reed's office, Dr. Mould, Ms. Bevenue, Chief Warych and the principals who replied, so the threads continue.
4. **The council.** Ask the district to name a staff sponsor so the District-Wide Student Council outlasts any one student.
5. **The record.** Keep publishing "You said, we did" monthly and a full update each semester. Keep the rules: no student names, emails as written, corrections logged.
6. **Overlap.** Run one full cycle together (one Board meeting and one city vote) before stepping away.

Resumen en español (Spanish Summary)

Resumen en español de este registro. Actualizado el 10 de noviembre de 2026.

Zackary Mark es un estudiante defensor en Sun Prairie West High School. Dirige dos proyectos independientes: **SPASD Student Voice** (desde enero de 2026), que lleva las opiniones de los estudiantes a los líderes del Distrito Escolar del Área de Sun Prairie, y **Sun Prairie ALPR** (desde julio de 2026), un informe comunitario en lenguaje sencillo sobre las cámaras lectoras de placas de la policía.

Lo que cambió gracias a los estudiantes

- Los boletines del distrito llegarán a todos los estudiantes (confirmado por escrito el 21 de octubre).
- El distrito confirmó por escrito el 1 de octubre que las protecciones LGBTQIA+ no cambian.
- Estudiantes participaron en las entrevistas de director y conocieron a los finalistas para superintendente; se reinició el Senado Estudiantil en Sun Prairie West.
- Estudiantes ayudaron a escribir el plan de calificaciones ponderadas, que llegó a la Junta el 9 de noviembre. Se espera la votación final a fines de noviembre.
- El superintendente, Dr. Reed, apoyó la idea de un Consejo Estudiantil de todo el distrito. Patrick Marsh ya se unió.
- El jefe de policía puso compromisos por escrito: una prueba de 14 días para guardar datos, sin transmisión en vivo, auditorías mensuales y un acuerdo público para compartir datos.

Encuesta a familias (octubre de 2026): 531 respuestas; el 70% apoya las calificaciones ponderadas.

Cámaras Axon propuestas: $235,388.97 en 10 años (estimado preliminar, no es un contrato). El Concejo Municipal vota el presupuesto el 17 de noviembre.

Cómo participar: escriba a @spasdstudentvoice en Instagram o a studentvoicesp@gmail.com (sobre las cámaras: sunprairiealpr@gmail.com). Puede hablar en las reuniones públicas de la Junta Escolar y del Concejo Municipal.

Sources

District rules and Board documents

- Board Procedure 3: Student Representatives to the School Board (12-9-24): https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/DBVRP26D6486/$file/Board%20Procedure%203%2C%20Student%20Representatives%20to%20the%20School%20Board%20(12-9-24).pdf
- Board Procedure 13: Formal Appeal Process: https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/DFRMCQ5A9EB0/$file/Board%20Procedure%2013%2C%20Formal%20Appeal%20Process.pdf
- OE-10: Learning Environment (revised 4-10-23): https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/CQSRUM6C41A4/$file/OE-10%20Learning%20Environment%20(Revised%204-10-23).pdf
- Board agendas and minutes (BoardDocs): https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf

Links rebuilt from emails in this record; a full link check is scheduled for the next update.

Where everything else in this record comes from

- Emails: Zackary's own inbox, including school email he forwarded. Each email appears once, as a numbered card.
- Meetings: calendar invites, emails and Zackary's notes.
- Surveys: summaries from the district and Zackary's own surveys. Raw responses are not published.
- Plate reader documents: the city, SPPD and public records (see the plate reader sources below).
- Instagram and websites: Zackary's own public accounts.

Topic Index

Every email card by topic. Click an E-number to jump to the card; the page follows in parentheses. Topics are assigned automatically from each email's words, so a card can have more than one.

Board of Education (21) — E-001 (p. 41), E-003 (p. 44), E-004 (p. 45), E-006 (p. 51), E-007 (p. 52), E-010 (p. 61), E-017 (p. 65), E-018 (p. 66), E-019 (p. 66), E-020 (p. 67), E-021 (p. 68), E-050 (p. 91), E-071 (p. 149), E-079 (p. 155), E-094 (p. 167), E-100 (p. 171), E-129 (p. 228), E-130 (p. 229), E-133 (p. 230), E-136 (p. 231), E-137 (p. 232)

Budget (7) — E-161 (p. 259), E-162 (p. 259), E-163 (p. 260), E-164 (p. 261), E-165 (p. 262), E-166 (p. 262), E-167 (p. 262)

Newsletter (10) — E-060 (p. 140), E-061 (p. 142), E-067 (p. 145), E-071 (p. 149), E-079 (p. 155), E-081 (p. 157), E-096 (p. 169), E-098 (p. 170), E-099 (p. 171), E-104 (p. 174)

Plate readers (1) — E-058 (p. 138)

Records requests (1) — E-212 (p. 182)

Safety & mental health (27) — E-001 (p. 41), E-002 (p. 44), E-003 (p. 44), E-004 (p. 45), E-005 (p. 48), E-006 (p. 51), E-007 (p. 52), E-008 (p. 58), E-009 (p. 60), E-015 (p. 64), E-016 (p. 64), E-025 (p. 70), E-026 (p. 71), E-060 (p. 140), E-067 (p. 145), E-079 (p. 155), E-081 (p. 157), E-083 (p. 158), E-084 (p. 159), E-161 (p. 259), E-162 (p. 259), E-168 (p. 263), E-169 (p. 264), E-171 (p. 265), E-173 (p. 266), E-175 (p. 267), E-212 (p. 182)

Student council (39) — E-007 (p. 52), E-019 (p. 66), E-033 (p. 76), E-034 (p. 77), E-054 (p. 134), E-060 (p. 140), E-067 (p. 145), E-068 (p. 147), E-069 (p. 148), E-070 (p. 149), E-071 (p. 149), E-072 (p. 151), E-073 (p. 151), E-074 (p. 152), E-075 (p. 152), E-076 (p. 153), E-077 (p. 154), E-078 (p. 154), E-079 (p. 155), E-080 (p. 156), E-081 (p. 157), E-083 (p. 158), E-084 (p. 159), E-085 (p. 161), E-086 (p. 162), E-087 (p. 162), E-088 (p. 163), E-089 (p. 164), E-090 (p. 164), E-091 (p. 165), E-092 (p. 166), E-095 (p. 168), E-096 (p. 169), E-098

(p. 170), E-103 (p. 173), E-107 (p. 176), E-108 (p. 177), E-173 (p. 266), E-175 (p. 267)

Surveys (22) — E-001 (p. 41), E-050 (p. 91), E-054 (p. 134), E-058 (p. 138), E-060 (p. 140), E-081 (p. 157), E-083 (p. 158), E-098 (p. 170), E-113 (p. 219), E-114 (p. 219), E-115 (p. 220), E-116 (p. 220), E-117 (p. 221), E-118 (p. 221), E-124 (p. 225), E-128 (p. 227), E-130 (p. 229), E-133 (p. 230), E-136 (p. 231), E-209 (p. 180), E-210 (p. 181), E-211 (p. 182)

Weighted grades (43) — E-006 (p. 51), E-009 (p. 60), E-015 (p. 64), E-022 (p. 68), E-036 (p. 79), E-037 (p. 79), E-039 (p. 80), E-049 (p. 91), E-050 (p. 91), E-060 (p. 140), E-067 (p. 145), E-071 (p. 149), E-072 (p. 151), E-073 (p. 151), E-079 (p. 155), E-081 (p. 157), E-100 (p. 171), E-101 (p. 172), E-102 (p. 173), E-106 (p. 176), E-113 (p. 219), E-114 (p. 219), E-115 (p. 220), E-116 (p. 220), E-117 (p. 221), E-119 (p. 222), E-120 (p. 222), E-121 (p. 224), E-122 (p. 224), E-123 (p. 224), E-124 (p. 225), E-125 (p. 226), E-126 (p. 226), E-127 (p. 227), E-128 (p. 227), E-129 (p. 228), E-130 (p. 229), E-133 (p. 230), E-136 (p. 231), E-138 (p. 232), E-139 (p. 233), E-140 (p. 233), E-212 (p. 182)

Index

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About Me

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I'm Zackary Mark, a student at Sun Prairie West High School.

This work started in January 2026 with an email to the Board of Education about student safety and trust, and it kept growing from there: the Act 95 and weighted grades work group, the student voice survey and public reports, meetings with district leaders about the budget, mental health and student voice, and a community report on Sun Prairie's license plate reader cameras.

I'm not part of a formal organization. I do this on my own and alongside other students because I think young people should be able to understand the decisions that affect them and ask questions of the people who make them.

Outside of advocacy, I teach martial arts at Kicks Unlimited in Sun Prairie, speak English and Spanish, and compete on the SPWHS Forensics team. I plan to become a social studies teacher.

I run two projects: SPASD Student Voice (spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app, @spasdstudentvoice) for student voice in the district, and Sun Prairie ALPR (sunprairiealpr.netlify.app, @sunprairiealpr), an independent look at the city's license plate reader cameras.

Contact

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SPASD Student Voice

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Sun Prairie ALPR (SP-ALPR)

- Website: https://sunprairiealpr.netlify.app
- Instagram: @sunprairiealpr
- Email: sunprairiealpr@gmail.com

Thank You

Thank you to everyone in these pages who answered an email, made time to meet, or pointed me to the right person: the Board of Education, district and school staff, Chief Warych and the Sun Prairie Police Department, and city staff and elected officials.

And thank you to the students, families and community members who filled out the survey, commented, asked questions and shared what they were going through. This is your work too.

I keep these records in one place so the conversations, answers and commitments don't get lost. If you have questions, ideas or corrections, I'd like to hear from you.

People who answered, met, or pointed Zackary in the right direction this year (by role; listing someone here does not mean they endorse anything in this record):

Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed and Karen Richmond; Dr. Curtis Mould and Dr. Taren Turner; Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr. and Marlita Bevenue; Board members Melissa Grayson and Amanda Davis;

Principals Peggy Shoemaker, Shawn Bartelt, Nehemirah Barrett, Michelle Jensen, Mark Roth and Jim Ertel; Sarah Dianich, Tiffany Kvalheim, Jennifer Loranger and Keith Medema; Chief Kevin Warych; and the city clerk's office.

What Changed in Each Update

- **November 11, 2026 (version 3.1)** — Added Nov 10–11 emails (council, records requests, media pitch, legal review request, Mayor follow-ups, East and the Nov 18 meeting) and the Nov 18 meeting. New pages: Act 95 timeline, plate reader glossary, problems found elsewhere, asked vs. answered, records requests, public comment log, media and press, what changed for students, how a decision gets made, lessons for student advocates, goals for 2027, student council charter draft, council notes, version history. Every email now has topic tags, links to the rest of its conversation, and its own bookmark; new emails are marked. Added a clickable topic index, clickable page numbers in the index, roles in the people index, and a contents list on each part's first page. New editions: large print, smaller email-friendly files, text-only files and single-section PDFs. Email numbers from v3.0 stay the same; new emails start at E-207.
- **November 10, 2026 (version 3.0)** — Rebuilt from Zackary's picks. New: executive summary, part introductions, Promises Tracker, Still Unanswered, Waiting On, You Said We Did, By the Numbers with dates and sources, council schools table, Flock vs. Axon table and 10-year cost chart, other Wisconsin cities, survey results summary, Ask the District log, meeting calendar, How to Speak Up, email templates, FAQ, anonymous voices, Who's Who, master timeline, corrections log, independence and AI statements, handoff plan, Spanish summary, Board procedure links and an index. Emails numbered E-001 onward; meeting log now opens with a table; larger type; color-coded parts; status labels; QR codes and version number on the cover; contents link on every page; plate reader sources moved to the appendix. Released the caregiver survey analysis. Removed the school email address and a class-year reference. Two public volumes added: Student Voice and ALPR. Project email addresses added: studentvoicesp@gmail.com and sunprairiealpr@gmail.com.

- **November 9, 2026** — Added the Chief's reply on a quarterly transparency report, the plate reader public records request and the clerk's reply, a letter to the editor, the reply to Sun Prairie East with an SP30 slide and poster, an outreach email to the Chamber of Commerce, and the Nov 9 Board meeting details.
- **November 6, 2026** — Added the district's Nov 3 newsletter feature, "Making a Difference Through Student Voice," word for word with its photo, Sun Prairie East's reply, Dr. Morgan's note, the Nov 4 next steps with Dr. Reed and the student Q&A, and the Nov 6 follow-ups to the Board President, communications, Dr. Mould, the Chief and the Mayor.
- **November 5, 2026** — Added the District-Wide Student Council: invitations to every middle and high school, replies from Patrick Marsh, Prairie Phoenix and Sun Prairie West, the registration question to Dr. Reed, and outreach to West's Student Council and Activities office. Added the Board student representative answer. Updated At a Glance, contacts and the meeting log.
- **November 4, 2026** — Added the advisory council thread (Dr. Reed's reply, Principal Shoemaker's concerns and Zackary's answer, and the Nov 4 meeting), letters to five more schools and Prairie View's reply, Nov 2 attendance, the Nov 9 rehearsal and Nov 17 follow-up invites, files shared by Dr. Mould, and a March Student Senate email. Updated At a Glance and the meeting log.
- **October 31, 2026** — Added the Oct 30 briefing to the student members going to the November 2 committee meeting, with their replies; noted in the meeting log that Zackary can't attend on Nov 2 because of work.
- **October 30, 2026** — Added At a Glance, a one-page timeline and a glossary. Clickable contents and PDF bookmarks. Meeting log put in date order. Part 2 put in date order. Officials' personal cell numbers removed. The second copy of the source documents removed; the Flock contract's full text now replaces 20 photo pages. Caregiver survey analysis held until the district confirms it can be public. School email removed from the contact page.

- **October 29, 2026** — Added Dr. Mould's November 2 meeting email, the advisory council proposal to Dr. Reed, questions to Dr. Mould about November 2 and 9, four new Student Voice graphics, and ten new reels across both Instagram accounts.
- **October 28, 2026** — Added Chief Warych's written answers to seven follow-up questions about the Axon plate readers, plus city budget dates.
- **October 27, 2026** — Added both logos, websites and Instagram accounts to the cover and About Me; the @sunprairiealpr account and ALPR handout; the Action Kit; the "What happened, why I started and why it matters" opening.
- **October 2026** — First combined edition, built from emails, invites, notes, documents and public posts from January to October 2026.